

Sophist

ΣΟΦΙΣΤΗΣ

Plato

translated by David Horan

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TD: Well, Socrates, as agreed yesterday,¹ we have come in person, and appropriately we are bringing this stranger, one of the people from Elea, an associate of those who follow Parmenides and Zeno.² He is a man with a great love of wisdom.

ΘΕΟ. κατὰ τὴν χθὲς ὁμολογίαν, ὧ Σώκρατες, ἤκομεν αὐτοί τε κοσμίως καὶ τόνδε τινὰ ξένον ἄγομεν, τὸ μὲν γένος ἐξ Ἑλέας, ἑταῖρον δὲ τῶν ἀμφὶ Παρμενίδην καὶ Ζήνωνα ἑταίρων, μάλα δὲ ἄνδρα φιλόσοφον. ΣΩ. ἄρ' οὖν, ὧ Θεόδωρε, οὐ ξένον ἀλλὰ τινα θεὸν ἄγων κατὰ τὸν Ὀμήρου λόγον λέληθας; ὅς φησιν ἄλλους

S: In that case, Theodorus, are you unwittingly bringing in some god rather than a stranger, as Homer's phrase would have it, when he says that the gods in general, and the god of strangers in particular, become the companions of people who partake of true righteousness, to behold the excesses and the good order of humanity?³ So, perhaps this companion of yours may indeed be one of those higher powers, who is going to watch over and refute our sorry predicament in these arguments, as he is a god of refutation.

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TD: That is not the manner of this stranger, Socrates. No, he is more moderate than those who take controversies seriously. Indeed, the man does not seem to me to be a god at all, though he is certainly divine, for I refer to all philosophers as divine.

τε θεοὺς τοῖς ἀνθρώποις ὅποσοι μετέχουσιν αἰδοῦς δικαίας, καὶ δὴ καὶ τὸν ξένιον οὐχ ἥκιστα θεὸν συνοπαδὸν γιγνόμενον ὕβρεις τε καὶ εὐνομίας τῶν ἀνθρώπων καθορᾶν. τάχ' οὖν ἂν καὶ σοί τις οὗτος τῶν κρειττόνων συνέπιτο, φαύλους ἡμᾶς ὄντας ἐν τοῖς λόγοις ἐποψόμενός τε καὶ ἐλέγξων, θεὸς ὧν τις ἐλεγκτικός. ΘΕΟ. οὐχ οὗτος ὁ τρόπος, ὧ Σώκρατες, τοῦ ξένου, ἀλλὰ μετριώτερος τῶν περὶ τὰς ἔριδας ἐσπουδακότων. καί μοι δοκεῖ θεὸς μὲν ἀνὴρ οὐδαμῶς εἶναι, θεῖος μὲν πάντας

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S: And rightly so, my friend. In fact, you could say that this kind is just as difficult to discern as that of the god. Because most people do not recognise them, they go in and out of the cities in all sorts of guises.⁴ And the actual philosophers, not the artificial ones, looking down from on high at the life of those below seem to some quite worthless, and to others most precious. Sometimes they appear as statesmen, at other times as sophists, and then again to some people they give the appearance of being utterly insane. Now, if it is acceptable to our stranger, I would like to find out from him what the people in his country think about these, and what names they use.

γὰρ ἐγὼ τοὺς φιλοσόφους τοιούτους προσαγορεύω. ΣΩ. καὶ καλῶς γε, ὦ φίλε. τοῦτο μέντοι κινδυνεύει τὸ γένος οὐ πολὺ τι ῥᾶον ὥς ἔπος εἰπεῖν εἶναι διακρίνειν ἢ τὸ τοῦ θεοῦ· πάννυ γὰρ ἄνδρες οὗτοι παντοῖοι φανταζόμενοι διὰ τὴν τῶν ἄλλων ἄγνοιαν ἐπιστρωφῶσι πόληας, οἳ μὴ πλαστῶς ἀλλ' ὄντως φιλόσοφοι, καθορῶντες ὑψόθεν τὸν τῶν κάτω βίον, καὶ τοῖς μὲν δοκοῦσιν εἶναι τοῦ μηδενὸς τίμιοι, τοῖς δ' ἄξιοι τοῦ παντός· καὶ τότε μὲν πολιτικοὶ φαντάζονται, τότε δὲ σοφισταί, τότε δ' ἔστιν οἷς δόξαν παράσχοιεντ' ἂν ὥς παντάπασιν ἔχοντες μανικῶς. τοῦ μέντοι ξένου ἡμῖν ἡδέως ἂν πυθθανοίμην, εἰ φίλον αὐτῷ, τί ταῦθ'

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TD: What are you referring to?

οἳ περὶ τὸν ἐκεῖ τόπον ἡγοῦντο καὶ ὠνόμαζον. ΘΕΟ. τὰ ποῖα δῆ; ΣΩ. σοφιστήν, πολιτικόν, φιλόσοφον. ΘΕΟ. τί δὲ μάλιστα καὶ τὸ ποῖόν τι περὶ αὐτῶν διαπορηθεὶς ἐρέσθαι διανοήθης; ΣΩ. τόδε· πότερον ἐν πάντα ταῦτα ἐνόμιζον ἢ δύο, ἢ καθάπερ τὰ ὀνόματα τρία, τρία καὶ τὰ γένη διαιρούμενοι καθ' ἐν ὄνομα γένος ἐκάστῳ προσῆπτον; ΘΕΟ. ἀλλ' οὐδεὶς, ὥς ἐγὼμαι, φθόνος αὐτῷ διελθεῖν αὐτά· ἢ πῶς, ὦ ξένε, λέγωμεν;

S: Sophist, statesman and philosopher.

TD: What do you want to ask? What exactly is puzzling you about them?

S: This: whether they regard all of these as one or two, or, as the names imply, three, also distinguishing three kinds and applying a name individually to each.

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TD: Well, I don't think that he is at all reluctant to give an account of these. But what does our stranger say?

ΞΕ. οὕτως, ὦ Θεόδωρε. φθόνος μὲν γὰρ οὐδεὶς οὐδὲ χαλεπὸν εἰπεῖν ὅτι γε τρί' ἡγοῦντο· καθ' ἕκαστον μὴν διορίσασθαι σαφῶς τί ποτ' ἔστιν, οὐ σμικρὸν οὐδὲ ῥάδιον ἔργον. ΘΕΟ. καὶ μὲν δὴ κατὰ τύχην γε, ὦ Σώκρατες, λόγων ἐπελάβου παραπλησίων ὧν καὶ πρὶν ἡμᾶς δεῦρ' ἐλθεῖν διερωτῶντες αὐτὸν ἐτυχάνομεν, ὃ δὲ ταῦτ' ἅπερ πρὸς σὲ νῦν καὶ τότε ἐσκήπτετο πρὸς ἡμᾶς· ἐπεὶ διακηκοέναι γέ φησιν ἱκανῶς καὶ οὐκ ἀμνημονεῖν.

ST: Just that, Theodorus. There is no reluctance at all, nor is there a problem stating that my people believe there are three. But to define what exactly each of them is would not be a simple or easy task.

TD: Well now, Socrates, by chance you have introduced questions much like those we happened to be asking him before we came here, and he gave the same excuse to us at the time as he gave to you just now. However, he does say that he has heard enough, in detail, and has not forgotten it.

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S: Then, stranger, do not deny us the first favour we ask, and tell us this much. Do you usually prefer to deliver a lengthy oration expressing what you wish to present to someone, in your own way? Or do you work through questioning, as Parmenides once did in my presence, as he expounded glorious arguments when I was young, while he was, by then, quite an elderly man indeed?⁵

ΣΩ. μὴ τοῖνυν, ὦ ξένε, ἡμῶν τήν γε πρώτην αἰτησάντων χάριν ἀπαρνηθεῖς γένῃ, τοσόνδε δ' ἡμῖν φράζε. πότερον εἴωθας ἥδιον αὐτὸς ἐπὶ σαυτοῦ μακρῶ λόγῳ διεξιέναι λέγων τοῦτο ὃ ἂν ἐνδείξασθαι τῷ βουλευθῆς, ἢ δι' ἐρωτήσεων, οἷόν ποτε καὶ Παρμενίδῃ χρωμένῳ καὶ

διεξιόντι λόγους παγκάλους παρεγενόμην ἐγὼ νέος ὢν, ἐκείνου μάλα δὴ τότε ὄντος πρεσβύτου;

ST: Well, Socrates, this interactive approach is easier with someone who converses mildly and co-operatively, but otherwise it is better to do the talking oneself.

S: Then you may select any member of the company you wish, for they will all respond gently to you, though if you take my advice you will choose one of the young men – Theaetetus here – or any of the others whom you prefer.

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ST: Socrates, I feel a certain shame now at our first encounter for not making conversation based on short word-for-word exchanges instead of expounding a lengthy and prolonged oration all by myself, or with a respondent, as though I were putting on an exhibition. In fact, there is more to this than one might imagine from your question, and any account of it must be an extremely lengthy one. Then again, it seems to me discourteous and uncivil not to oblige you and these people, especially when you express it in this way. As for Theaetetus, well I unreservedly accept him as a partner in discourse, based on my own previous conversation, and your present recommendation.

ΞΕ. τῷ μὲν, ὦ Σώκρατες, ἀλύπως τε καὶ εὐηνίως προσδιαλεγομένῳ ῥᾶον οὕτω, τὸ πρὸς ἄλλον· εἰ δὲ μή, τὸ καθ' αὐτόν. ΣΩ. ἔξεστι τοίνυν τῶν παρόντων ὃν ἂν βουληθῇς ἐκλέξασθαι, πάντες γὰρ ὑπακούσονται σοι πρᾶως· συμβούλῳ μὴν ἐμοὶ χρώμενος τῶν νέων τινὰ αἰρήσῃ, Θεαίτητον τόνδε, ἢ καὶ τῶν ἄλλων εἴ τις σοι κατὰ νοῦν. ΞΕ. ὦ Σώκρατες, αἰδῶς τίς μ' ἔχει τὸ νῦν πρῶτον συγγενόμενον ὑμῖν μὴ κατὰ σμικρὸν ἔπος πρὸς ἔπος ποιεῖσθαι

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TT: Go ahead, dear stranger, and, as Socrates says, you will be doing us all a favour.

τὴν συνουσίαν, ἀλλ' ἐκτείναντα ἀπομηκύνειν λόγον συχνὸν κατ' ἑμαυτόν, εἴτε καὶ πρὸς ἕτερον, οἷον ἐπίδειξιν ποιούμενον· τῷ γὰρ ὄντι

τὸ νῦν ῥηθὲν οὐχ ὅσον ὧδε ἐρωτηθὲν ἐλπίσειεν ἂν αὐτὸ εἶναί τις, ἀλλὰ τυγχάνει λόγου παμμήκους ὄν. τὸ δὲ αὖ σοὶ μὴ χαρίζεσθαι καὶ τοῖσδε, ἄλλως τε καὶ σοῦ λέξαντος ὡς εἶπες, ἄξενόν τι καταφαίνεται μοι καὶ

ST: There is probably no more to be said on these issues, and from now on the discussion should be with you, Theaetetus. So, if the length of it causes problems, do not blame me for that. Blame these friends of yours instead.

TT: Well, at the moment I don't think I shall give up on that account. However, if something like that does happen, we could involve Socrates here, the namesake of 'the' Socrates, as he is the same age as I am, we train together, and he is well used to working with me.

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ST: Well said, and you can make that decision for yourself as the discussion proceeds. But you and I should now investigate this together, beginning firstly, I believe, with the sophist, searching and clarifying through argument what precisely he is. Indeed, at the moment our only common possession is his name, though perhaps we have the function upon which we both confer that name, privately within ourselves. But we should always come to agreement on the issue itself through arguments rather than a mere name in the absence of argument. We intend to investigate this kind, the sophist, but it is not the easiest thing in the world to comprehend what precisely he is. Now, whenever major issues need to be worked out properly, everyone has traditionally agreed that in such circumstances we should practise first with small and simple things before moving on to the greater. So now, Theaetetus, I am advising us, in view of the difficulty and elusiveness of the sophistic kind, to practise the method first on something simpler, unless you can suggest an easier way.

ἄγριον. ἐπεὶ Θεαίτητόν γε τὸν προσδιαλεγόμενον εἶναι δέχομαι παντάπασιν ἐξ ὧν αὐτός τε πρότερον διείλεγμα καὶ σὺ τὰ νῦν μοι διακελεύῃ. ΘΕΑΙ. δρᾷ τοίνυν, ὦ ξέने, οὕτω καὶ καθάπερ εἶπε Σωκράτης πᾶσιν κεχαρισμένος ἔση. ΞΕ. κινδυνεύει πρὸς μὲν ταῦτα οὐδὲν ἔτι

λεκτέον εἶναι, Θεαίτητε· πρὸς δὲ σὲ ἤδη τὸ μετὰ τοῦτο, ὡς ἔοικε, γίγνοιτο ἂν ὁ λόγος. ἂν δ' ἄρα τι τῷ μήκει πονῶν ἄχθη, μὴ ἐμὲ αἰτιάσθαι τούτων, ἀλλὰ τούσδε τοὺς σοὺς ἐταίρους. ΘΕΑΙ. ἀλλ' οἶμαι μὲν δὴ νῦν οὕτως οὐκ ἀπερεῖν ἂν δ' ἄρα τι τοιοῦτον γίγνηται, καὶ τόνδε παραληψόμεθα Σωκράτη, τὸν Σωκράτους μὲν ὁμώνυμον, ἐμὸν δὲ ἡλικιώτην καὶ συγγυμναστήν, ᾧ συνδιαπονεῖν μετ' ἐμοῦ τὰ πολλὰ οὐκ ἄηθες. ΞΕ. εὖ λέγεις, καὶ ταῦτα μὲν ἰδίᾳ βουλευέση προϊόντος τοῦ λόγου· κοινῇ δὲ μετ' ἐμοῦ σοι συσκεπτέον ἀρχομένῳ πρῶτον, ὡς ἐμοὶ φαίνεται, νῦν ἀπὸ τοῦ σοφιστοῦ, ζητοῦντι καὶ ἐμφανίζοντι λόγῳ τί ποτ' ἔστι. νῦν γὰρ δὴ σύ τε κἀγὼ τούτου πέρι τοῦνομα μόνον ἔχομεν κοινῇ, τὸ δὲ ἔργον ἐφ' ᾧ καλοῦμεν ἑκάτερος τάχ' ἂν ἰδίᾳ παρ' ἡμῖν αὐτοῖς ἔχοιμεν· δεῖ δὲ ἀεὶ παντὸς πέρι τὸ πρᾶγμα αὐτὸ μᾶλλον διὰ λόγων ἢ τοῦνομα μόνον συνωμολογήσθαι χωρὶς λόγου. τὸ δὲ φύλον δ' νῦν ἐπινοοῦμεν ζητεῖν οὐ πάντων ῥᾶστον συλλαβεῖν τί ποτ' ἔστιν, ὁ σοφιστής· ὅσα δ' αὖ τῶν μεγάλων δεῖ διαπονεῖσθαι καλῶς, περὶ τῶν τοιούτων δέδοκται πᾶσιν καὶ πάλαι

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TT: No, I cannot.

τὸ πρότερον ἐν σμικροῖς καὶ ῥάοσιν αὐτὰ δεῖν μελετᾶν, πρὶν ἐν αὐτοῖς τοῖς μεγίστοις. νῦν οὖν, ὦ Θεαίτητε, ἔγωγε καὶ νῶν οὕτω συμβουλευώ, χαλεπὸν καὶ δυσθήρευτον ἡγησαμένοις εἶναι τὸ τοῦ σοφιστοῦ γένος πρότερον ἐν ἄλλῳ ῥάονι τὴν μέθοδον αὐτοῦ προμελετᾶν, εἰ μὴ σύ ποθεν εὐπετεστέραν ἔχεις εἰπεῖν ἄλλην ὁδόν. ΘΕΑΙ. ἀλλ' οὐκ ἔχω. ΞΕ. βούλει δῆτα περὶ τίνος τῶν φαύλων μετιόντες πειραθῶμεν παράδειγμα αὐτὸ θέσθαι τοῦ μείζονος;

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ST: In that case, do you want us to resort to some ordinary example, and attempt to position it as a model for what's more important?

ΘΕΑΙ. ναί. ΞΕ. τί δῆτα προταξαίμεθ' ἂν εὐγνωστον μὲν καὶ σμικρόν, λόγον δὲ μηδενὸς ἐλάττονα ἔχον τῶν μείζονων; οἷον ἀσπαλιευτής ἄρ' οὐ πᾶσί τε γνώριμον καὶ σπουδῆς οὐ πάνυ τι πολλῆς τίνος ἐπάξιον; ΘΕΑΙ. οὕτως.

Tt: Yes.

St: Well then, what should we choose first as something minor and well known, and yet having an account no shorter than the important items? What about an angler, since he is readily recognisable to everyone without being of any great significance?

Tt: Just so.

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St: Well, I hope he provides us with a method and an account that is suitable to our purposes.

ΞΕ. μέθοδον μὴν αὐτὸν ἐλπίζω καὶ λόγον οὐκ ἀνεπιτήδειον ἡμῖν ἔχειν πρὸς ὃ βουλόμεθα. ΘΕΑΙ. καλῶς ἂν ἔχοι. ΞΕ. φέρε δὴ, τῇδε ἀρχώμεθα αὐτοῦ. καὶ μοι λέγε· πότερον ὡς τεχνίτην αὐτὸν ἢ τινα ἄτεχνον, ἄλλην δὲ δύναμιν ἔχοντα θήσομεν; ΘΕΑΙ. ἥκιστα γε ἄτεχνον. ΞΕ. ἀλλὰ μὴν τῶν γε τεχνῶν πασῶν σχεδὸν εἶδη δύο. ΘΕΑΙ. πῶς; ΞΕ. γεωργία μὲν καὶ ὅση περὶ τὸ θνητὸν πᾶν σῶμα θεραπεία, τό τε αὖ περὶ τὸ σύνθετον καὶ πλαστόν, ὃ δὴ

Tt: That would be good.

St: Come on, let's begin as follows. Tell me whether we should propose that he is a skilled person or someone who is unskilled, but has some other power.

Tt: He is certainly not unskilled.

St: Well then, all skills belong basically to two forms.

Tt: How so?

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St: Farming and the general care of any mortal creature, also the assembling or moulding of what we call household goods, and the imitative skill, may all be most properly referred to by a single name.

σκεῦος ὠνομάκαμεν, ἥ τε μιμητική, σύμπαντα ταῦτα δικαιοτάτ' ἂν ἐνὶ προσαγορεύοιτ' ἂν ὀνόματι. ΘΕΑΙ. πῶς καὶ τίनि; ΞΕ. πᾶν ὅπερ ἂν μὴ πρότερόν τις ὄν ὕστερον εἰς οὐσίαν ἄγῃ, τὸν μὲν ἄγοντα ποιεῖν, τὸ δὲ

ἀγόμενον ποιῆσθαι πού φαμεν. ΘΕΑΙ. ὀρθῶς. ΞΕ. τὰ δέ γε νυνδὴ ἃ διήλθομεν ἅπαντα εἶχεν εἰς τοῦτο τὴν αὐτῶν δύναμιν. ΘΕΑΙ. εἶχε γὰρ οὖν. ΞΕ. ποιητικὴν τοίνυν αὐτὰ συγκεφαλαιωσάμενοι προσείπωμεν.

TT: How? What is it?

ST: When a person brings something into being which previously was not, we usually say that he who brings it into being produces it, and whatever is brought into being is produced.

TT: Correct.

ST: And the power of everything we just mentioned is directed towards production.

TT: That is indeed their direction.

ST: Then we may refer to these by the general term 'productive'.

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TT: We may.

ΘΕΑΙ. ἔστω. ΞΕ. τὸ δὴ μαθηματικὸν αὖ μετὰ τοῦτο εἶδος ὅλον καὶ τὸ τῆς γνώσεως τό τε χρηματιστικὸν καὶ ἀγωνιστικὸν καὶ θηρευτικόν, ἐπειδὴ δημιουργεῖ μὲν οὐδὲν τούτων, τὰ δὲ ὄντα καὶ γεγονότα τὰ μὲν χειροῦται λόγοις καὶ πράξεσι, τὰ δὲ τοῖς χειρουμένοις οὐκ ἐπιτρέπει, μάλιστ' ἄν που διὰ ταῦτα συνάπαντα τὰ μέρη τέχνη τις κτητικὴ λεχθεῖσα ἂν διαπρέψειεν. ΘΕΑΙ. ναί· πρέποι γὰρ ἄν.

ST: Now, besides this, there is the whole form that includes learning, knowledge acquisition, finance, sport and hunting. Although none of these actually manufacture anything, some manipulate by speech and action what has come into being or already exists, while others prevent anyone else from manipulating them. On this basis, all these subdivisions may very properly be said to constitute an acquisitive skill.

TT: Yes, that would be appropriate.

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ST: Then, since all skills are either productive or acquisitive, in which of the two should we place angling, Theaetetus?

ΞΕ. κτητικῆς δὴ καὶ ποιητικῆς συμπασῶν οὐσῶν τῶν τεχνῶν ἐν ποτέρᾳ τὴν ἀσπαλιευτικὴν, ᾧ Θεαίτητε, τιθῶμεν; ΘΕΑΙ. ἐν κτητικῇ που δῆλον.
ΞΕ. κτητικῆς δὲ ἄρ' οὐ δύο εἶδη; τὸ μὲν ἐκόντων πρὸς ἐκόντας μεταβλητικὸν ὃν διὰ τε δωρεῶν καὶ μισθώσεων καὶ ἀγοράσεων, τὸ δὲ λοιπόν, ἢ κατ' ἔργα ἢ κατὰ λόγους χειρούμενον σύμπαν, χειρωτικὸν ἂν εἴη; ΘΕΑΙ. φαίνεται γοῦν ἐκ τῶν εἰρημένων. ΞΕ. τί δέ; τὴν χειρωτικὴν ἄρ' οὐ διχῇ τμητέον; ΘΕΑΙ. πῇ;

TT: In the acquisitive. I suppose that is obvious.

ST: But are there not two forms of the acquisitive, one being an exchange between willing participants through gifts, hire or purchase, while the rest includes all manipulation based upon word or deed, and this would be the manipulative skill?

TT: It appears so anyway, from what has been said.

ST: But what about this? Shouldn't the manipulative skill be divided into two?

TT: In what way?

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ST: By designating all overt manipulation as competitive, and all manipulation by stealth as hunting.

ΞΕ. τὸ μὲν ἀναφανδὸν ὅλον ἀγωνιστικὸν θέντας, τὸ δὲ κρυφαῖον αὐτῆς πᾶν θηρευτικόν. ΘΕΑΙ. ναί. ΞΕ. τὴν δέ γε μὴν θηρευτικὴν ἄλογον τὸ μὴ οὐ τέμνειν διχῇ. ΘΕΑΙ. λέγε ὅπῃ. ΞΕ. τὸ μὲν ἀψύχου γένους διελομένους, τὸ δ' ἐμψύχου. ΘΕΑΙ. τί μὴν; εἴπερ ἔστον γε ἄμφω.

TT: Yes.

ST: However, it would be unreasonable not to divide hunting in two.

TT: Tell me how.

ST: By categorising it as the hunting of living or lifeless prey.

Tt: Why yes, if there are indeed both.

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St: How could there not be both? Though it is best to disregard the hunting of the inanimate, as it does not even have a name, except for certain parts of diving and other trifling activities of that sort. However, we should refer to the hunting of living creatures as animal hunting.

ΞΕ. πῶς δὲ οὐκ ἔστων; καὶ δεῖ γε ἡμᾶς τὸ μὲν τῶν ἀψύχων, ἀνώνυμον ὄν πλην κατ' ἓνια τῆς κολυμβητικῆς ἅττα μέρη καὶ τοιαῦτ' ἄλλα βραχέα, χαίρειν ἑᾶσαι, τὸ δέ, τῶν ἐμψύχων ζώων οὔσαν θήραν, προσειπεῖν ζωοθηρικὴν. ΘΕΑΙ. ἔστω. ΞΕ. ζωοθηρικῆς δὲ ἅρ' οὐ διπλοῦν εἶδος ἂν λέγοιτο ἐν δίκῃ, τὸ μὲν πεζοῦ γένους, πολλοῖς εἴδεσι καὶ ὀνόμασι διηρημένον, πεζοθηρικόν, τὸ δ' ἕτερον νευστικοῦ ζώου πᾶν ἐνυγοθηρικόν; ΘΕΑΙ. πάνυ γε.

Tt: So be it.

St: Can't we also say, properly speaking, that animal hunting is twofold in form? One kind involving land animals is divided into many forms and names, while the other includes the swimming creatures and is generally called water animal hunting.

Tt: Yes, certainly.

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St: Now, we observe that one class of swimming creatures has wings, while the other lives in the water.

ΞΕ. νευστικοῦ μὴν τὸ μὲν πτηνὸν φῦλον ὀρώμεν, τὸ δὲ ἔνυδρον; ΘΕΑΙ. πῶς δ' οὐ; ΞΕ. καὶ τοῦ πτηνοῦ μὴν γένους πᾶσα ἡμῖν ἡ θήρα λέγεται πού τις ὀρνιθευτική. ΘΕΑΙ. λέγεται γὰρ οὖν. ΞΕ. τοῦ δὲ ἐνύδρου σχεδὸν τὸ σύνολον ἀλιευτική. ΘΕΑΙ. ναί. ΞΕ. τί δέ; ταύτην αὖ τὴν θήραν ἅρ' οὐκ ἂν κατὰ μέγιστα μέρη δύο διέλοιμεν; ΘΕΑΙ. κατὰ ποῖα; ΞΕ. καθ' ἃ τὸ μὲν ἔρκεσιν αὐτόθεν ποιεῖται τὴν θήραν, τὸ δὲ πληγῇ. ΘΕΑΙ. πῶς λέγεις, καὶ πῇ διαιρούμενος ἑκάτερον;

Tt: Obviously.

ST: And the hunting of the winged kind is generally referred to as fowling, I suppose.

TT: Yes, that's what it's called.

ST: While the hunting of the water dwellers is, in general, termed fishing.

TT: Yes.

ST: What about this? Can't we also divide this hunting again into two broad significant parts?

TT: Based upon what?

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ST: Based on whether they conduct the hunt with traps or by striking.

ΞΕ. τὸ μὲν, ὅτι πᾶν ὅσον ἂν ἔνεκα κωλύσεως εἴργη τι περιέχον, ἔρκος εἰκὸς ὀνομάζειν. ΘΕΑΙ. πάνυ μὲν οὖν. ΞΕ. κύρτους δὴ καὶ δίκτυα καὶ βρόχους καὶ πόρκους καὶ τὰ τοιαῦτα μῶν ἄλλο τι πλὴν ἔρκη χρὴ προσαγορεύειν; ΘΕΑΙ. οὐδέν. ΞΕ. τοῦτο μὲν ἄρα ἐρκοθηρικὸν τῆς ἄγρας τὸ μέρος φήσομεν ἢ τι τοιοῦτον. ΘΕΑΙ. ναί. ΞΕ. τὸ δὲ ἀγκίστροις καὶ τριόδουσι πληγῇ γιγνόμενον

TT: What do you mean? And how do you distinguish between these?

ST: Well, whatever encloses something, and completely surrounds it to imprison it, may properly be called a trap.

TT: Yes, certainly.

ST: So, baskets, nets, snares, nooses and the like must obviously be referred to as traps.

TT: Indeed.

ST: Then we shall say that this part of hunting is trapping, or something of that sort.

TT: Yes.

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ST: But, Theaetetus, hunting effected by impact with hooks or tridents is different from this, and should now be referred to by the single word 'striking', unless someone has a better suggestion.

ἕτερον μὲν ἐκείνου, πληκτικὴν δέ τινα θήραν ἡμᾶς προσεῖπεῖν ἐνὶ λόγῳ νῦν χρεών· ἢ τί τις ἄν, ὧ θεαίτητε, εἴποι κάλλιον; ΘΕΑΙ. ἀμελῶμεν τοῦ ὀνόματος· ἀρκεῖ γὰρ καὶ τοῦτο. ΞΕ. τῆς τοίνυν πληκτικῆς τὸ μὲν νυκτερινὸν οἶμαι πρὸς πυρὸς φῶς γιγνόμενον ὑπ' αὐτῶν τῶν περὶ τὴν θήραν πυρευτικὴν ῥηθῆναι συμβέβηκεν. ΘΕΑΙ. πάνυ γε. ΞΕ. τὸ δέ γε μεθημερινόν, ὡς ἐχόντων ἐν ἄκροις ἄγκιστρα καὶ τῶν τριοδόντων, πᾶν ἀγκιστρευτικόν.

TT: Let's not bother about the name, this one will suffice.

ST: Well, I believe that striking that occurs at night by firelight is referred to by the hunters themselves as fire-hunting.

TT: It is, indeed.

ST: While striking conducted in daylight is generally termed barbing, as both the tridents and the hooks are barbed at the tip.

TT: Yes, that's what it is called.

220e

ST: Now, this striking by barbing, when performed from above upon prey which is below, is called tridentry, I believe, as it is usually done using tridents.

ΘΕΑΙ. λέγεται γὰρ οὕν. ΞΕ. τοῦ τοίνυν ἀγκιστρευτικοῦ τῆς πληκτικῆς τὸ μὲν ἄνωθεν εἰς τὸ κάτω γιγνόμενον διὰ τὸ τοῖς τριοδούσιν οὕτω μάλιστα χρῆσθαι τριοδοντία τις οἶμαι κέκληται. ΘΕΑΙ. φασὶ γοῦν τινές. ΞΕ. τὸ δέ γε λοιπὸν ἐστὶν ἐν ἑτι μόνον ὡς εἶπεῖν εἶδος. ΘΕΑΙ. τὸ ποῖον; ΞΕ. τὸ τῆς ἐναντίας ταύτης πληγῆς, ἀγκίστρω τε γιγνόμενον καὶ τῶν ἰχθύων οὐχ ἢ τις ἄν τύχη τοῦ σώματος, ὥσπερ

TT: Well, that's what some people call it.

ST: However, there is, so to speak, only one form still left.

Tt: What is it?

221a

St: The kind which delivers the blow which is opposite to the trident and is effected with a hook, but not to any random part of the body of the fish, but always to the head and mouth of the victim, pulling him upwards from below with rods or sticks. By what name shall we say this process should be called, Theaetetus?

τοῖς τριόδουσιν, ἀλλὰ περὶ τὴν κεφαλὴν καὶ τὸ στόμα τοῦ θηρευθέντος ἐκάστοτε, καὶ κάτωθεν εἰς τοῦναντίον ἄνω ῥάβδοις καὶ καλάμοις ἀνασπώμενον· οὗ τί φήσομεν, ὦ Θεαίτητε, δεῖν τοῦνομα λέγεσθαι; ΘΕΑΙ. δοκῶ μὲν, ὅπερ ἄρτι προϋθέμεθα δεῖν ἐξευρεῖν, τοῦτ' αὐτὸ νῦν ἀποτετελέσθαι. ΞΕ. νῦν ἄρα τῆς ἀσπαλιευτικῆς πέρι σύ τε κἀγὼ

Tt: Well, we proposed earlier that we needed to discover something, and I think our search has just been concluded.

221b

St: So, now you and I have come to agreement not just about the name of angling, but we have also acquired a satisfactory account of the function itself. Indeed, from the totality of skills, one half was acquisitive, half of the acquisitive was manipulative, and half of manipulative was hunting. Half of hunting was animal-hunting, and half of animal-hunting was water animal-hunting. The lower division of water animal-hunting was fishing, and half of fishing was striking, and half of striking was barbing. Now, the barbing by a blow which pulls upwards from below has a name which reflects this activity, and this is the angling for which we have been seeking.

συνωμολογήκαμεν οὐ μόνον τοῦνομα, ἀλλὰ καὶ τὸν λόγον περὶ αὐτὸ τοῦργον εἰλήφαμεν ἰκανῶς. συμπάσης γὰρ τέχνης τὸ μὲν ἡμῖς μέρος κτητικὸν ἦν, κτητικοῦ δὲ χειρωτικόν, χειρωτικοῦ δὲ θηρευτικόν, τοῦ δὲ θηρευτικοῦ ζωοθηρικόν, ζωοθηρικοῦ δὲ ἐνυγροθηρικόν, ἐνυγροθηρικοῦ δὲ τὸ κάτωθεν τμήμα ὅλον ἀλιευτικόν, ἀλιευτικῆς δὲ πληκτικόν, πληκτικῆς δὲ ἀγκιστρευτικόν· τούτου δὲ τὸ περὶ τὴν κάτωθεν

221c

TT: Yes, that has certainly been made abundantly clear.

ἄνω πληγὴν ἀνασπασμένην, ἀπ' αὐτῆς τῆς πράξεως ἀφομοιωθὲν τοῦνομα, ἢ νῦν ἀσπαλιευτικὴ ζητηθεῖσα ἐπὶ κλην γέγονεν. ΘΕΑΙ. παντάπασι μὲν οὖν τοῦτο γε ἱκανῶς δεδήλωται. ΞΕ. φέρε δὴ, κατὰ τοῦτο τὸ παράδειγμα καὶ τὸν σοφιστὴν ἐπιχειρῶμεν εὐρεῖν ὅτι ποτ' ἔστιν. ΘΕΑΙ. κομιδῇ μὲν οὖν. ΞΕ. καὶ μὴν ἐκεῖνό γ' ἦν τὸ ζήτημα πρῶτον, πότερον ἰδιώτην ἢ τινα τέχνην ἔχοντα θετέον εἶναι τὸν ἀσπαλιευτὴν. ΘΕΑΙ. ναί.

ST: Come now, let's try to find out what exactly a sophist is, based upon this model.

TT: Yes, certainly.

ST: Now, the first question we asked was whether we should regard the angler as an ordinary man, or as someone with a skill.

TT: Yes.

221d

ST: And shall we now propose, Theaetetus, that this other man is an ordinary man, or in truth utterly wise?

ΞΕ. καὶ νῦν δὴ τοῦτον ἰδιώτην θήσομεν, ὃ Θεαίτητε, ἢ παντάπασιν ὡς ἀληθῶς σοφιστὴν; ΘΕΑΙ. οὐδαμῶς ἰδιώτην· μανθάνω γὰρ ὁ λέγεις, ὡς παντὸς δεῖ τοιοῦτος εἶναι τό γε ὄνομα τοῦτο ἔχων. ΞΕ. ἀλλὰ τινα τέχνην αὐτὸν ἡμῖν ἔχοντα, ὡς ἔοικε, θετέον. ΘΕΑΙ. τίνα ποτ' οὖν δὴ ταύτην; ΞΕ. ἄρ' ὃ πρὸς θεῶν ἡγνοήκαμεν ἀνδρὸς τὸν ἄνδρα ὄντα συγγενῇ; ΘΕΑΙ. τίνα τοῦ; ΞΕ. τὸν ἀσπαλιευτὴν τοῦ σοφιστοῦ. ΘΕΑΙ. πῃ; ΞΕ. θηρευτά τινα καταφαίνεσθον ἄμφω μοι.

TT: He is certainly not an ordinary man. However, I understand what you mean, as he falls far short of the wisdom which his name implies.⁶

ST: But it seems we must propose that he has some skill.

TT: Well, in that case, what precisely would it be?

ST: By the gods, have we ignored the fact that this man is related to the other man?

TT: Who is related to whom?

ST: The angler to the sophist.

TT: In what way?

ST: To me they are both quite obviously hunters of some sort.

221e

TT: What is the hunt of the sophist? We have said what the other man hunts.

ΘΕΑΙ. τίνος θήρας ἄτερος; τὸν μὲν γὰρ ἕτερον εἶπομεν. ΞΕ. δίχα που νυνδὴ διείλομεν τὴν ἄγραν πᾶσαν, νευστικοῦ μέρους, τὸ δὲ πεζοῦ τέμνοντες. ΘΕΑΙ. ναί. ΞΕ. καὶ τὸ μὲν διήλθομεν, ὅσον περὶ τὰ νευστικά τῶν ἐνύδρων· τὸ δὲ πεζὸν εἰάσαμεν ἄσχιστον, εἰπόντες ὅτι πολυειδὲς εἶη.

ST: We somehow divided all hunting into two parts just now, one of swimming creatures and the other of land creatures.

TT: Yes.

ST: And we went on to discuss those swimming creatures who live in water, while we left the land animals undivided, though we said there were many forms.

222a

TT: Certainly.

ΘΕΑΙ. πάνυ γε. ΞΕ. μέχρι μὲν τοίνυν ἐνταῦθα ὁ σοφιστὴς καὶ ὁ ἀσπαλιευτὴς ἅμα ἀπὸ τῆς κητικῆς τέχνης πορεύεσθον. ΘΕΑΙ. εἰκότα γοῦν. ΞΕ. ἐκτρέπεσθον δέ γε ἀπὸ τῆς ζωοθηρικῆς, ὁ μὲν ἐπὶ θάλατταν που καὶ ποταμοὺς καὶ λίμνας, τὰ ἐν τούτοις ζῶα θηρευσόμενος. ΘΕΑΙ. τί μὴν; ΞΕ. ὁ δέ γε ἐπὶ τὴν γῆν καὶ ποταμοὺς ἑτέρους αὖ τινας, πλούτου καὶ νεότητος οἷον λειμῶνας ἀφθόνους, τὰν τούτοις θρέμματα χειρυσόμενος.

ST: So, beginning with the acquisitive skill, the sophist and the angler proceed together up to this point.

TT: So it seems, anyway.

ST: However, they diverge when it comes to animal hunting, and one will hunt animals in seas, rivers and lakes.

TT: Of course.

ST: While the other will hunt by land, and in quite different rivers of wealth and youth, which are like abundant meadows, in order to manipulate the creatures in them.

222b

TT: What do you mean?

ΘΕΑΙ. πῶς λέγεις; ΞΕ. τῆς πεζῆς θήρας γίγνεσθον δύο μεγίστω τινὲ μέρει. ΘΕΑΙ. ποῖον ἐκάτερον; ΞΕ. τὸ μὲν τῶν ἡμέρων, τὸ δὲ τῶν ἀγρίων. ΘΕΑΙ. εἴτ' ἔστι τις θήρα τῶν ἡμέρων; ΞΕ. εἴπερ γέ ἐστιν ἄνθρωπος ἡμερον ζῶον. θές δὲ ὅπη χαίρεις, εἴτε μηδὲν τιθεὶς ἡμερον, εἴτε ἄλλο μὲν ἡμερόν τι, τὸν δὲ ἄνθρωπον ἄγριον, εἴτε ἡμερον μὲν λέγεις αὖ τὸν ἄνθρωπον, ἀνθρώπων δὲ μηδεμίαν ἡγήθῃ θήραν· τούτων ὁπότερ' ἂν ἡγῇ φίλον εἰρησθαί σοι, τοῦτο ἡμῖν διόρισον.

ST: There are two significant parts of land animal hunting.

TT: What are they?

222c

ST: One is of the tame and the other of the wild.

ΘΕΑΙ. ἀλλ' ἡμᾶς τε ἡμερον, ὃ ξένε, ἡγοῦμαι ζῶον, θήραν τε ἀνθρώπων εἶναι λέγω. ΞΕ. διττὴν τοίνυν καὶ τὴν ἡμεροθηρικὴν εἴπωμεν. ΘΕΑΙ. κατὰ τί λέγοντες; ΞΕ. τὴν μὲν ληστικὴν καὶ ἀνδραποδιστικὴν καὶ τυραννικὴν καὶ σύμπασαν τὴν πολεμικὴν, ἐν πάντα, βίαιον θήραν, ὀρισάμενοι. ΘΕΑΙ. καλῶς. ΞΕ. τὴν δὲ γε δικανικὴν καὶ δημηγορικὴν καὶ προσομιλητικὴν, ἐν αὖ τὸ σύνολον, πιθανουργικὴν τινα μίαν

TT: Is there any hunting of tame animals?

ST: Yes, if man is indeed a tame animal. But propose whatever you like, either that no animal is tame, or that some other animal is tame while man is wild, or that man is actually tame but in your opinion there is no hunting of men whatsoever. Make whatever one of these statements pleases you, and let that be our definition.

TT: Well, I believe that we are tame creatures, and I say that there is hunting of men.

ST: Let's declare that tame animal hunting also has a twofold division.

TT: On what basis is that said?

ST: By defining piracy, enslavement, tyranny, and everything military under the single heading of violent hunting.

TT: Good.

222d

ST: And by then referring to skill in winning court cases, speaking to crowds, and general conversation, all together, as the single skill of persuasion.

τέχνην προσειπόντες. ΘΕΑΙ. ὀρθῶς. ΞΕ. τῆς δὴ πιθανουργικῆς διττὰ λέγωμεν γένη. ΘΕΑΙ. ποῖα; ΞΕ. τὸ μὲν ἕτερον ἰδίᾳ, τὸ δὲ δημοσίᾳ γιγνόμενον. ΘΕΑΙ. γίνεσθον γὰρ οὖν εἶδος ἐκάτερον. ΞΕ. οὐκοῦν αὖ τῆς ἰδιοθηρευτικῆς τὸ μὲν μισθαρνητικόν ἐστιν, τὸ δὲ δωροφορικόν; ΘΕΑΙ. οὐ μανθάνω. ΞΕ. τῇ τῶν ἐρώντων θήρᾳ τὸν νοῦν, ὡς ἔοικας, οὕτω προσέσχες. ΘΕΑΙ. τοῦ πέρι;

TT: Correct.

ST: Now, we should say that there are two kinds of persuasion.

TT: What are they?

ST: One operates in private, the other in public.

TT: Yes, each of these does constitute a form.

ST: Now, isn't the hunting of private persons, for its part, either reward-accepting or gift-bearing?

TT: I do not understand.

ST: It seems you have not yet paid attention to the hunting carried out by lovers.

TT: To what aspect?

222e

ST: That besides everything else, they bestow gifts on those whom they hunt.

ΞΕ. ὅτι τοῖς θηρευθεῖσι δῶρα προσεπιδιδόασιν. ΘΕΑΙ. ἀληθέστατα λέγεις. ΞΕ. τοῦτο μὲν τοίνυν ἐρωτικῆς τέχνης ἔστω εἶδος. ΘΕΑΙ. πάνυ γε. ΞΕ. τοῦ δέ γε μισθαρνητικοῦ τὸ μὲν προσομιλοῦν διὰ χάριτος καὶ παντάπασι δι' ἡδονῆς τὸ δέλεαρ πεποιημένον καὶ τὸν μισθὸν πραττόμενον τροφήν ἑαυτῷ μόνον κολακικήν, ὥς

TT: Very true.

ST: Well, let this form then be called the skill of love.

TT: Certainly.

ST: But the form which accepts reward converses for the sake of gratification, and lays its bait entirely through pleasure, demanding only its own sustenance as a reward. And I think we would all refer to this as flattery, a skill in making things pleasant.

TT: Yes, what else could it be?

223a

ST: However, when it professes to carry on its discourse as though for the sake of excellence, and exacts a financial reward, doesn't that kind deserve a different name from the previous one?

ἐγῶμαι, πάντες φαῖμεν ἂν ἡ ἡδυντικήν τινα τέχνην εἶναι. ΘΕΑΙ. πῶς γὰρ οὐ; ΞΕ. τὸ δὲ ἐπαγγελλόμενον μὲν ὡς ἀρετῆς ἔνεκα τὰς ὁμιλίας ποιούμενον, μισθὸν δὲ νόμισμα πραττόμενον, ἄρα οὐ τοῦτο τὸ γένος ἐτέρῳ προσειπεῖν ἄξιον ὀνόματι; ΘΕΑΙ. πῶς γὰρ οὐ; ΞΕ. τίτι δὴ τούτῳ; πειρῶ λέγειν. ΘΕΑΙ. δῆλον δὴ τὸν γὰρ σοφιστήν μοι δοκοῦμεν

ἀνηυρηκέναί. τοῦτ' οὖν ἔγωγε εἰπὼν τὸ προσῆκον ὄνομ' ἂν ἡγοῦμαι καλεῖν αὐτόν.

TT: Yes, it must.

ST: What name? Try to say.

TT: Well, it's obvious. Indeed, we seem to me to have discovered the sophist. So, having said that, I think I would be calling it by the appropriate name.

223b

ST: Then it seems, Theaetetus, based on the present account, that what must be referred to as sophistry is an acquisitive skill of hunting live, land-dwelling prey, hunting humans privately for money payment, which seems to be educational, and is a hunt for rich and famous young men. That is what our current argument concludes.

ΞΕ. κατὰ δὴ τὸν νῦν, ὃ Θεαίτητε, λόγον, ὡς ἔοικεν, ἡ τέχνης οἰκειωτικῆς, χειρωτικῆς, κτητικῆς, θηρευτικῆς, ζωοθηρίας, πεζοθηρίας, χερσαίας, ἡμεροθηρικῆς, ἀνθρωποθηρίας, πιθανοθηρίας, ἰδιοθηρίας, μισθαρνικῆς, νομισματοπωλικῆς, δοξοπαιδευτικῆς, νέων πλουσίων καὶ ἐνδόξων γιγνομένη θήρα προσρητέον, ὡς ὁ νῦν λόγος ἡμῖν συμβαίνει, σοφιστική. ΘΕΑΙ. παντάπασιν μὲν οὖν.

TT: Entirely so.

ST: Let's take a further look at this. For what we are pursuing belongs to no ordinary skill but to an extremely variegated one. And, indeed, in our previous deliberations, the appearance is given that it is not what we are now saying it is, but is a different kind.

223c

TT: In what way?

ΞΕ. ἔτι δὲ καὶ τῇδε ἴδωμεν· οὐ γάρ τι φαύλης μέτοχόν ἐστι τέχνης τὸ νῦν ζητούμενον, ἀλλ' εὖ μάλα ποικίλης. καὶ γὰρ οὖν ἐν τοῖς πρόσθεν εἰρημένοις φάντασμα παρέχεται μὴ τοῦτο ὃ νῦν αὐτὸ ἡμεῖς φαμεν ἀλλ' ἕτερον εἶναι τι γένος. ΘΕΑΙ. πῇ δὴ; ΞΕ. τὸ τῆς κτητικῆς τέχνης διπλοῦν

ἦν εἶδος που, τὸ μὲν θηρευτικὸν μέρος ἔχον, τὸ δὲ ἀλλακτικόν. ΘΕΑΙ. ἦν γὰρ οὖν. ΞΕ. τῆς τοίνυν ἀλλακτικῆς δύο εἶδη λέγωμεν, τὸ μὲν δωρητικόν, τὸ δὲ ἕτερον ἀγοραστικόν; ΘΕΑΙ. εἰρήσθω. ΞΕ. καὶ μὴν αὖ φήσομεν ἀγοραστικὴν διχῇ τέμνεσθαι.

ST: The acquisitive skill somehow was a twofold form, one part was hunting and the other exchange.

TT: It was, indeed.

ST: Should we now declare that there are two forms of exchange, one based on gifts, the other on purchase?

TT: Let's say so.

ST: And we shall actually go on to say that purchasing is divided in two.

223d

TT: How?

ΘΕΑΙ. πῆ; ΞΕ. τὴν μὲν τῶν αὐτουργῶν αὐτοπωλικὴν διαιρουμένην, τὴν δὲ τὰ ἀλλότρια ἔργα μεταβαλλομένην μεταβλητικὴν. ΘΕΑΙ. πάνυ γε. ΞΕ. τί δέ; τῆς μεταβλητικῆς οὐχ ἡ μὲν κατὰ πόλιν ἀλλαγὴ, σχεδὸν αὐτῆς ἡμῖς μέρος ὄν, καπηλικὴ προσαγορεύεται; ΘΕΑΙ. ναί. ΞΕ. τὸ δέ γε ἐξ ἄλλης εἰς ἄλλην πόλιν διαλλάττον ὡνῇ καὶ πράσει ἐμπορικὴ; ΘΕΑΙ. τί δ' οὐ;

ST: By distinguishing between the sale of one's own productions, which is 'self-selling', and dealing in the productions of others, which is barter.

TT: Yes, certainly.

ST: What about this? Don't we refer to barter within the city, which is roughly half of it, as retailing?

TT: Yes.

ST: And the barter between one city and another, by sale and purchase, as trading?

Tt: Of course.

223e

St: Have we not observed that there is trading which, in one case, exchanges for money whatever sustains and provides for the body, and, in another case, whatever sustains and provides for the soul?

ΞΕ. τῆς δ' ἐμπορικῆς ἄρ' οὐκ ἠσθήμεθα ὅτι τὸ μὲν ὅσοις τὸ σῶμα τρέφεται καὶ χρῆται, τὸ δὲ ὅσοις ἡ ψυχὴ, πωλοῦν διὰ νομίσματος ἀλλάττεται; ΘΕΑΙ. πῶς τοῦτο λέγεις; ΞΕ. τὸ περὶ τὴν ψυχὴν ἴσως ἀγνοοῦμεν, ἐπεὶ τό γε ἕτερόν που συνίεμεν. ΘΕΑΙ. ναί.

Tt: What do you mean by that?

St: Perhaps we don't recognise this in relation to the soul, though we do presumably understand the other instance.

Tt: Yes.

224a

St: Well, let's speak about music and skills in general, which are constantly going from city to city, being bought in one place, brought somewhere else and sold. Paintings, entertainments and much else besides are brought in and sold, some for the delight, others for the more serious intent, of the soul. Now, a buyer or seller of these has as much right to be called a trader as those who sell food and drink.

ΞΕ. μουσικὴν τε τοίνυν συνάπασαν λέγωμεν, ἐκ πόλεως ἐκάστοτε εἰς πόλιν ἔνθεν μὲν ὠνηθεῖσαν, ἐτέρωσε δὲ ἀγομένην καὶ πιπρασκομένην, καὶ γραφικὴν καὶ θαυματοποιικὴν καὶ πολλὰ ἕτερα τῆς ψυχῆς, τὰ μὲν παραμυθίας, τὰ δὲ καὶ σπουδῆς χάριν ἀχθέντα καὶ πωλούμενα, τὸν ἄγοντα καὶ πωλοῦντα μηδὲν ἦττον τῆς τῶν σιτίων καὶ ποτῶν πράσεως ἔμπορον ὁρθῶς ἂν λεγόμενον παρασχεῖν. ΘΕΑΙ. ἀληθέστατα λέγεις.

Tt: What you say is very true.

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St: And shouldn't a man who buys up items of knowledge, and goes from city to city exchanging them for money, also be called by the same name?

ΞΕ. οὐκοῦν καὶ τὸν μαθήματα συνωνούμενον πόλιν τε ἐκ πόλεως νομίσματος ἀμείβοντα ταῦτὸν προσερεῖς ὄνομα; ΘΕΑΙ. σφόδρα γε. ΞΕ. τῆς δὴ ψυχεμπορικῆς ταύτης ἄρ' οὐ τὸ μὲν ἐπιδεικτικὴ δικαιοτάτα λέγοιτ' ἄν, τὸ δὲ γελοῖον μὲν οὐχ ἦττον τοῦ πρόσθεν, ὅμως δὲ μαθημάτων οὕσαν πρᾶσιν αὐτὴν ἀδελφῶ τινι τῆς πράξεως ὀνόματι προσειπεῖν ἀνάγκη; ΘΕΑΙ. πάνυ μὲν οὖν. ΞΕ. ταύτης τοίνυν τῆς μαθηματοπωλικῆς τὸ μὲν περὶ

ΤΤ: Quite emphatically.

ST: Now, one part of this trading for the benefit of the soul may properly be called exhibiting, and the other part is just as ridiculous, but nevertheless, since it is the actual sale of knowledge, it must be assigned a name relevant to this activity. Is this not so?

ΤΤ: Yes, certainly.

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ST: Therefore, the part of this knowledge-selling which relates to the subjects of the other skills should be called that, while the part which deals with the subject of excellence should be called something else.

τὰ τῶν ἄλλων τεχνῶν μαθήματα ἐτέρω, τὸ δὲ περὶ τὸ τῆς ἀρετῆς ἄλλω προσρητέον. ΘΕΑΙ. πῶς γὰρ οὐ; ΞΕ. τεchnοπωλικὸν μὴν τό γε περὶ τᾶλλα ἂν ἀρμόττοι· τὸ δὲ περὶ ταῦτα σὺ προθυμήθητι λέγειν ὄνομα. ΘΕΑΙ. καὶ τί τις ἂν ἄλλο ὄνομα εἰπὼν οὐκ ἂν πλημμελοίη πλὴν τὸ νῦν ζητούμενον αὐτὸ εἶναι τὸ σοφιστικὸν γένος; ΞΕ. οὐδὲν ἄλλο. ἴθι δὴ νῦν συναγάγωμεν αὐτὸ λέγοντες ὡς τὸ τῆς κτητικῆς, μεταβλητικῆς, ἀγοραστικῆς,

ΤΤ: Of course.

ST: Well, in the case of the other subjects, skill-selling would be an appropriate name. Now, you must try to give the name of the part which deals with excellence.

ΤΤ: Indeed, it is the very object of our search! What other name could you safely utter? It is the sophistic kind.

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ST: None other. Come on, we shall summarise this now by saying that sophistry has made its second appearance as part of the acquisitive skill, which exchanges by purchasing through trading, which is for the benefit of the soul, and traffics in words and knowledge concerning excellence.

ἐμπορικῆς, ψυχεμπορικῆς περὶ λόγους καὶ μαθήματα ἀρετῆς πωλητικὸν δεύτερον ἀνεφάνη σοφιστικῇ. ΘΕΑΙ. μάλα γε. ΞΕ. τρίτον δέ γ' οἶμαί σε, καὶν εἴ τις αὐτοῦ καθιδρυμένος ἐν πόλει, τὰ μὲν ὠνούμενος, τὰ δὲ καὶ τεκταινόμενος αὐτὸς μαθήματα περὶ τὰ αὐτὰ ταῦτα καὶ πωλῶν, ἐκ τούτου τὸ ζῆν προτάξατο, καλεῖν οὐδὲν ἄλλο πλὴν ὅπερ νυνδὴ. ΘΕΑΙ. τί δ' οὐ μέλλω;

TT: Exactly.

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ST: Actually, I think you have a third instance. For if one of them settled down in the city and proposed to make a living by buying some knowledge, and also fabricating his own knowledge on the same subjects, and making sales, presumably you would call him by the exact same name as you used just now.

ΞΕ. καὶ τὸ κτητικῆς ἄρα μεταβλητικόν, ἀγοραστικόν, καπηλικόν εἴτε αὐτοπωλικόν, ἀμφοτέρως, ὅτιπερ ἂν ἦ περὶ τὰ τοιαῦτα μαθηματοπωλικόν γένος, ἀεὶ σὺ προσερεῖς, ὡς φαίνει, σοφιστικόν. ΘΕΑΙ. ἀνάγκη τῷ γὰρ λόγῳ δεῖ συνακολουθεῖν. ΞΕ. ἔτι δὴ σκοπῶμεν εἴ τιτι τοιῷδε προσέοικεν ἄρα τὸ νῦν μεταδιωκόμενον γένος.

TT: I would have to.

ST: And so, the part of the acquisitive skill which involves exchange by purchasing, whether by retailing or self-selling, in either case whatever involves selling knowledge in this way, you would presumably refer to, always, as sophistic.

TT: I must, for I need to keep following the argument.

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ST: Then let's proceed to consider if the kind which we are pursuing actually bears a resemblance to something like this.

ΘΕΑΙ. ποίῳ δῆ; ΞΕ. τῆς κτητικῆς ἀγωνιστικῆ τι μέρος ἡμῖν ἦν. ΘΕΑΙ. ἦν γὰρ οὖν. ΞΕ. οὐκ ἀπὸ τρόπου τοίνυν ἐστὶ διαιεῖν αὐτὴν δίχα. ΘΕΑΙ. καθ' ὅποια λέγε. ΞΕ. τὸ μὲν ἀμιλλητικὸν αὐτῆς τιθέντας, τὸ δὲ μαχητικόν. ΘΕΑΙ. ἔστιν. ΞΕ. τῆς τοίνυν μαχητικῆς τῷ μὲν σώματι πρὸς σώματα γιγνομένῳ σχεδὸν εἰκὸς καὶ πρέπον ὄνομα λέγειν τι τοιοῦτον τιθεμένους οἷον βιαστικόν. ΘΕΑΙ. ναί. ΞΕ. τῷ δὲ λόγοις πρὸς λόγους τί τις, ὧ Θεαίτητε, ἄλλο

TT: Like what?

ST: We said that the acquisitive skill had a competitive part.

TT: Yes, we did.

ST: So, quite predictably, we divide it in two.

TT: Tell me how it is done.

ST: By designating one part as contentious and the other as combative.

TT: That's it.

ST: Is it quite reasonable and appropriate then, to assign a name such as 'violent' to the part of the combative which pitches bodies against one another?

TT: Yes.

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ST: And when it is one argument against another, what else can we call it, Theaetetus, except disputatious?

εἶπερ πλὴν ἀμφισβητητικόν; ΘΕΑΙ. οὐδέν. ΞΕ. τὸ δέ γε περὶ τὰς ἀμφισβητήσεις θετέον διττόν. ΘΕΑΙ. πῆ; ΞΕ. καθ' ὅσον μὲν γὰρ γίνεταί μήκεσσι τε πρὸς ἐναντία μήκη λόγων καὶ περὶ τὰ δίκαια καὶ ἄδικοι δημοσίᾳ, δικανικόν. ΘΕΑΙ. ναί. ΞΕ. τὸ δ' ἐν ἰδίοις αὖ καὶ κατακεκερματισμένον ἐρωτήσεσι πρὸς ἀποκρίσεις μὲν εἰθίσμεθα

καλεῖν ἄλλο πλὴν ἀντιλογικόν; ΘΕΑΙ. οὐδέν. ΞΕ. τοῦ δὲ ἀντιλογικοῦ τὸ μὲν ὅσον περὶ τὰ συμβόλαια

ΤΤ: Nothing.

ST: And we should propose that the part concerned with disputes is twofold.

ΤΤ: How so?

ST: Well, when it is conducted in public, with one long speech opposing another, and the concern is justice and injustice, then it is a judicial dispute.

ΤΤ: Yes.

ST: However, when it is done in private, and has been broken up into questions and answers, is there anything else we usually call it except contradiction?

ΤΤ: Nothing.

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ST: And the sort of contradiction which argues about contracts and proceeds at random and without skill, this should be designated as a particular form, since the discussion recognises it as separate. However, our predecessors never gave it a name, nor would it be worth our while to do so now.

ἀμφισβητεῖται μὲν, εἰκῇ δὲ καὶ ἀτέχνως περὶ αὐτὸ πράττεται, ταῦτα θετέον μὲν εἶδος, ἐπεὶ περ αὐτὸ διέγνωκεν ὡς ἕτερον ὃν ὁ λόγος, ἀτὰρ ἐπ' αὐτοῦ οὐθ' ὑπὸ τῶν ἔμπροσθεν ἔτυχεν οὔτε νῦν ὑφ' ἡμῶν τυχεῖν ἄξιον. ΘΕΑΙ. ἀληθῆ κατὰ σμικρὰ γὰρ λίαν καὶ παντοδαπὰ διήρηται. ΞΕ. τὸ δέ γε ἔντεχνον, καὶ περὶ δικαίων αὐτῶν καὶ ἀδίκων καὶ περὶ τῶν ἄλλων ὅλως ἀμφισβητοῦν, ἅρ' οὐκ ἐριστικὸν αὖ λέγειν εἰθίσι μεθεῖν; ΘΕΑΙ. πῶς γὰρ οὔ;

ΤΤ: True, for it has such minute and multifarious sub-divisions.

ST: But when it does involve a skill, and disputes comprehensively about justice itself and injustice and about other matters, don't we usually refer to it as argumentative?

TT: What else could we call it?

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ST: Now, there is a form of the argumentative which wastes money, and a form which makes money.

ΞΕ. τοῦ μὴν ἐριστικοῦ τὸ μὲν χρηματοφθορικόν, τὸ δὲ χρηματιστικὸν ὃν τυγχάνει. ΘΕΑΙ. παντάπασί γε. ΞΕ. τὴν ἐπωνυμίαν τοίνυν ἢν ἐκάτερον δεῖ καλεῖν αὐτῶν πειραθῶμεν εἰπεῖν. ΘΕΑΙ. οὐκοῦν χρή. ΞΕ. δοκῶ μὴν τό γε δι' ἡδονὴν τῆς περὶ ταῦτα διατριβῆς ἀμελὲς τῶν οἰκείων γιγνόμενον, περὶ δὲ τὴν λέξιν τοῖς πολλοῖς τῶν ἀκούοντων οὐ μεθ' ἡδονῆς ἀκουόμενον καλεῖσθαι κατὰ γνώμην τὴν ἐμὴν οὐχ ἕτερον ἀδολεσχηκοῦ. ΘΕΑΙ. λέγεται γὰρ οὖν οὕτω πως.

TT: There certainly is.

ST: Well, let's try to say what names should be given to each of them.

TT: Yes, we should do that.

ST: Now, I think that when the pleasure of engaging in these leads to neglect of one's own affairs, and the speech affords no pleasure to the many people who hear it, then in my opinion it is nothing other than talkativeness.

TT: Yes, that's the sort of thing that is said about it.

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ST: Then, the opposite of this makes money from private arguments, and it is now your turn to try to name it.

ΞΕ. τούτου τοίνυν τούναντίον, ἀπὸ τῶν ἰδιωτικῶν ἐρίδων χρηματιζόμενον, ἐν τῷ μέρει σὺ πειρῶ νῦν εἰπεῖν. ΘΕΑΙ. καὶ τί τις ἂν αὐτῶν εἰπὼν ἕτερον οὐκ ἐξαμάρτοι πλήν γε τὸν θαυμαστὸν πάλιν ἐκείνον ἥκειν αὐτῶν τέταρτον τὸν μεταδιωκόμενον ὑφ' ἡμῶν σοφιστήν;

Tt: Indeed, what else can one say without falling into error, except that a wondrous creature has turned up again for the fourth time, the object of our pursuit, the sophist.

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St: So, our argument has now revealed further that the sophist is none other than the money-making kind, as it seems, belonging to the argumentative, contradictory, disputatious, combative, competitive skill in acquisition.

ΞΕ. οὐδὲν ἄλλ' ἢ τὸ χρηματιστικὸν γένος, ὡς ἔοικεν, ἐριστικῆς ὄν τέχνης, τῆς ἀντιλογικῆς, τῆς ἀμφισβητητικῆς, τῆς μαχητικῆς, τῆς ἀγωνιστικῆς, τῆς κτητικῆς ἔστιν, ὡς ὁ λόγος αὖ μεμήνυκε νῦν, ὁ σοφιστής. ΘΕΑΙ. κομιδῇ μὲν οὖν. ΞΕ. ὁρᾷς οὖν ὡς ἀληθῆ λέγεται τὸ ποικίλον εἶναι τοῦτο τὸ θηρίον καὶ τὸ λεγόμενον οὐ τῇ ἑτέρᾳ ληπτόν; ΘΕΑΙ. οὐκοῦν ἀμφοῖν χρή.

Tt: Yes, certainly.

St: Now do you see how true it is that this is a creature of many aspects who will not be "captured with one hand", as the saying goes?

Tt: Then we must use both!

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St: Yes, we must. And we should do this to the best of our ability by pursuing a particular mark of his. Tell me, then, do we have certain names for common household tasks?

ΞΕ. χρή γὰρ οὖν, καὶ κατὰ δυνάμιν γε οὕτω ποιητέον, τοιόνδε τι μεταθέοντας ἵχνος αὐτοῦ. καί μοι λέγε τῶν οἰκετικῶν ὀνομάτων καλοῦμεν ἅττα πού; ΘΕΑΙ. καὶ πολλά· ἀτὰρ ποῖα δὴ τῶν πολλῶν πυνθάνη; ΞΕ. τὰ τοιάδε, οἷον διηθεῖν τε λέγομεν καὶ διαττᾶν καὶ βράττειν καὶ διακρίνειν. ΘΕΑΙ. τί μήν; ΞΕ. καὶ πρὸς γε τούτοις ἔτι ξαίνειν, κατάγειν, κερκίζειν, καὶ μυρία ἐν ταῖς τέχναις ἄλλα τοιαῦτα ἐνόντα ἐπιστάμεθα. ἦ γάρ;

Tt: Indeed there are many, but what sort of tasks are you asking about?

ST: We refer to tasks such as filtering, sifting, sieving and winnowing.

TT: Of course.

ST: And in addition to these, there is dressing wool, spinning, adjusting the web, and we know countless other such terms which are involved in the skills. Is this so?

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TT: What quality of them do you wish to demonstrate when you give these examples and ask about them all?

ΘΕΑΙ. τὸ ποῖον αὐτῶν πέρι βουλευθεῖς δηλῶσαι παραδείγματα προθεῖς ταῦτα κατὰ πάντων ἥρου; ΞΕ. διαιρετικά που τὰ λεχθέντα εἴρηται σύμπαντα. ΘΕΑΙ. ναί. ΞΕ. κατὰ τὸν ἐμὸν τοῖνον λόγον ὡς περὶ ταῦτα μίαν οὔσαν ἐν ἅπασι τέχνην ἐνὸς ὀνόματος ἀξιῶσομεν αὐτήν. ΘΕΑΙ. τίνα προσειπόντες; ΞΕ. διακριτικήν. ΘΕΑΙ. ἔστω. ΞΕ. σκόπει δὴ ταύτης αὖ δύο ἂν πη δυνώμεθα κατιδεῖν εἴδη. ΘΕΑΙ. ταχεῖαν ὡς ἐμοὶ σκέψιν ἐπιτάττεις.

ST: All of these terms somehow refer to discrimination.

TT: Yes.

ST: Then, according to my argument, we should assign one name to the single skill which is involved in them all.

TT: What shall we call it?

ST: Discrimination.

TT: So be it.

ST: Well, let's see if there is any way that we can proceed to discern two forms of this.

TT: You are asking me to think very quickly.

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ST: And yet in the distinctions we described, one separated worse from better, another like from like.

ΞΕ. καὶ μὴν ἔν γε ταῖς εἰρημέναις διακρίσεισι τὸ μὲν χειρὸν ἀπὸ βελτίονος ἀποχωρίζειν ἦν, τὸ δ' ὅμοιον ἀφ' ὁμοίου. ΘΕΑΙ. σχεδὸν οὕτω νῦν λεχθὲν φαίνεται. ΞΕ. τῆς μὲν τοίνυν ὄνομα οὐκ ἔχω λεγόμενον· τῆς δὲ καταλειπούσης μὲν τὸ βέλτιον διακρίσεως, τὸ δὲ χειρὸν ἀποβαλλούσης ἔχω. ΘΕΑΙ. λέγε τί. ΞΕ. πᾶσα ἡ τοιαύτη διάκρισις, ὡς ἐγὼ συννοῶ, λέγεται παρὰ πάντων καθαρμός τις. ΘΕΑΙ. λέγεται γὰρ οὖν.

ΤΤ: When you put it like that it appears so anyway.

ST: Now, I do not have a name for the second one, but I do have a name for discrimination, which leaves the better and discards the worse.

ΤΤ: Say it.

ST: All such discrimination is, as I understand it, referred to by everyone as purification.

ΤΤ: Yes, that's what it is called.

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ST: And couldn't everyone see that purification has two forms?

ΞΕ. οὐκοῦν τό γε καθαρτικὸν εἶδος αὖ διπλοῦν ὃν πᾶς ἂν ἴδοι; ΘΕΑΙ. ναί, κατὰ σχολήν γε ἴσως· οὐ μὴν ἔγωγε καθορῶ νῦν. ΞΕ. καὶ μὴν τά γε περὶ τὰ σώματα πολλὰ εἶδη καθάρσεων ἐνὶ περιλαβεῖν ὀνόματι προσήκει. ΘΕΑΙ. ποῖα καὶ τίνοι; ΞΕ. τά τε τῶν ζώων, ὅσα ἐντὸς σωμαμάτων ὑπὸ γυμναστικῆς

ΤΤ: Given time, perhaps. However it is not obvious to me at the moment.

ST: Well, it is surely appropriate to comprehend the many forms of bodily purification under a single name.

ΤΤ: What are they? And what is this name?

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ST: There are those which apply to living creatures and effect purification within the body, making proper divisions by means of gymnastics or medicine, and outside the body through the process of bathing. These we regard as commonplace. There are also those

affecting inanimate things which are cared for by wool-dressing and adorning in general, and are given numerous trivial and apparently ridiculous names.

ιατρικῆς τε ὀρθῶς διακρινόμενα καθαίρεται καὶ περὶ τὰκτός, εἰπεῖν μὲν φαῦλα, ὅσα βαλανευτική παρέχεται· καὶ τῶν ἀψύχων σωμάτων, ὧν γναφευτική καὶ σύμπασα κοσμητική τὴν ἐπιμέλειαν παρεχομένη κατὰ σμικρὰ πολλὰ καὶ γελοῖα δοκοῦντα ὀνόματα ἔσχεν. ΘΕΑΙ. μάλα γε. ΞΕ. παντάπασι μὲν οὔν, ὧ Θεαίτητε. ἀλλὰ γὰρ τῇ τῶν λόγων μεθόδῳ σπογγιστικῆς ἢ φαρμακοποιίας οὐδὲν ἦττον οὐδέ τι μᾶλλον τυγχάνει μέλον εἰ τὸ μὲν σμικρὰ, τὸ δὲ μεγάλα ἡμᾶς ὠφελεῖ καθαῖρον. τοῦ κτήσασθαι γὰρ

TT: Very much so.

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ST: They certainly are, Theaetetus. However, it is of no particular concern to the method based on arguments, whether purification by washing or medication benefits us much or little. For it endeavours to discern the inter-relation and non-relation of all the skills, with the aim of acquiring intelligence, and to that end it respects them all equally. Indeed, because of their similarity, this method does not believe that one is more ridiculous than another. And it does not regard a person as more important if he exemplifies his skill in hunting through generalship, rather than louse-catching, though it will probably regard him as more pretentious.

Now, let's go back to the question you asked. What name shall we assign to the collective capacities whose function is to purify living and lifeless bodies? And it will make no difference to this method whether the title sounds impressive or not, as long as it separates out whatever purifies the soul, and combines whatever purifies anything else. Indeed, if we do in fact understand its intention, this method has attempted to separate mental purification from the others.

ένεκα νοῦν πασῶν τεχνῶν τὸ συγγενές καὶ τὸ μὴ συγγενές κατανοεῖν πειρωμένη τιμᾷ πρὸς τοῦτο ἐξ ἴσου πάσας, καὶ θάτερα τῶν ἑτέρων κατὰ τὴν ὁμοιότητα οὐδὲν ἡγεῖται γελοιότερα, σεμνότερον δέ τι τὸν διὰ στρατηγικῆς ἢ φθειριστικῆς δηλοῦντα θηρευτικὴν οὐδὲν νενόμικεν, ἀλλ' ὥς τὸ πολὺ χαννότερον. καὶ δὴ καὶ νῦν, ὅπερ ἤρου, τί προσερούμεν ὄνομα συμπάσας δυνάμεις ὅσαι σῶμα εἴτε ἔμψυχον εἴτε ἄψυχον

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TT: But I do understand, and I agree that there are indeed two forms of purification, though one form is concerned with the soul, which is separate from the one concerned with the body.

εἰλήχασι καθαίρειν, οὐδὲν αὐτῇ διοίσει ποῖόν τι λεχθὲν εὐπρεπέστατον εἶναι δόξει· μόνον ἐχέτω χωρὶς τῶν τῆς ψυχῆς καθάρσεων πάντα συνδῆσαν ὅσα ἄλλο τι καθαίρει. τὸν γὰρ περὶ τὴν διάνοιαν καθαρμὸν ἀπὸ τῶν ἄλλων ἐπικεχείρηκεν ἀφορίσασθαι τὰ νῦν, εἴ γε ὅπερ βούλεται μανθάνομεν. ΘΕΑΙ. ἀλλὰ μεμάθηκα, καὶ συγχωρῶ δύο μὲν εἶδη καθάρσεως, ἔν δὲ τὸ περὶ τὴν ψυχὴν εἶδος εἶναι, τοῦ περὶ τὸ σῶμα χωρὶς ὄν. ΞΕ. πάντων κάλλιστα. καί μοι τὸ μετὰ τοῦτο ἐπάκουε

ST: Really excellent! Now, listen to the next aspect, and try in turn to cut that form in two.

TT: I shall try to make this division on whatever basis you suggest.

ST: Do we say that vice in the soul is something different from excellence?

TT: What else could we say?

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ST: And purification was the casting aside of whatever was in any way base, leaving the other part.

πειρώμενος αὖ τὸ λεχθὲν διχῇ τέμνειν. ΘΕΑΙ. καθ' ὅποι' ἂν ὑφηγῇ πειράσομαί σοι συντέμνειν. ΞΕ. πονηρίαν ἕτερον ἀρετῆς ἐν ψυχῇ λέγομέν τι; ΘΕΑΙ. πῶς γὰρ οὐ; ΞΕ. καὶ μὴν καθαρμός γ' ἦν τὸ λείπειν μὲν θάτερον, ἐκβάλλειν δὲ ὅσον ἂν ἦ πού τι φλαῦρον. ΘΕΑΙ. ἦν γὰρ οὖν. ΞΕ. καὶ ψυχῆς ἄρα, καθ' ὅσον ἂν εὐρίσκωμεν κακίας ἀφαίρεσίν τινα,

καθαρμὸν αὐτὸν λέγοντες ἐν μέλει φθελγζόμεθα. ΘΕΑΙ. καὶ μάλα γε. ΞΕ.
 δύο μὲν εἶδη κακίας περὶ ψυχὴν ῥητέον. ΘΕΑΙ. ποῖα;

ΤΤ: Yes, it was.

ST: So then, to whatever extent we discern any removal of badness from the soul, we may properly refer to that process as purification.

ΤΤ: Very much so.

ST: Now we should state that there are two forms of badness of the soul.

ΤΤ: What are they?

ST: One is like a disease in the body, while the other is like a deformity that arises.

ΤΤ: I do not understand.

ST: Perhaps you think that disease and discord are not the same?

ΤΤ: Again, I do not know how to respond to this.

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ST: Do you believe that discord is anything other than disagreement, born of some corruption, among naturally kindred elements?

ΞΕ. τὸ μὲν οἷον νόσον ἐν σώματι, τὸ δ' οἷον αἷσχος ἐγγιγνόμενον. ΘΕΑΙ.
 οὐκ ἔμαθον. ΞΕ. νόσον ἴσως καὶ στάσιν οὐ ταὐτὸν νενόμικας; ΘΕΑΙ. οὐδ'
 αὖ πρὸς τοῦτο ἔχω τί χρή με ἀποκρίνασθαι. ΞΕ. πότερον ἄλλο τι στάσιν
 ἡγούμενος ἢ τὴν τοῦ φύσει συγγενοῦς ἔκ τινος διαφθορᾶς διαφορὰν;
 ΘΕΑΙ. οὐδέν. ΞΕ. ἀλλ' αἷσχος ἄλλο τι πλὴν τὸ τῆς ἀμετρίας πανταχοῦ
 δυσειδὲς ἐνὸν γένος;

ΤΤ: Nothing other.

ST: And is deformity anything other than the absence of measure, a characteristic which is ugly in every case?

ΤΤ: Nothing else.

ST: What about this? In the souls of base people, don't we observe that opinions are opposed by desires, spirit by pleasures, and reason by aversions, and that all these are opposed to one another?

TT: Very much so.

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ST: However, all of these are necessarily kindred.

ΘΕΑΙ. οὐδαμῶς ἄλλο. ΞΕ. τί δέ; ἐν ψυχῇ δόξας ἐπιθυμίαις καὶ θυμὸν ἡδοναῖς καὶ λόγον λύπαις καὶ πάντα ἀλλήλοις ταῦτα τῶν φλαύρως ἐχόντων οὐκ ἡσθήμεθα διαφερόμενα; ΘΕΑΙ. καὶ σφόδρα γε. ΞΕ. συγγενῇ γε μὴν ἐξ ἀνάγκης σύμπαντα γέγονεν. ΘΕΑΙ. πῶς γὰρ οὐ; ΞΕ. στάσιν ἄρα καὶ νόσον τῆς ψυχῆς πονηρίαν λέγοντες ὀρθῶς ἐροῦμεν. ΘΕΑΙ. ὀρθότατα μὲν οὖν.

TT: Of course.

ST: So, we shall be right in referring to vice as discord and disease of the soul.

TT: Absolutely right.

228c

ST: What about this? If things that partake of motion and have been assigned some target wander off that target with every attempt, and miss the mark, would we say that this happens to them through proper measure in relation to one another, or alternatively through lack of measure?

ΞΕ. τί δ'; ὅς' ἂν κινήσεως μετασχόντα καὶ σκοπὸν τινα θέμενα πειρώμενα τούτου τυγχάνειν καθ' ἐκάστην ὁρμὴν παράφορα αὐτοῦ γίγνηται καὶ ἀποτυγχάνη, πότερον αὐτὰ φήσομεν ὑπὸ συμμετρίας τῆς πρὸς ἄλληλα ἢ τούναντίον ὑπὸ ἀμετρίας αὐτὰ πάσχειν; ΘΕΑΙ. δηλὸν ὡς ὑπὸ ἀμετρίας. ΞΕ. ἀλλὰ μὴν ψυχὴν γε ἴσμεν ἄκουσαν πᾶσαν πᾶν ἀγνοοῦσαν. ΘΕΑΙ. σφόδρα γε. ΞΕ. τό γε μὴν ἀγνοεῖν ἐστὶν ἐπ' ἀλήθειαν ὀρμωμένης

TT: Obviously through lack of measure.

ST: Now, we do know that any soul which is ignorant of anything is ignorant unwillingly.

TT: Very much so.

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ST: And, indeed, ignorance is nothing but the disordered thinking of a soul, intent upon truth, whose understanding goes astray.

ψυχῆς, παραφόρου συνέσεως γιγνομένης, οὐδὲν ἄλλο πλὴν παραφροσύνη. ΘΕΑΙ. πάνυ μὲν οὖν. ΞΕ. ψυχὴν ἄρα ἀνόητον αἰσχροὺς καὶ ἄμετρον θετέον. ΘΕΑΙ. ἔοικεν. ΞΕ. ἔστι δὴ δύο ταῦτα, ὡς φαίνεται, κακῶν ἐν αὐτῇ γένη, τὸ μὲν πονηρία καλούμενον ὑπὸ τῶν πολλῶν, νόσος αὐτῆς σαφέστατα ὄν. ΘΕΑΙ. ναί. ΞΕ. τὸ δέ γε ἄγνοιαν μὲν καλοῦσι, κακίαν δὲ αὐτὸ ἐν ψυχῇ μόνον γιγνόμενον οὐκ ἐθέλουσιν ὁμολογεῖν.

TT: Yes, certainly.

ST: So we must propose that an ignorant soul is deformed and lacking in measure.

TT: So it seems.

ST: Now, there are, it appears, two kinds of badness in the soul. One, which most people call vice, is clearly a disease of the soul.

TT: Yes.

ST: The other they call ignorance, but they are unwilling to agree that it is a badness arising only in the soul.

228e

TT: It certainly should be conceded, though I doubted it now when you said that there are two kinds of badness in the soul, and that cowardice, lack of restraint, and injustice should all be regarded as a disease within us, while the many varieties of ignorance should be designated as deformity.

ΘΕΑΙ. κομιδῇ συγχωρητέον, ὃ νυνδὲ λέξαντος ἡμφεγνόησά σου, τὸ δύο εἶναι γένη κακίας ἐν ψυχῇ, καὶ δειλίαν μὲν καὶ ἀκολασίαν καὶ ἀδικίαν σύμπαντα ἡγητέον νόσον ἐν ἡμῖν, τὸ δὲ τῆς πολλῆς καὶ παντοδαπῆς

ἀγνοίας πάθος αἴσχος θετέον. ΞΕ. οὐκοῦν ἔν γε σώματι περὶ δύο παθήματα τούτω δύο τέχνα τινὲ ἐγενέσθην; ΘΕΑΙ. τίνε τούτω;

ST: Now, in the case of the body, aren't there two skills relating to the two conditions?

TT: What are the two?

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ST: Gymnastic for deformity and medicine for disease.

ΞΕ. περὶ μὲν αἴσχος γυμναστική, περὶ δὲ νόσον ἰατρική. ΘΕΑΙ. φαίνεσθον. ΞΕ. οὐκοῦν καὶ περὶ μὲν ὕβριν καὶ ἀδικίαν καὶ δειλίαν ἢ κολαστική πέφυκε τεχνῶν μάλιστα δὴ πασῶν προσήκουσα Δίκη. ΘΕΑΙ. τὸ γοῦν εἰκός, ὥς εἶπεῖν κατὰ τὴν ἀνθρωπίνην δόξαν. ΞΕ. τί δέ; περὶ σύμπασαν ἄγνοιαν μὲν ἄλλην τινὰ ἢ διδασκαλικὴν ὀρθότερον εἴποι τις ἄν; ΘΕΑΙ. οὐδεμίαν.

TT: Clearly.

ST: And when it comes to violence, injustice and cowardice, surely punishment is the skill which is naturally closer to justice than any other?

TT: Quite likely. At least that's what people think.

ST: What about the other case? Could anyone prescribe anything more appropriate than teaching to remedy ignorance in its entirety?

TT: Not at all.

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ST: Come now. Should we say that there is only one kind of teaching, or are there more, two of which are the most significant? Consider this.

ΞΕ. φέρε δὴ διδασκαλικῆς δὲ ἄρα ἔν μόνον γένος φατέον εἶναι ἢ πλείω, δύο δὲ τινε αὐτῆς εἶναι μεγίστω; σκόπει. ΘΕΑΙ. σκοπῶ. ΞΕ. καί μοι δοκοῦμεν τῇδε ἄν πη τάχιστα εὐρεῖν. ΘΕΑΙ. πῃ; ΞΕ. τὴν ἄγνοιαν ἰδόντες εἴ πη κατὰ μέσον αὐτῆς τομὴν ἔχει τινά. διπλῇ γὰρ αὕτη γιγνομένη δῆλον ὅτι καὶ τὴν διδασκαλικὴν δύο ἀναγκάζει μόρια ἔχειν, ἔν ἐφ' ἐνὶ

γένει τῶν αὐτῆς ἐκατέρω. ΘΕΑΙ. τί οὖν; καταφανές πῇ σοι τὸ νῦν ζητούμενον;

ΤΤ: I am considering it.

ST: Well, I think the quickest way for us to find out would be as follows.

ΤΤ: How?

ST: By seeing whether ignorance has somehow got a division in the middle of it. For if it is twofold, it is obvious that teaching must also have two parts, one corresponding to each kind of ignorance.

ΤΤ: Yes, but is the division we are now looking for becoming evident to you?

229c

ST: Well, I think I can discern a distinct form of ignorance which is extensive and problematic, and as weighty as all the other parts put together.

ΞΕ. ἀγνοίας γοῦν μέγα τί μοι δοκῶ καὶ χαλεπὸν ἀφωρισμένον ὄρᾶν εἶδος, πᾶσι τοῖς ἄλλοις αὐτῆς ἀντίσταθμον μέρεσιν. ΘΕΑΙ. ποῖον δῆ; ΞΕ. τὸ μὴ κατειδότα τι δοκεῖν εἰδέναι· δι' οὗ κινδυνεύει πάντα ὅσα διανοίᾳ σφαλλόμεθα γίγνεσθαι πᾶσιν. ΘΕΑΙ. ἀληθῆ. ΞΕ. καὶ δὴ καὶ τούτῳ γε οἶμαι μόνῳ τῆς ἀγνοίας ἀμαθίαν τοῦνομα προσρηθῆναι. ΘΕΑΙ. πάνυ γε. ΞΕ. τί δὲ δὴ τῷ τῆς διδασκαλικῆς ἄρα μέρει τῷ τοῦτο ἀπαλλάττοντι λεκτέον;

ΤΤ: What is it?

ST: Being of the opinion that you know something when you do not know. It is likely that this is how all mistaken thinking arises in everyone.

ΤΤ: True.

ST: And, indeed, it is only this form of ignorance which is given the name of foolishness.

ΤΤ: Yes, certainly.

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ST: Now then, what should we call the part of teaching which does away with this foolishness?

ΘΕΑΙ. οἶμαι μὲν οὖν, ὦ ξένε, τὸ μὲν ἄλλο δημιουργικὰς διδασκαλίας, τοῦτο δὲ ἐνθάδε γε παιδείαν δι' ἡμῶν κεκληῖσθαι. ΞΕ. καὶ γὰρ σχεδόν, ὦ Θεαίτητε, ἐν πᾶσιν Ἑλλήσιν. ἀλλὰ γὰρ ἡμῖν ἔτι καὶ τοῦτο σκεπτέον, ἄρ' ἄτομον ἤδη ἐστὶ πᾶν ἢ τινα ἔχον διαίρεσιν ἀξίαν ἐπωνυμίας. ΘΕΑΙ. οὐκοῦν χρή σκοπεῖν. ΞΕ. δοκεῖ τοίνυν μοι καὶ τοῦτο ἔτι πῃ σχίζεσθαι. ΘΕΑΙ. κατὰ τί;

TT: Well, stranger, I believe that the other part of it is called technical instruction, while this part, among ourselves in the city at any rate, is called education.

ST: Almost all the Greeks do the same, Theaetetus. However, we shall still need to consider whether education is completely indivisible, or has some subdivision worth naming.

TT: Yes, we should consider that.

ST: It seems to me that there is a way of dividing this further.

TT: On what basis?

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ST: There seems to be a part of teaching in discourse, which is a rougher method, and another one, which is smoother.

ΞΕ. τῆς ἐν τοῖς λόγοις διδασκαλικῆς ἢ μὲν τραχυτέρα τις ἔοικεν ὁδὸς εἶναι, τὸ δ' ἕτερον αὐτῆς μόνον λειότερον. ΘΕΑΙ. τὸ ποῖον δὴ τούτων ἑκάτερον λέγομεν; ΞΕ. τὸ μὲν ἀρχαιοπρεπές τι πάτριον, ὃ πρὸς τοὺς υἱεῖς μάλιστ' ἐχρῶντό τε καὶ ἔτι πολλοὶ χρῶνται τὰ νῦν, ὅταν

TT: Can we say what sort of methods they are?

ST: Well, there is the traditional method which fathers use towards their sons, a method still used by many today whereby they either get angry with them whenever they fall into error, or else resort to more

gentle exhortation. This may in general most correctly be called didactic.

TT: So it is.

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ST: However some people, having considered this for themselves, seem to conclude that all ignorance is involuntary, that no one who thinks that he is wise will ever wish to learn about matters of which he thinks himself knowledgeable, and that after a lot of trouble, the didactic form of education accomplishes little.

αὐτοῖς ἐξαμαρτάνωσί τι, τὰ μὲν χαλεπαίνοντες, τὰ δὲ μαλθακωτέως παραμυθούμενοι· τὸ δ' οὖν σύμπαν αὐτὸ ὀρθότατα εἴποι τις ἂν νοουθητικήν. ΘΕΑΙ. ἔστιν οὕτως. ΞΕ. τὸ δέ γε, εἴξασί τινες αὖ λόγον ἑαυτοῖς δόντες ἡγήσασθαι πᾶσαν ἀκούσιον ἀμαθίαν εἶναι, καὶ μαθεῖν οὐδέν ποτ' ἂν ἐθέλιν τὸν οἰόμενον εἶναι σοφὸν τούτων ὧν οἶοιτο περί δεινὸς εἶναι, μετὰ δὲ πολλοῦ πόνου τὸ νοουθητικὸν εἶδος τῆς παιδείας σμικρὸν ἀνύτειν. ΘΕΑΙ. ὀρθῶς γε νομίζοντες.

TT: A correct conclusion.

ST: Accordingly, they set about the eradication of this opinion in another way.

TT: What way?

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ST: They question him on matters about which he believes he is talking sense, when he is talking nonsense. They readily discover that his opinions are quite confused. So, by arguments, they gather the opinions together and place them side by side, and then they show him that these contradict themselves, about the same issues, in the same ways, and on the same basis. And those who recognise this become angry with themselves and gentle towards others, and they are liberated by this method from their exalted and fixed views about themselves. Their liberation brings the greatest delight to those who hear it, and constancy to those who experience it.

Indeed, dear child, the physicians of the body recognise that the body derives no benefit from any food it is offered until the internal impediments are first removed. So too these purifiers of the soul understand that the soul will obtain no advantage from any learning which it is offered until someone resorts to refutation, and brings the man who is refuted to a condition of humility where the impediments to learning have been removed, he is rendered pure, and he thinks that he knows only what he does actually know, and nothing more.

ΞΕ. τῷ τοι ταύτης τῆς δόξης ἐπὶ ἐκβολὴν ἄλλω τρόπῳ στέλλονται. ΘΕΑΙ. τίνι δῆ; ΞΕ. διερωτῶσιν ὧν ἂν οἴηταί τις τι πέρι λέγειν λέγων μηδέν· εἴθ' ἄτε πλανωμένων τὰς δόξας ῥαδίως ἐξετάζουσι, καὶ συνάγοντες δὴ τοῖς λόγοις εἰς ταῦτόν τιθέασι παρ' ἀλλήλας, τιθέντες δὲ ἐπιδεικνύουσιν αὐτὰς αὐταῖς ἅμα περὶ τῶν αὐτῶν πρὸς τὰ αὐτὰ κατὰ ταῦτ' ἐναντίας. οἱ δ' ὁρῶντες ἑαυτοῖς μὲν χαλεπαίνουσι, πρὸς δὲ τοὺς ἄλλους ἡμεροῦνται, καὶ τοῦτ' ἔτι τῷ τρόπῳ τῶν περὶ αὐτοὺς μεγάλων καὶ σκληρῶν δοξῶν ἀπαλλάττονται πασῶν τε ἀπαλλαγῶν ἀκούειν τε ἡδίστην καὶ τῷ πάσχοντι βεβαιότατα γιγνομένην. νομίζοντες γάρ, ὧ παῖ φίλε, οἱ καθαίροντες αὐτούς, ὥσπερ οἱ περὶ τὰ σώματα ἱατροὶ νενομίσασιν μὴ πρότερον ἂν τῆς προσφερομένης τροφῆς ἀπολαύειν δύνασθαι σῶμα, πρὶν ἂν τὰ ἐμποδίζοντα ἐντός τις ἐκβάλῃ, ταῦτόν καὶ περὶ ψυχῆς διανοήθησαν ἐκεῖνοι, μὴ πρότερον αὐτὴν ἔξῃ τῶν προσφερομένων μαθημάτων

230d

TT: And this is surely the best and most sound-minded condition to be in.

ὄνησιν, πρὶν ἂν ἐλέγχων τις τὸν ἐλεγχόμενον εἰς αἰσχύνην καταστήσας, τὰς τοῖς μαθήμασιν ἐμποδίους δόξας ἐξελών, καθαρὸν ἀποφῆνῃ καὶ ταῦτα ἡγούμενον ἅπερ οἶδεν εἰδέναι μόνον, πλείω δὲ μή. ΘΕΑΙ. βελτίστη γοῦν καὶ σωφρονεστάτη τῶν ἔξεων αὕτη. ΞΕ. διὰ ταῦτα δὴ πάντα ἡμῖν, ὦ Θεαίτητε, καὶ τὸν ἔλεγχον λεκτέον ὥς ἄρα μεγίστη

καὶ κυριωτάτη τῶν καθάρσεων ἐστὶ, καὶ τὸν ἀνέλεγκτον αὐτὸν νομιστέον, ἂν καὶ τυγχάνῃ

230e

ST: Now, on account of all this, Theaetetus, we must also state that refutation is the greatest and most powerful of purifications, and we must realise that the unrefuted man, even if he happens to be the Great King,⁷ is utterly unpurified, and is both uneducated and deformed, where a man who intends to be truly happy should be most pure and good.

βασιλεὺς ὁ μέγας ὢν, τὰ μέγιστα ἀκάθαρτον ὄντα, ἀπαίδευτόν τε καὶ αἰσχροὺς γεγονέναι ταῦτα ἃ καθαρώτατον καὶ κάλλιστον ἔπρεπε τὸν ὄντως ἐσόμενον εὐδαίμονα εἶναι. ΘΕΑΙ. παντάπασιν μὲν οὖν. ΞΕ. τί δέ; τοὺς ταύτη χρωμένους τῇ τέχνῃ τίνας

TT: Entirely so.

231a

ST: Well then, what shall we call those who employ this skill? Indeed, I am afraid to say sophists.

φήσομεν; ἐγὼ μὲν γὰρ φοβοῦμαι σοφιστὰς φάναι. ΘΕΑΙ. τί δὴ; ΞΕ. μὴ μεῖζον αὐτοῖς προσάπτωμεν γέρας. ΘΕΑΙ. ἀλλὰ μὴν προσέοικέ γε τοιούτῳ τινὶ τὰ νῦν εἰρημένα. ΞΕ. καὶ γὰρ κυνὶ λύκος, ἀγριώτατον ἡμερωτάτῳ. τὸν δὲ ἀσφαλῇ δεῖ πάντων μάλιστα περὶ τὰς ὁμοιότητος ἀεὶ ποιεῖσθαι τὴν φυλακὴν· ὀλισθηρότατον γὰρ τὸ γένος. ὅμως δὲ ἔστω· οὐ γὰρ περὶ μικρῶν ὄρων τὴν ἀμφισβήτησιν οἴομαι

TT: Why is that?

ST: In case I assign them too much honour.

TT: But surely the people we are discussing bear some resemblance to sophists.

ST: Yes, and so does a wolf to a dog, the fiercest animal to the tame. And a cautious man must always be on his guard, especially when dealing with resemblances, for they are a most slippery class. Anyway,

let them be called sophists, for I don't think that disputes over minor distinctions will arise once people are sufficiently vigilant.

231b

TT: No, it is quite unlikely.

γενήσεσθαι τότε όπόταν ίκανώς φυλάττωσιν. ΘΕΑΙ. οὐκουν τό γε εικός. ΞΕ. έστω δή διακριτικῆς τέχνης καθαρτική, καθαρτικῆς δέ τὸ περὶ ψυχὴν μέρος άφωρίσθω, τούτου δέ διδασκαλική, διδασκαλικῆς δέ παιδευτική τῆς δέ παιδευτικῆς ό περὶ τὴν μάταιον δοξοσοφίαν γιγνόμενος έλεγχος έν τῷ νῦν λόγω παραφανέντι μηδέν άλλ' ήμῖν εἶναι λεγέσθω πλήν ή γένει γενναία σοφιστική. ΘΕΑΙ. λεγέσθω μέν· άπορῶ δέ έγωγε ήδη διὰ τὸ πολλὰ

ST: So let there be a purificatory part of the skill of discrimination, and from purification let us separate out the part which deals with the soul. Let teaching be part of this, and let education be part of teaching, and let us say that the part of education which brings about refutation of a vain presumption to wisdom turns out in our present argument to be nothing other than the noble kind of sophistry.

231c

TT: Well, let's say so. But on account of the multiplicity of manifestations, I am now perplexed about what exactly I should say that the sophist really is with any confidence that I am speaking the truth.

πεφάνθαι, τί χρή ποτε ώς άληθῆ λέγοντα καὶ δισχυριζόμενον εἰπεῖν όντως εἶναι τὸν σοφιστήν. ΞΕ. εἰκότως γε σὺ άπορῶν. αλλά τοι κάκεῖνον ήγεῖσθαι χρή νῦν ήδη σφόδρα άπορεῖν όπη ποτε έτι διαδύσεται τὸν λόγον· όρθή γάρ ή παροιμία, τὸ τὰς άπάσας μὴ ράδιον εἶναι διαφεύγειν. νῦν οὖν καὶ μάλιστα έπιθετέον αὐτῷ. ΘΕΑΙ. καλῶς λέγεις. ΞΕ. πρῶτον δή στάντες οἶον έξαναπνεύσωμεν, καὶ πρὸς

ST: Your perplexity is to be expected. But you must also appreciate that the man himself is intensely perplexed by now as to how he will continue to evade this argument. Indeed, the proverb is right in saying

that "it is not easy to escape all the grips of the wrestler". So now is the very best moment, and we must set upon him.

Tt: Well said.

231d

St: Well, now that we have stopped, let's catch our breath first, and while we are resting let's count up for ourselves how many times the sophist has appeared to us. Now, I think he was first discovered as the paid hunter of the young and wealthy.

ἡμᾶς αὐτοὺς διαλογισώμεθα ἅμα ἀναπαυόμενοι, φέρε, ὅποσα ἡμῖν ὁ σοφιστὴς πέφανται. δοκῶ μὲν γάρ, τὸ πρῶτον ἡύρέθη νέων καὶ πλουσίων ἔμμισθος θηρευτῆς. ΘΕΑΙ. ναί. ΞΕ. τὸ δέ γε δεύτερον ἔμπορός τις περὶ τὰ τῆς ψυχῆς μαθήματα. ΘΕΑΙ. πάνυ γε. ΞΕ. τρίτον δὲ ἄρα οὐ περὶ αὐτὰ ταῦτα κάπηλος ἀνεφάνη; ΘΕΑΙ. ναί, καὶ τέταρτόν γε αὐτοπώλης περὶ τὰ μαθήματα ἡμῖν ἦν. ΞΕ. ὁρθῶς ἐμνημόνευσας. πέμπτον δ' ἐγὼ πειράσομαι

Tt: Yes.

St: And secondly as a trader in things which are learned by the soul.

Tt: Yes, certainly.

St: And didn't he appear for the third time as a retailer of the same things?

Tt: Yes, and for the fourth time selling his own knowledge himself.

231e

St: Your recollection is correct. Now I shall try to remember the fifth. Indeed, he was a contestant in verbal competitiveness, specialising in the argumentative skill.

μνημονεύειν· τῆς γὰρ ἀγωνιστικῆς περὶ λόγους ἦν τις ἀθλητής, τὴν ἐριστικὴν τέχνην ἀφωρισμένος. ΘΕΑΙ. ἦν γὰρ οὖν. ΞΕ. τό γε μὴν ἔκτον ἀμφισβητήσιμον μὲν, ὅμως δ' ἔθεμεν αὐτῷ συγχωρήσαντες δοξῶν ἐμποδίων μαθήμασιν περὶ ψυχὴν καθαρτὴν αὐτὸν εἶναι. ΘΕΑΙ. παντάπασιν μὲν οὖν.

Tt: He was, indeed.

St: Well, although the sixth was actually disputed, we agreed nevertheless to propose that he is a purifier of souls from opinions that are an impediment to learning.

Tt: Yes, entirely so.

232a

St: Well, do you appreciate that when someone appears knowledgeable about many subjects but is called by the name of a single skill, this appearance is not sound? Rather, it is obvious that whoever experiences this in relation to any skill is unable to discern clearly that aspect of the skill that all these understandings look to. Consequently he assigns multiple names, rather than one, to whoever possesses them.

ΞΕ. ἄρ' οὖν ἐννοεῖς, ὅταν ἐπιστήμων τις πολλῶν φαίνεται, μιᾶς δὲ τέχνης ὀνόματι προσαγορεύεται, τὸ φάντασμα τοῦτο ὡς οὐκ ἔσθ' ὑγιές, ἀλλὰ δηλὸν ὡς ὁ πάσχων αὐτὸ πρὸς τινα τέχνην οὐ δύναται κατιδεῖν ἐκεῖνο αὐτῆς εἰς ὃ πάντα τὰ μαθήματα ταῦτα βλέπει, διὸ καὶ πολλοῖς ὀνόμασιν ἀνθ' ἑνὸς τὸν ἔχοντα αὐτὰ προσαγορεύει; ΘΕΑΙ. κινδυνεύει τοῦτο ταύτῃ πη μάλιστα πεφυκέναι.

Tt: It's likely that this happens in exactly the way you describe.

232b

St: Let's ensure that it does not happen to us in our search, due to laziness. Rather, let us first take one of the statements about the sophist again, as there was one which did seem particularly revealing to me.

ΞΕ. μὴ τοίνυν ἡμεῖς γε αὐτὸ ἐν τῇ ζητήσει δι' ἀργίαν πάσχωμεν, ἀλλ' ἀναλάβωμεν ἓν πρῶτον τῶν περὶ τὸν σοφιστὴν εἰρημένων. ἓν γάρ τί μοι μάλιστα κατεφάνη αὐτὸν μηνῶν. ΘΕΑΙ. τὸ ποῖον; ΞΕ. ἀντιλογικὸν αὐτὸν ἔφαμεν εἶναι που. ΘΕΑΙ. ναί. ΞΕ. τί δ'; οὐ καὶ τῶν ἄλλων αὐτοῦ τούτου διδάσκαλον γίγνεσθαι; ΘΕΑΙ. τί μήν; ΞΕ. σκοπῶμεν δὴ, περὶ τίνος ἄρα καὶ φασιν οἱ τοιοῦτοι ποιεῖν ἀντιλογικούς. ἡ δὲ σκέψις ἡμῖν ἐξ ἀρχῆς ἔστω τῇδε

Tt: Which one?

St: We said that he was a contradictor.

Tt: Yes.

St: What else? Isn't he also a teacher of others, in this particular skill?

Tt: Yes, indeed.

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St: Let's consider this. In what realm do these men claim that they can turn people into contradictors? Our enquiry should begin as follows. Do they render people competent in contradicting about the divine realm which is unmanifest to the multitude?

πη. φέρε, περὶ τῶν θείων, ὅς' ἀφανῆ τοῖς πολλοῖς, ἄρ' ἱκανοὺς ποιοῦσι τοῦτο δρᾶν; ΘΕΑΙ. λέγεται γοῦν δὴ περὶ αὐτῶν ταῦτα. ΞΕ. τί δ' ὅσα φανερά γῆς τε καὶ οὐρανοῦ καὶ τῶν περὶ τὰ τοιαῦτα; ΘΕΑΙ. τί γάρ; ΞΕ. ἀλλὰ μὴν ἔν γε ταῖς ἰδίαις συνουσίαις, ὅποταν γενέσεώς τε καὶ οὐσίας πέρι κατὰ πάντων λέγηταί τι, σύνισμεν ὥς αὐτοῖ τε ἀντειπεῖν δεινοὶ τοὺς τε ἄλλους ὅτι ποιοῦσιν ἅπερ αὐτοὶ δυνατούς; ΘΕΑΙ. παντάπασί γε.

Tt: Well that is what people say, anyway.

St: And what about the manifest realm of earth and sky, and the subjects associated with them?

Tt: These too.

St: In fact, whenever something is said in private gatherings concerning the entire field of becoming or being, we are aware, aren't we, that these men are brilliant at arguing against it, and they enable others to do the same.

Tt: Entirely so.

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St: And again, don't they also promise to enable people to dispute about laws, and affairs of state in general?

ΞΕ. τί δ' αὖ περὶ νόμων καὶ συμπάντων τῶν πολιτικῶν, ἅρ' οὐχ ὑπισχνούνται ποιεῖν ἀμφισβητητικούς; ΘΕΑΙ. οὐδεὶς γὰρ ἂν αὐτοῖς ὡς ἔπος εἰπεῖν διελέγετο μὴ τοῦτο ὑπισχνουμένοις. ΞΕ. τὰ γε μὴν περὶ πασῶν τε καὶ κατὰ μίαν ἐκάστην τέχνην, ἃ δεῖ πρὸς ἕκαστον αὐτὸν τὸν δημιουργὸν ἀντειπεῖν, δεδημοσιωμένα που καταβέβληται γεγραμμένα τῷ βουλομένῳ μαθεῖν. ΘΕΑΙ. τὰ Πρωταγόρειά μοι φαίνη περί τε πάλης καὶ

TT: Indeed, no one, or hardly anyone, would converse with them unless they made that promise.

ST: Indeed, for each and every skill, what is needed in each case to argue against the practitioner himself has presumably been composed, written down, and published for anyone who wishes to learn.

232e

TT: You seem to me to be referring to the writings of Protagoras,⁸ on wrestling and the other subjects.

τῶν ἄλλων τεχνῶν εἰρηκέναι. ΞΕ. καὶ πολλῶν γε, ὦ μακάριε, ἐτέρων. ἀτὰρ δὴ τὸ τῆς ἀντιλογικῆς τέχνης ἅρ' οὐκ ἐν κεφαλαίῳ περὶ πάντων πρὸς ἀμφισβήτησιν ἰκανή τις δύναμις ἔοικ' εἶναι; ΘΕΑΙ. φαίνεται γοῦν δὴ σχεδὸν οὐδὲν ὑπολιπεῖν. ΞΕ. σὺ δὴ πρὸς θεῶν, ὦ παῖ, δυνατὸν ἡγῇ τοῦτο; τάχα γὰρ ἂν ὑμεῖς μὲν ὀξύτερον οἱ νέοι πρὸς αὐτὸ βλέποιτε, ἡμεῖς δὲ ἀμβλύτερον.

ST: And of many others besides, blessed man. However, doesn't this skill in contradiction seem, in short, to be a power which is up to the task of disputation on all subjects.

TT: Well, there is nothing it seems to leave out.

233a

ST: Well, by the gods, child, do you think this is possible? For perhaps you young people may view this matter with more insight, while we older men are more dim.

ΘΕΑΙ. τὸ ποῖον, καὶ πρὸς τί μάλιστα λέγεις; οὐ γάρ που κατανοῶ τὸ νῦν ἐρωτώμενον. ΞΕ. εἰ πάντα ἐπίστασθαί τινα ἀνθρώπων ἐστὶ δυνατόν.

ΘΕΑΙ. μακάριον μεντᾶν ἡμῶν, ὦ ξένε, ἦν τὸ γένος. ΞΕ. πῶς οὖν ἂν ποτέ τις πρὸς γε τὸν ἐπιστάμενον αὐτὸς ἀνεπιστήμων ὦν δύναιτ' ἂν ὑγιές τι λέγων ἀντειπεῖν; ΘΕΑΙ. οὐδαμῶς. ΞΕ. τί ποτ' οὖν ἂν εἴη τὸ τῆς σοφιστικῆς δυνάμεως θαῦμα; ΘΕΑΙ. τοῦ δὴ περί;

TT: What matter? What exactly are you referring to? I do not quite understand what you are asking me now.

ST: Whether it is possible for a human being to know all things.

TT: In that case, stranger, the human race would indeed be blessed.

ST: Then how could someone who is not knowledgeable himself ever say anything worthwhile when he contradicts a person who knows?

TT: He simply cannot do so.

233b

ST: Well, what on earth can this wondrous sophistic power be?

ΞΕ. καθ' ὅντινα τρόπον ποτὲ δυνατοὶ τοῖς νέοις δόξαν παρασκευάζειν ὥς εἰσὶ πάντα πάντων αὐτοὶ σοφώτατοι. δῆλον γὰρ ὥς εἰ μήτε ἀντέλεγον ὀρθῶς μήτε ἐκείνοις ἐφαίνοντο, φαινόμενοί τε εἰ μηδὲν αὖ μᾶλλον ἐδόκουν διὰ τὴν ἀμφισβήτησιν εἶναι φρόνιμοι, τὸ σὸν δὴ τοῦτο, σχολῇ ποτ' ἂν αὐτοῖς τις χρήματα διδοὺς ἤθελεν ἂν τούτων αὐτῶν μαθητῆς γίγνεσθαι. ΘΕΑΙ. σχολῇ μεντᾶν. ΞΕ. νῦν δέ γ' ἐθέλουσιν; ΘΕΑΙ. καὶ μάλα.

TT: Wondrous in what way?

ST: In the way that they are somehow able to arm young people with the belief that they are wiser than everyone about everything. For it is obvious that if the sophists neither contradicted properly nor gave that appearance to the young, or again if they did give that appearance but were not regarded as more learned due to this disputatiousness, then according to you hardly anyone would want to pay money to become their pupils in these subjects.

233c

TT: Hardly anyone indeed.

ΞΕ. δοκοῦσι γὰρ οἶμαι πρὸς ταῦτα ἐπιστημόνως ἔχειν αὐτοὶ πρὸς ἅπερ ἀντιλέγουσιν. ΘΕΑΙ. πῶς γὰρ οὐ; ΞΕ. δρῶσι δέ γε τοῦτο πρὸς ἅπαντα, φαμέν; ΘΕΑΙ. ναί. ΞΕ. πάντα ἄρα σοφοὶ τοῖς μαθηταῖς φαίνονται. ΘΕΑΙ. τί μήν; ΞΕ. οὐκ ὄντες γε ἀδύνατον γὰρ τοῦτό γε ἐφάνη. ΘΕΑΙ. πῶς γὰρ οὐκ ἀδύνατον; ΞΕ. δοξαστικὴν ἄρα τινὰ περὶ πάντων ἐπιστήμην ὁ σοφιστὴς ἡμῖν ἀλλ' οὐκ ἀλήθειαν ἔχων ἀναπέφανται.

ST: But nowadays they want to do this.

TT: Very much so.

ST: Presumably because the sophists are believed to be knowledgeable themselves with regard to whatever they contradict.

TT: That must be so.

ST: And are we saying that they may contradict every proposition?

TT: Yes.

ST: So they will appear to their pupils to be wise about everything.

TT: They must.

ST: But they are not, for this turned out to be impossible.

TT: Yes, it must be impossible.

ST: So our sophist has turned out to have an opinion-based knowledge about everything, but not truth.

233d

TT: Yes, certainly. And what we are now saying is probably the most accurate thing we have said about these fellows.

ΘΕΑΙ. παντάπασι μὲν οὖν, καὶ κινδυνεύει γε τὸ νῦν εἰρημένον ὀρθότατα περὶ αὐτῶν εἰρῆσθαι. ΞΕ. λάβωμεν τοίνυν σαφέστερόν τι παράδειγμα περὶ τούτων. ΘΕΑΙ. τὸ ποῖον δὴ; ΞΕ. τόδε. καί μοι πειρῶ προσέχων τὸν νοῦν εὖ μάλα ἀποκρίνασθαι. ΘΕΑΙ. τὸ ποῖον; ΞΕ. εἴ τις φαίη μὴ λέγειν μὴδ' ἀντιλέγειν, ἀλλὰ ποιεῖν καὶ δρᾶν μιᾷ τέχνῃ συνάπαντα ἐπίστασθαι πράγματα—

ST: Well, let's take a clearer example of this.

TT: What sort of example?

ST: As follows. Apply your mind to this and try to answer really well.

TT: Answer what?

ST: If someone were to maintain that on account of a single skill he knew not how to speak and argue, but how to do and make everything there is...

233e

TT: What do you mean by everything?

ΘΕΑΙ. πῶς πάντα εἶπες; ΞΕ. τὴν ἀρχὴν τοῦ ῥηθέντος σύ γ' ἡμῖν εὐθὺς ἄγνοεῖς· τὰ γὰρ σύμπαντα, ὡς ἔοικας, οὐ μανθάνεις. ΘΕΑΙ. οὐ γὰρ οὖν. ΞΕ. λέγω τοίνυν σὲ καὶ ἐμὲ τῶν πάντων καὶ πρὸς ἡμῖν τᾶλλα ζῶα καὶ δένδρα. ΘΕΑΙ. πῶς λέγεις; ΞΕ. εἴ τις ἐμὲ καὶ σὲ καὶ τᾶλλα φυτὰ πάντα ποιήσιν φαίη—

ST: You immediately fail to understand the point of what was said. In fact, it seems you do not understand the phrase 'everything there is'.

TT: No, I do not.

ST: Well, I am saying that you and I are included in 'everything', as well as all the other animals and plants.

TT: What do you mean?

ST: If someone said he was going to make you and me, and all the other creatures...

234a

TT: What could he mean by 'making'? Indeed, you are not actually referring to some sort of farmer, since you are also talking about a maker of animals.

ΘΕΑΙ. τίνα δὴ λέγων τὴν ποίησιν; οὐ γὰρ δὴ γεωργόν γε ἔρεῖς τίνα· καὶ γὰρ ζῶων αὐτὸν εἶπες ποιητήν. ΞΕ. φημί, καὶ πρὸς γε θαλάττης καὶ γῆς καὶ οὐρανοῦ καὶ θεῶν καὶ τῶν ἄλλων συμπάντων· καὶ τοίνυν καὶ ταχὺ

ποιήσας αὐτῶν ἕκαστα πάνυ σμικροῦ νομίσματος ἀποδίδοται. ΘΕΑΙ. παιδιὰν λέγεις τινά. ΞΕ. τί δέ; τὴν τοῦ λέγοντος ὅτι πάντα οἶδε καὶ ταῦτα ἕτερον ἂν διδάξειεν ὀλίγου καὶ ἐν ὀλίγῳ χρόνῳ, μῶν οὐ παιδιὰν νομιστέον; ΘΕΑΙ. πάντως που.

ST: And also of sea and earth, sky and gods, and everything else there is. What's more, he makes them quickly and sells each of them for very little money.

TT: You are describing some sort of game.

ST: Indeed. Mustn't you regard it as a game when someone says that he knows everything and would teach this to someone else for a small sum in a short time?

TT: Entirely so.

234b

ST: And do you know of any form of game more skilled and elegant than that of imitation?

ΞΕ. παιδιᾶς δὲ ἔχεις ἢ τι τεχνικώτερον ἢ καὶ χαριέστερον εἶδος ἢ τὸ μιμητικόν; ΘΕΑΙ. οὐδαμῶς· πάμπολυ γὰρ εἴρηκας εἶδος εἰς ἓν πάντα συλλαβὼν καὶ σχεδὸν ποικιλώτατον. ΞΕ. οὐκοῦν τόν γ' ὑπισχνούμενον δυνατόν εἶναι μιᾷ τέχνῃ πάντα ποιεῖν γιγνώσκομέν που τοῦτο, ὅτι μιμήματα καὶ ὁμώνυμα τῶν ὄντων ἀπεργαζόμενος τῇ γραφικῇ τέχνῃ δυνατός ἔσται τοὺς ἀνοήτους τῶν νέων παίδων, πόρρωθεν τὰ γεγραμμένα ἐπιδεικνύς, λανθάνειν ὡς ὅτι περ ἂν βουλευθῇ δρᾶν, τοῦτο ἱκανώτατος ὢν ἀποτελεῖν ἔργῳ.

TT: Not at all. Indeed, you have proposed a very extensive form, all captured in a single word, more diverse than almost anything else.

ST: And so we appreciate that a man who professes to be able to make everything by means of a single skill, will be able to make imitations with the same names as the real objects by means of the skill in painting, and to deceive the less intelligent of the young children, who view the paintings from afar, into believing that he is entirely competent to complete any task he wishes.

234c

TT: How could he fail?

ΘΕΑΙ. πῶς γὰρ οὐ; ΞΕ. τί δὲ δῆ; περὶ τοὺς λόγους ἄρ' οὐ προσδοκῶμεν εἶναι τινα ἄλλην τέχνην, ἥ αὖ δυνατόν ὄν αὖ τυγχάνει τοὺς νέους καὶ ἔτι πόρρω τῶν πραγμάτων τῆς ἀληθείας ἀφεστῶτας διὰ τῶν ὥτων τοῖς λόγοις γοητεύειν, δεικνύοντας εἰδωλα λεγόμενα περὶ πάντων, ὥστε ποιεῖν ἀληθῆ δοκεῖν λέγεσθαι καὶ τὸν λέγοντα δὴ σοφώτατον πάντων ἅπαντ' εἶναι;

ST: Now, shouldn't we presume that there is some other skill involving words by which one could beguile the young through their ears with words, while they are still at a far remove from matters of truth, showing them verbal images of everything so as to make the statements seem true, and the speaker seem the wisest of all men on every issue?

234d

TT: Yes, there would be another skill like this, wouldn't there?

ΘΕΑΙ. τί γὰρ οὐκ ἂν εἴη ἄλλη τις τοιαύτη τέχνη; ΞΕ. τοὺς πολλοὺς οὖν, ὧ θεαίτητε, τῶν τότε ἀκουόντων ἄρ' οὐκ ἀνάγκη χρόνου τε ἐπελθόντος αὐτοῖς ἱκανοῦ καὶ προϋούσης ἡλικίας τοῖς τε οὖσι προσπίπτοντας ἐγγύθεν καὶ διὰ παθημάτων ἀναγκαζομένους ἐναργῶς ἐφάπτεσθαι τῶν ὄντων, μεταβάλλειν τὰς τότε γενομένας δόξας, ὥστε σμικρὰ μὲν φαίνεσθαι τὰ μεγάλα, χαλεπὰ δὲ τὰ ῥάδια, καὶ πάντα

ST: Now, Theaetetus, most of those when they hear this, must, given enough time and advance in years, encounter things that are, and be compelled through their experiences to get a clear apprehension of things that are. This changes the opinions they once held, so that what was significant will appear trivial and what was easy will appear difficult, and all the illusions created by words will be turned completely upside down by the practical situations which they encounter. Is this so?

TT: Yes, as far as I can judge at my age anyway. But I believe that I am one of those who are "still at a far remove from matters of truth".

234e

ST: In that case, all of us here will try, and indeed are trying, to draw you as close as possible to the truth in the absence of these experiences. So now, tell me something about the sophist. Is it clear by now that he is a sort of beguiler who imitates things that are, or are we still hesitating, in case he truly possesses as many items of knowledge as the number of subjects on which he seems to be able to practise contradiction?

πάντη ἀνατετράφθαι τὰ ἐν τοῖς λόγοις φαντάσματα ὑπὸ τῶν ἐν ταῖς πράξεσιν ἔργων παραγενομένων; ΘΕΑΙ. ὥς γοῦν ἐμοὶ τηλικῶδε ὄντι κρῖναι. οἶμαι δὲ καὶ ἐμὲ τῶν ἔτι πόρρωθεν ἀφεστηκότων εἶναι. ΞΕ. τοιγαροῦν ἡμεῖς σε οἶδε πάντες πειρασόμεθα καὶ νῦν πειρώμεθα ὥς ἐγγύτατα ἄνευ τῶν παθημάτων προσάγειν. περὶ δ' οὖν τοῦ σοφιστοῦ τόδε μοι λέγε· πότερον ἤδη τοῦτο

TT: How could he, stranger? No. It is fairly clear by now from what has been said, that he is one of the huge number of people involved in entertainment.

235a

ST: Well, in that case, we should propose that he is a beguiler and a sort of imitator.

σαφές, ὅτι τῶν γοήτων ἐστὶ τις, μιμητὴς ὧν τῶν ὄντων, ἢ διστάζομεν ἔτι μὴ περὶ ὅσων περ ἀντιλέγειν δοκεῖ δυνατός εἶναι, περὶ τοσούτων καὶ τὰς ἐπιστήμας ἀληθῶς ἔχων τυγχάνει; ΘΕΑΙ. καὶ πῶς ἂν, ὦ ξένε; ἀλλὰ σχεδὸν ἤδη σαφές ἐκ τῶν εἰρημένων, ὅτι τῶν τῆς παιδείας μετεχόντων ἐστὶ τις μερῶν εἷς. ΞΕ. γόητα μὲν δὴ καὶ μιμητὴν ἄρα θετέον αὐτόν τινα. ΘΕΑΙ. πῶς γὰρ οὐ θετέον; ΞΕ. ἄγε δὴ, νῦν ἡμέτερον ἔργον ἤδη τὸν θῆρα μηκέτ'

TT: What else could we propose?

ST: Come now, our task at this stage is to make sure that the creature does not get away. Indeed, we have almost captured him in a sort of web of devices involving our statements about these matters. Consequently, he will never escape the next proposal.

TT: What is it?

235b

ST: That he is someone who belongs to the wonder-working kind.

ἀνεῖναι· σχεδὸν γὰρ αὐτὸν περιελήφαμεν ἐν ἀμφιβληστροῖσι τινὶ τῶν ἐν τοῖς λόγοις περὶ τὰ τοιαῦτα ὀργάνων, ὥστε οὐκέτ' ἐκφεύζεται τόδε γε. ΘΕΑΙ. τὸ ποῖον; ΞΕ. τὸ μὴ οὐ τοῦ γένους εἶναι τοῦ τῶν θαυματοποιῶν τις εἷς. ΘΕΑΙ. κάμοι τοῦτό γε οὕτω περὶ αὐτοῦ συνδοκεῖ. ΞΕ. δέδοκται τοίνυν ὅτι τάχιστα διαιρεῖν τὴν εἰδωλοποιικὴν τέχνην, καὶ καταβάντας εἰς αὐτήν, ἐὰν μὲν ἡμᾶς εὐθὺς ὁ σοφιστὴς ὑπομείνη, συλλαβεῖν αὐτὸν κατὰ τὰ ἐπεσταλμένα

TT: And I agree with that statement about him at least.

ST: It is accepted then that we should divide the image-making skill immediately, and descend into it, and if the sophist opposes us there, arrest him on the orders of lordly reason, hand him over to that king, and publicise his capture. But if he should somehow dive down into the subdivisions of the skill of imitation, we shall follow along, and continually divide the part which contains him until he has been caught. There is no way that this, or any other kind, will ever boast of escaping the method of those who are thus able to proceed in this way, based upon both the particular and the general.

235c

TT: Well said! We should do as you say.

ὑπὸ τοῦ βασιλικοῦ λόγου, κἀκείνῳ παραδόντας ἀποφῆναι τὴν ἄγραν· ἐὰν δ' ἄρα κατὰ μέρη τῆς μιμητικῆς δύηται πῃ, συνακολουθεῖν αὐτῷ διαιροῦντας αἰεὶ τὴν ὑποδεχομένην αὐτὸν μοῖραν, ἕωςπερ ἂν ληφθῇ. πάντως οὔτε οὗτος οὔτε ἄλλο γένος οὐδὲν μὴ ποτε ἐκφυγὸν ἐπεύξεται τὴν τῶν οὕτω δυναμένων μετιέναι καθ' ἑκάστα τε καὶ ἐπὶ πάντα μέθοδον. ΘΕΑΙ. λέγεις εὖ, καὶ ταῦτα ταύτῃ ποιητέον. ΞΕ. κατὰ δὴ τὸν παρεληλυθότα τρόπον τῆς διαιρέσεως

ST: Now, based upon the process of division we have been using, it seems to me that I can now discern two forms of imitative skill, but I

don't think that I can yet figure out which of them contains the object of our search.

TT: You should first say what the two forms are, and then make the division for us.

235d

ST: I can see one skill within it, the skill in making imitations. This is most in evidence when someone produces the imitation according to the proportions of length, breadth and depth of the original, with the appropriate colours being assigned to each part.

ἐγὼ γέ μοι καὶ νῦν φαίνομαι δύο καθορᾶν εἶδη τῆς μιμητικῆς· τὴν δὲ ζητουμένην ἰδέαν, ἐν ὁποτέρῳ ποθ' ἡμῖν οὔσα τυγχάνει, καταμαθεῖν οὐδέπω μοι δοκῶ νῦν δυνατός εἶναι. ΘΕΑΙ. σὺ δ' ἄλλ' εἰπέ πρῶτον καὶ δίδελε ἡμῖν τίνα τῶ δύο λέγεις. ΞΕ. μίαν μὲν τὴν εἰκαστικὴν ὁρῶν ἐν αὐτῇ τέχνην. ἔστι δ' αὕτη μάλιστα ὁπόταν κατὰ τὰς τοῦ παραδείγματος συμμετρίας τις ἐν μήκει καὶ πλάτει καὶ βάθει, καὶ πρὸς

TT: Yes, but isn't that what all imitators try to do?

ST: Not in the case of those who somehow fashion or draw huge works of art. Indeed, if they were to give true proportions to the limbs, you know that the upper parts would appear smaller than they should and the lower parts larger, because one is viewed from a distance and the other from close up.

235e

TT: Yes, certainly.

τούτοις ἔτι χρώματα ἀποδιδούς τὰ προσήκοντα ἐκάστοις, τὴν τοῦ μιμήματος γένεσιν ἀπεργάζεται. ΘΕΑΙ. τί δ'; οὐ πάντες οἱ μιμούμενοί τι τοῦτ' ἐπιχειροῦσι δρᾶν; ΞΕ. οὐκ οὐκ ὅσοι γε τῶν μεγάλων πού τι πλάττουσιν ἔργων ἢ γράφουσιν. εἰ γὰρ ἀποδίδοιεν τὴν τῶν καλῶν ἀληθινὴν συμμετρίαν, οἷσθ' ὅτι σμικρότερα μὲν τοῦ δέοντος

ST: So these craftsmen nowadays set the truth aside, and fashion into their images not the actual proportions, but those which will seem to be beautiful, do they not?

236a

Tt: Entirely so.

τὰ ἄνω, μείζω δὲ τὰ κάτω φαίνοιτ' ἂν διὰ τὸ τὰ μὲν πόρρωθεν, τὰ δ' ἐγγύθεν ὑφ' ἡμῶν ὁρᾶσθαι. ΘΕΑΙ. πάνυ μὲν οὖν. ΞΕ. ἄρ' οὖν οὐ χαίρειν τὸ ἀληθὲς ἑάσαντες οἱ δημιουργοὶ νῦν οὐ τὰς οὐσας συμμετρίας ἀλλὰ τὰς δοξούσας εἶναι καλὰς τοῖς εἰδώλοις ἐναπεργάζονται; ΘΕΑΙ. παντάπασι γε. ΞΕ. τὸ μὲν ἄρα ἕτερον οὐ δίκαιον, εἰκὸς γε ὄν, εἰκόνα καλεῖν; ΘΕΑΙ. ναί.

ST: So, in the first case, where it is different but like, is it fair to call it a likeness?

Tt: Yes.

236b

ST: And the part of the skill of imitation that deals with this should be called what we called it before, likeness-making.

ΞΕ. καὶ τῆς γε μιμητικῆς τὸ ἐπὶ τούτῳ μέρος κλητέον ὅπερ εἵπομεν ἐν τῷ πρόσθεν, εἰκαστικήν; ΘΕΑΙ. κλητέον. ΞΕ. τί δέ; τὸ φαινόμενον μὲν διὰ τὴν οὐκ ἐκ καλοῦ θέαν εἰσκέναι τῷ καλῷ, δύναμιν δὲ εἴ τις λάβοι τὰ τηλικάυτα ἰκανῶς ὁρᾶν, μὴδ' εἰκὸς ὧς φησιν εἰσκέναι, τί καλοῦμεν; ἄρ' οὐκ, ἐπεὶ περ φαίνεται μὲν, εἰσκει δὲ οὐ, φάντασμα; ΘΕΑΙ. τί μήν; ΞΕ. οὐκοῦν πάμπλου καὶ κατὰ τὴν ζωγραφίαν τοῦτο

Tt: Yes, it should be called that.

ST: But what about something that appears to resemble the beautiful, because the viewpoint is unfavourable, but is not like what it is said to be like, once someone is able to get a proper view of such an object? What should we call this? Well, since it appears to be like, though it is unlike, should we call it an appearance?

Tt: Yes, indeed.

236c

ST: And isn't this very common in painting, and in imitation generally?

μέρος ἐστὶ καὶ κατὰ σύμπασαν μιμητικήν; ΘΕΑΙ. πῶς δ' οὔ; ΞΕ. τὴν δὴ φάντασμα ἄλλ' οὐκ εἰκόνα ἀπεργαζομένην τέχνην ἄρ' οὐ φανταστικήν ὀρθότατ' ἂν προσαγορεύοιμεν; ΘΕΑΙ. πολὺ γε. ΞΕ. τούτῳ τοίνυν τῷ δύο ἔλεγον εἶδη τῆς εἰδωλοποιικῆς, εἰκαστικήν καὶ φανταστικήν. ΘΕΑΙ. ὀρθῶς. ΞΕ. ὃ δέ γε καὶ τότε ἡμφεγνόουν, ἐν ποτέρᾳ τὸν σοφιστὴν θετέον, οὐδὲ νῦν πῶς δύναμαι θεάσασθαι σαφῶς,

TT: Of course.

ST: And wouldn't it be best if we referred to the skill which produces appearances rather than likenesses as appearance-making?

TT: Very much so.

ST: Now, these are the two forms of image-making I was talking about – likeness-making and appearance-making.

TT: Correct.

236d

ST: And yet, even now I am not able to see an obvious solution to the issue that bothered me earlier, in which of these two should the sophist be placed. Yes, the man is really wondrous, and extremely hard to catch clear sight of, since even now he has taken refuge very nicely and cleverly in a form which is hard to examine thoroughly.

ἀλλ' ὄντως θαυμαστός ἀνὴρ καὶ κατιδεῖν παγχάλεπος, ἐπεὶ καὶ νῦν μάλα εὖ καὶ κομψῶς εἰς ἄπορον εἶδος διερευνήσασθαι καταπέφευγεν. ΘΕΑΙ. ἔοικεν. ΞΕ. ἄρ' οὖν αὐτὸ γινώσκων σύμφης, ἢ σε οἷον ῥύμη τις ὑπὸ τοῦ λόγου συνειθισμένον συνεπεσπάσατο πρὸς τὸ ταχὺ συμφῆσαι; ΘΕΑΙ. πῶς καὶ πρὸς τί τοῦτο εἴρηκας; ΞΕ. ὄντως, ὦ μακάριε, ἐσμέν ἐν παντάπασι χαλεπῇ

TT: So it seems.

ST: Now, are you agreeing because you recognise this, or have you been drawn along by the force of the argument to agree quickly out of habit?

TT: How? What are you referring to?

236e

ST: We really are involved in an extremely difficult investigation, my friend. Indeed this appearing, and seeming without being, and saying things which are not actually true, all these are now full of difficulties, and they always have been. For it is extremely difficult, Theaetetus, to maintain that there really is false speech and false thinking, without being involved in contradictions as soon as this is said.

σκέψει. τὸ γὰρ φαίνεσθαι τοῦτο καὶ τὸ δοκεῖν, εἶναι δὲ μή, καὶ τὸ λέγειν μὲν ἄττα, ἀληθῆ δὲ μή, πάντα ταῦτά ἐστι μεστὰ ἀπορίας αἰεὶ ἐν τῷ πρόσθεν χρόνῳ καὶ νῦν. ὅπως γὰρ εἰπόντα χρή ψευδῆ λέγειν ἢ δοξάζειν ὄντως εἶναι, καὶ τοῦτο φθηγζάμενον ἐναντιολογία μὴ συνέχεσθαι, παντάπασιν, ὧ

TT: What contradictions?

237a

ST: This statement has dared to propose that what is not, is. For otherwise falsehood would not have come into being. But, my boy, beginning when we were children up until his death, the great Parmenides emphasised this to us, stating in prose what he also says in verse.

*"Never shall this be proved that things that are not, are,
but do thou, in thine enquiry, hold back thy thought from this way."*¹⁹

So that is the testimony of the great man. But in fact, the statement itself would reveal most if it were probed moderately. So first let's spend a while looking at this, if it makes no difference to you.

Θεαίττε, χαλεπόν. ΘΕΑΙ. τί δῆ; ΞΕ. τετόλμηκεν ὁ λόγος οὗτος ὑποθέσθαι τὸ μὴ ὄν εἶναι· ψεῦδος γὰρ οὐκ ἂν ἄλλως ἐγίγνετο ὄν. Παρμενίδης δὲ ὁ μέγας, ὧ παῖ, παισὶν ἡμῖν οὖσιν ἀρχόμενός τε καὶ διὰ τέλους τοῦτο ἀπεμαρτύρατο, πεζῇ τε ὧδε ἐκάστοτε λέγων καὶ μετὰ μέτρων—οὐ γὰρ μήποτε τοῦτο δαμῆ, φησὶν, εἶναι μὴ ἐόντα· ἀλλὰ σὺ τῆσδ' ἀφ' ὁδοῦ διζήμενος εἶργε νόημα.

237b

Tt: I accept anything you propose. So just proceed by considering how the argument may best unfold, and lead me also along that path.

παρ' ἐκείνου τε οὖν μαρτυρεῖται, καὶ μάλιστα γε δὴ πάντων ὁ λόγος αὐτὸς ἂν δηλώσειε μέτρια βασανισθεῖς. τοῦτο οὖν αὐτὸ πρῶτον θεασώμεθα, εἰ μὴ τί σοι διαφέρει. ΘΕΑΙ. τὸ μὲν ἐμὸν ὅπη βούλει τίθεσο, τὸν δὲ λόγον ἢ βέλτιστα διέξεισι σκοπῶν αὐτός τε ἴθι κάμῃ κατὰ ταύτην τὴν ὁδὸν ἄγε. ΞΕ. ἀλλὰ χρή δρᾶν ταῦτα. καί μοι λέγε· τὸ μηδαμῶς ὄν τολμῶμέν· που φθέγγεσθαι; ΘΕΑΙ. πῶς γὰρ οὐ; ΞΕ. μὴ τοῖνυν ἔριδος ἔνεκα μηδὲ παιδιᾶς, ἀλλ' εἰ σπουδῇ

St: Well, that's what must be done. So tell me, would we dare to use the expression 'that which in no way is'?

Tt: Well, why not?

237c

St: If one of his pupils who had considered this were asked, not for the sake of argument or sport, but seriously, to tell us to what the expression 'what is not' should be applied, what do we think he would say? To what sort of thing would he apply the phrase himself? To what would he apply it, and how would he explain this to the questioner?

δέοι συννοήσαντά τινα ἀποκρίνασθαι τῶν ἀκροατῶν ποῖ χρή τοῦνομ' ἐπιφέρειν τοῦτο, τὸ μὴ ὄν, τί δοκοῦμεν ἂν εἰς τί καὶ ἐπὶ ποῖον αὐτόν τε καταχρήσασθαι καὶ τῷ πυνθανομένῳ δεικνύναι; ΘΕΑΙ. χαλεπὸν ἥρου καὶ σχεδὸν εἰπεῖν οἴω γε ἐμοὶ παντάπασιν ἄπορον. ΞΕ. ἀλλ' οὖν τοῦτό γε δηλόν, ὅτι τῶν ὄντων ἐπὶ τι τὸ μὴ ὄν οὐκ οἰστέον. ΘΕΑΙ. πῶς γὰρ ἄν; ΞΕ. οὐκοῦν ἐπέπερ οὐκ ἐπὶ τὸ ὄν, οὐδ' ἐπὶ τὸ τί φέρων ὀρθῶς ἂν τις φέροι. ΘΕΑΙ. πῶς δῆ;

Tt: You have asked a difficult question, and it is almost completely impossible for someone like me to answer it.

St: Well, isn't it obvious in any case that the term 'what is not' may not be applied to any of the things that are?

Tt: No, how could it?

ST: Then, since it is not actually applicable to what is, neither may it be applied to something.

TT: Indeed not.

237d

ST: And presumably it is clear to us that we always use the word 'something' in relation to what is, for it is impossible to use this word on its own, naked and isolated from all of the things that are. Is this so?

ΞΕ. καὶ τοῦτο ἡμῖν που φανερόν, ὥς καὶ τὸ τὶ τοῦτο ῥῆμα ἐπ' ὄντι λέγομεν ἐκάστοτε· μόνον γὰρ αὐτὸ λέγειν, ὥσπερ γυμνὸν καὶ ἀπρηλωμένον ἀπὸ τῶν ὄντων ἀπάντων, ἀδύνατον· ἢ γάρ; ΘΕΑΙ. ἀδύνατον. ΞΕ. ἄρα τῆδε σκοπῶν σύμφης, ὥς ἀνάγκη τὸν τι λέγοντα ἔν γέ τι λέγειν; ΘΕΑΙ. οὕτως. ΞΕ. ἐνὸς γὰρ δὴ τό γε τὶ φήσεις σημεῖον εἶναι, τὸ δὲ τινὲς δυοῖν, τὸ δὲ τινὲς πολλῶν. ΘΕΑΙ. πῶς γὰρ οὐ;

TT: Yes, it's impossible.

ST: Do you agree because you recognise that when speaking of 'something' we must be speaking of some one thing?

TT: That's right.

ST: Yes, indeed. And you will agree that 'some thing' indicates one, and 'some things' indicates two or many.

TT: How could I disagree?

ST: Well then, when not speaking of something, it is most necessary, it seems, that we are speaking of absolutely nothing.

TT: Yes, it is most necessary.

237e

ST: Could we ever agree that such a person is speaking at all, when he is speaking of nothing? No, we should not even say that a man is speaking when he tries to utter what is not.

ΞΕ. τὸν δὲ δὴ μὴ τι λέγοντα ἀναγκαιότατον, ὥς ἔοικε, παντάπασι μηδὲν λέγειν. ΘΕΑΙ. ἀναγκαιότατον μὲν οὖν. ΞΕ. ἄρ' οὖν οὐδὲ τοῦτο

συγχωρητέον, τὸ τὸν τοιοῦτον λέγειν μὲν τι, λέγειν μέντοι μηδέν, ἀλλ' οὐδὲ λέγειν φατέον, ὅς γ' ἂν ἐπιχειρῇ μὴ ὄν φθέγγεσθαι; ΘΕΑΙ. τέλος γοῦν ἂν ἀπορίας ὁ λόγος ἔχοι.

TT: This argument should end our perplexity anyway.

ST: Don't make extravagant claims yet, my friend, for there are other perplexities. Indeed, the greatest and first of them actually relates to the very principle involved here.

TT: What do you mean? Speak, and do not hesitate at all.

ST: If we take something that is, I presume we may add to it something else that is.

TT: Of course.

238a

ST: But shall we say that it is ever possible to add anything which is, to what is not?

ΞΕ. μήπω μέγ' εἴπης; ἔτι γάρ, ὦ μακάριε, ἔστι, καὶ ταῦτά γε τῶν ἀποριῶν ἡ μεγίστη καὶ πρώτη. περὶ γὰρ αὐτὴν αὐτοῦ τὴν ἀρχὴν οὔσα τυγχάνει. ΘΕΑΙ. πῶς φῆς; λέγε καὶ μηδέν ἀποκνήσης. ΞΕ. τῷ μὲν ὄντι που προσγένειτ' ἂν τι τῶν ὄντων ἕτερον. ΘΕΑΙ. πῶς γὰρ οὐ; ΞΕ. μὴ ὄντι δέ τι τῶν ὄντων ἄρ' ἀποτε προσγίγνεσθαι φήσομεν δυνατόν εἶναι; ΘΕΑΙ. καὶ πῶς; ΞΕ. ἀριθμὸν δὴ τὸν σύμπαντα τῶν ὄντων τίθεμεν.

TT: No, how could we?

ST: Now, we include number in general among things that are.

TT: Well, if we propose that anything is, we must surely propose that number is.

ST: Therefore we should not even attempt to apply number, be it multiple or be it one, to 'what is not'.

238b

TT: Well, the argument does seem to indicate that it would not be appropriate to attempt this.

ΘΕΑΙ. εἴπερ γε καὶ ἄλλο τι θετέον ὥς ὄν. ΞΕ. μὴ τοίνυν μὴδ' ἐπιχειρῶμεν ἀριθμοῦ μήτε πλήθος μήτε ἔν πρὸς τὸ μὴ ὄν προσφέρειν. ΘΕΑΙ. οὐκουν ἂν ὀρθῶς γε, ὥς ἔοικεν, ἐπιχειροῖμεν, ὥς φησιν ὁ λόγος. ΞΕ. πῶς οὖν ἂν ἢ διὰ τοῦ στόματος φθέγγαιτο ἂν τις ἢ καὶ τῇ διανοίᾳ τὸ παράπαν λάβοι τὰ μὴ ὄντα ἢ τὸ μὴ ὄν χωρὶς ἀριθμοῦ; ΘΕΑΙ. λέγε πῇ; ΞΕ. μὴ ὄντα μὲν ἐπειδὴν λέγωμεν, ἄρα οὐ πλήθος

ST: How, then, could anyone either utter through the mouth, or in any way comprehend in thought, things that are not, or what is not, in the absence of number?

TT: Tell me why not.

ST: Well, whenever we say 'things that are not', aren't we trying to attribute multiplicity of number to them?

TT: Yes, indeed.

ST: But whenever we say 'what is not', we attribute one in that case, do we not?

238c

TT: Well, that is very clear, anyway.

ἐπιχειροῦμεν ἀριθμοῦ προστιθέναι; ΘΕΑΙ. τί μήν; ΞΕ. μὴ ὄν δέ, ἄρα οὐ τὸ ἔν αὖ; ΘΕΑΙ. σαφέστατά γε. ΞΕ. καὶ μὴν οὔτε δίκαιόν γε οὔτε ὀρθόν φαμεν ὄν ἐπιχειρεῖν μὴ ὄντι προσαρμόττειν. ΘΕΑΙ. λέγεις ἀληθέστατα. ΞΕ. συννοεῖς οὖν ὥς οὔτε φθέγγασθαι δυνατόν ὀρθῶς οὔτ' εἰπεῖν οὔτε διανοηθῆναι τὸ μὴ ὄν αὐτὸ καθ' αὐτό, ἀλλ' ἔστιν ἀδιανόητόν τε καὶ ἄρρητον καὶ ἀφθεγκτον καὶ ἄλογον; ΘΕΑΙ. παντάπασι μὲν οὖν.

ST: And yet we have been saying that it is neither proper nor correct to try to attach being to non-being.

TT: What you are saying is perfectly true.

ST: Do you appreciate then that it is not possible to utter correctly, or speak of or think of non-being just by itself? It is rather unthinkable, unspeakable and unutterable, and there is no account thereof.

Tt: Entirely so.

238d

St: In that case, wasn't I mistaken earlier when I said that I was going to state the greatest perplexity involved here, when another even greater perplexity may be stated?

ΞΕ. ἄρ' οὖν ἐψευσάμην ἄρτι λέγων τὴν μεγίστην ἀπορίαν ἐρεῖν αὐτοῦ περὶ, τὸ δὲ ἔτι μείζω τινὰ λέγειν ἄλλην ἔχομεν; ΘΕΑΙ. τίνα δὴ; ΞΕ. ὃ θαυμάσιε, οὐκ ἐννοεῖς αὐτοῖς τοῖς λεχθεῖσιν ὅτι καὶ τὸν ἐλέγχοντα εἰς ἀπορίαν καθίστησι τὸ μὴ ὄν οὕτως, ὥστε, ὁπόταν αὐτὸ ἐπιχειρῇ τις ἐλέγχειν, ἐναντία αὐτὸν αὐτῷ περὶ ἐκεῖνο ἀναγκάζεσθαι λέγειν; ΘΕΑΙ. πῶς φῆς; εἰπέ ἔτι σαφέστερον. ΞΕ. οὐδὲν δεῖ τὸ σαφέστερον ἐν ἐμοὶ σκοπεῖν. ἐγὼ μὲν

Tt: What perplexity?

St: You surprise me! Do you not realise from what has already been said, that 'what is not' reduces even the person who tries to refute it to such perplexity that it forces him to contradict himself on the issue?

Tt: What are you saying? Make this a bit clearer.

238e

St: Don't look to me for clarity. For although I am proposing that what is not must partake neither of one nor of many, I said, both then and now, that it is one, for I said 'what is not'. Do you understand?

γὰρ ὑποθέμενος οὔτε ἑνὸς οὔτε τῶν πολλῶν τὸ μὴ ὄν δεῖν μετέχειν, ἄρτι τε καὶ νῦν οὕτως ἐν αὐτὸ εἴρηκα τὸ μὴ ὄν γὰρ φημί. συνίης τοι. ΘΕΑΙ. ναί. ΞΕ. καὶ μὴν αὖ καὶ σμικρὸν ἔμπροσθεν ἄφθεγκτόν τε αὐτὸ καὶ ἄρρητον καὶ ἄλογον ἔφην εἶναι. συνέπη; ΘΕΑΙ. συνέπομαι. πῶς γὰρ οὐ; ΞΕ. οὐκοῦν τό γε εἶναι προσάπτειν πειρώμενος ἐναντία

Tt: Yes.

St: And what's more, I actually said a little earlier that it is unutterable, unspeakable, and there is no account thereof. Do you follow?

TT: Yes, of course.

239a

ST: So in trying to associate 'being' with this, am I not contradicting what I said before?

τοῖς πρόσθεν ἔλεγον; ΘΕΑΙ. φαίνῃ. ΞΕ. τί δέ; τοῦτο προσάπτων οὐχ ὡς ἐνὶ διελεγόμην; ΘΕΑΙ. ναί. ΞΕ. καὶ μὴν ἄλογόν γε λέγων καὶ ἄρρητον καὶ ἄφθεγκτον ὥς γε πρὸς ἓν τὸν λόγον ἐποιούμην. ΘΕΑΙ. πῶς δ' οὐ; ΞΕ. φαμέν δέ γε δεῖν, εἴπερ ὀρθῶς τις λέξει, μήτε ὡς ἓν μήτε ὡς πολλὰ διορίζειν αὐτό, μηδὲ τὸ παράπαν αὐτὸ καλεῖν· ἐνὸς γὰρ εἶδει καὶ κατὰ ταύτην ἂν τὴν πρόσρῃσιν προσαγορεύοιτο. ΘΕΑΙ. παντάπασί γε.

TT: It appears that you are.

ST: Then again, when I applied the word 'that' to it, wasn't I referring to it as one?

TT: Yes.

ST: And, indeed, in saying that there is 'no word' for it, and it is 'unspeakable' and 'unutterable', I used a statement that implies one.

TT: Of course.

ST: And yet we say that properly speaking it should not be defined as one, or many, or be called 'it' at all, for the use of this phrase would attribute the form of one.

TT: Entirely so.

239b

ST: Well, what is to be said about me? It turns out that the refutation of non-being is again defeating me. So, as I said, we should not look to my pronouncements for the correct manner of speaking about 'what is not'. Instead, let it be your turn, and let's consider what you say.

ΞΕ. τὸν μὲν τοίνυν ἐμέ γε τί τις ἂν λέγοι; καὶ γὰρ πάλαι καὶ τὰ νῦν ἡττημένον ἂν εὖροι περὶ τὸν τοῦ μὴ ὄντος ἔλεγχον. ὥστε ἐν ἑμοιγε λέγοντι, καθάπερ εἶπον, μὴ σκοπῶμεν τὴν ὀρθολογίαν περὶ τὸ μὴ ὄν, ἀλλ' εἴα δὴ νῦν ἐν σοὶ σκεψώμεθα. ΘΕΑΙ. πῶς φής; ΞΕ. ἴθι ἡμῖν εὖ καὶ

γενναίως, ἅτε νέος ὢν, ὅτι μάλιστα δύνασαι συντείνας πειράθητι, μήτε οὐσίαν μήτε τὸ ἐν μήτε πλῆθος ἀριθμοῦ προστιθείς τῷ μὴ ὄντι, κατὰ τὸ ὀρθὸν φθέγξασθαί τι περὶ αὐτοῦ.

TT: What are you referring to?

ST: Since you are young, you should come before us, fair and noble, exert yourself, and try your very best to make some correct utterance about this without attributing being, or one, or numerical multiplicity to what is not.

239c

TT: It would be strange if I had any great desire to attempt this myself in the light of what has happened to you.

ΘΕΑΙ. πολλή μεντᾶν με καὶ ἄτοπος ἔχοι προθυμία τῆς ἐπιχειρήσεως, εἰ σὲ τοιαῦθ' ὀρῶν πάσχοντα αὐτὸς ἐπιχειροίην. ΞΕ. ἀλλ' εἰ δοκεῖ, σὲ μὲν καὶ ἐμὲ χαίρειν ἐῷμεν· ἕως δ' ἂν τινι δυναμένῳ δρᾶν τοῦτο ἐντυγχάνωμεν, μέχρι τούτου λέγωμεν ὡς παντὸς μᾶλλον πανούργως εἰς ἄπορον ὁ σοφιστὴς τόπον καταδέδυκεν. ΘΕΑΙ. καὶ μάλα δὴ φαίνεται. ΞΕ. τοιγαροῦν εἴ τινα φήσομεν αὐτὸν ἔχειν φανταστικήν

ST: Well, if that's what you think, then let's forget about you and me. Until we encounter someone who can do what I asked you to do, we should say that the sophist has very cunningly dived down into a place we cannot enter.

TT: That is certainly how it seems.

239d

ST: Well, in that case, if we say that he has some skill which involves appearances, he will readily attack us for this usage of words, and turn those words against us by asking what precisely we mean at all by 'image' when we refer to him as an image-maker. So consider, Theaetetus, how we should respond to this impetuous questioning.

τέχνην, ῥαδίως ἐκ ταύτης τῆς χρείας τῶν λόγων ἀντιλαμβανόμενος ἡμῶν εἰς τούναντίον ἀποστρέψει τοὺς λόγους, ὅταν εἰδωλοποιὸν αὐτὸν καλῶμεν, ἀνερωτῶν τί ποτε τὸ παράπαν εἶδωλον λέγομεν.

σκοπεῖν οὖν, ὧ Θεαίτητε, χρή τί τις τῷ νεανίᾳ πρὸς τὸ ἐρωτώμενον ἀποκρινεῖται. ΘΕΑΙ. δῆλον ὅτι φήσομεν τὰ τε ἐν τοῖς ὕδασι καὶ κατόπτροις εἶδωλα, ἔτι καὶ τὰ γεγραμμένα καὶ τὰ τετυπωμένα καὶ τᾶλλα ὅσα που τοιαῦτ' ἔσθ' ἕτερα.

TT: Obviously we are talking about images both in water and in mirrors, and also paintings, sculptures, and all the other varied productions of this sort.

239e

ST: Apparently, Theaetetus, you have never seen a sophist.

ΞΕ. φανερός, ὧ Θεαίτητε, εἴ σοφιστὴν οὐκ ἔωρακώς. ΘΕΑΙ. τί δή; ΞΕ. δόξει σοι μῦειν ἢ παντάπασιν οὐκ ἔχειν ὄμματα. ΘΕΑΙ. πῶς; ΞΕ. τὴν ἀπόκρισιν ὅταν οὕτως αὐτῷ διδῶς ἐὰν ἐν κατόπτροις ἢ πλάσμασι λέγῃς τι, καταγελάσεταιί σου τῶν λόγων, ὅταν ὡς βλέποντι λέγῃς αὐτῷ, προσποιοῦμενος οὔτε κάτοπτρα

TT: Why do you say that?

ST: He will have you thinking that his eyes are shut or that he has no eyes.

TT: How?

ST: If you were to answer him in that way and refer to mirror images or fashioned images, he would laugh at your words for speaking as though he was a man who could see. He would pretend that he recognised neither mirror nor water, nor had any sight at all, and would just ask you something about your words.

240a

TT: What would he ask about?

οὔτε ὕδατα γινώσκειν οὔτε τὸ παράπαν ὄψιν, τὸ δ' ἐκ τῶν λόγων ἐρωτήσῃ σε μόνον. ΘΕΑΙ. ποῖον; ΞΕ. τὸ διὰ πάντων τούτων ἃ πολλὰ εἰπὼν ἡξίωσας ἐνὶ προσειπεῖν ὀνόματι φθελγᾶμενος εἶδωλον ἐπὶ πᾶσιν ὡς ἔν ὄν. λέγε οὖν καὶ ἀμύνου μηδὲν ὑποχωρῶν τὸν ἄνδρα. ΘΕΑΙ. τί δῆτα, ὧ ξένε, εἶδωλον ἂν φαῖμεν εἶναι πλήν γε τὸ πρὸς τάληθινόν

ἀφωμοιωμένον ἕτερον τοιοῦτον; ΞΕ. ἕτερον δὲ λέγεις τοιοῦτον ἀληθινόν, ἢ ἐπὶ τίνι τὸ

ST: In all these instances, and you say that there are many, you decided to employ a single word, and you used the word 'image' as one term applicable to all the instances. So defend this. Speak, and do not yield any ground to this fellow.

TT: Well, stranger, what else can we say an image is except another sort of object made like the true object?

240b

ST: Are you speaking of another sort of true object? Or what do you mean by 'sort of object'?

τοιοῦτον εἶπες; ΘΕΑΙ. οὐδαμῶς ἀληθινόν γε, ἀλλ' εἰκὸς μέν. ΞΕ. ἄρα τὸ ἀληθινὸν ὄντως ὃν λέγων; ΘΕΑΙ. οὕτως. ΞΕ. τί δέ; τὸ μὴ ἀληθινὸν ἄρ' ἐναντίον ἀληθοῦς; ΘΕΑΙ. τί μήν; ΞΕ. οὐκ ὄντως οὐκ ὃν ἄρα λέγεις τὸ εἰκός, εἴπερ αὐτό γε μὴ ἀληθινὸν ἐρεῖς. ΘΕΑΙ. ἀλλ' ἔστι γε μήν πως. ΞΕ. οὐκ οὐκ ἀληθῶς γε, φήεις. ΘΕΑΙ. οὐ γὰρ οὕν· πλήν γ' εἰκὼν ὄντως. ΞΕ. οὐκ ὃν ἄρα οὐκ ὄντως ἐστὶν ὄντως ἣν λέγομεν εἰκόνα;

TT: It is not true at all, but like the true.

ST: Are you saying that the true object actually is?

TT: Just so.

ST: And what about this? Is the not true opposite to the true?

TT: Of course.

ST: So, are you saying that the likeness actually is not, if you say that it is not true?

TT: Yet somehow or other it is.

ST: Though you are not saying that it truly is.

TT: Indeed not. However, it is actually an image.

240c

ST: So, while it actually is not, it is actually what we call an image.

ΘΕΑΙ. κινδυνεύει τοιαύτην τινὰ πεπλέχθαι συμπλοκὴν τὸ μὴ ὄν τῷ ὄντι, καὶ μάλα ἄτοπον. ΞΕ. πῶς γὰρ οὐκ ἄτοπον; ὁρᾷς γοῦν ὅτι καὶ νῦν διὰ τῆς ἐπαλλάξεως ταύτης ὁ πολυκέφαλος σοφιστὴς ἠνάγκακεν ἡμᾶς τὸ μὴ ὄν οὐχ ἐκόντας ὁμολογεῖν εἶναί πως. ΘΕΑΙ. ὁρῶ καὶ μάλα. ΞΕ. τί δὲ δῆ; τὴν τέχνην αὐτοῦ τίνα ἀφορίσαντες ἡμῖν αὐτοῖς συμφωνεῖν οἴοι τε ἐσόμεθα; ΘΕΑΙ. πῇ καὶ τὸ ποῖόν τι φοβούμενος οὕτω λέγεις;

TT: It really seems that something like this combines what is with what is not, and is very strange.

ST: Indeed, how could it be otherwise? And now you may see that our many-headed sophist, by means of this interchanging, has compelled us against our will to agree that what is not somehow is.

TT: I see it, indeed.

240d

ST: And now, shall we be able to define this skill of his without contradicting ourselves?

ΞΕ. ὅταν περὶ τὸ φάντασμα αὐτὸν ἀπατᾶν φῶμεν καὶ τὴν τέχνην εἶναί τινα ἀπατητικὴν αὐτοῦ, τότε πότερον ψευδῇ δοξάζειν τὴν ψυχὴν ἡμῶν φήσομεν ὑπὸ τῆς ἐκείνου τέχνης, ἢ τί ποτ' ἐροῦμεν; ΘΕΑΙ. τοῦτο· τί γὰρ ἂν ἄλλο εἴπαιμεν; ΞΕ. ψευδῆς δ' αὖ δόξα ἔσται τάναντία τοῖς οὔσι δοξάζουσα, ἢ πῶς; ΘΕΑΙ. οὕτως· τάναντία. ΞΕ. λέγεις ἄρα τὰ μὴ ὄντα δοξάζειν τὴν ψευδῇ δόξαν; ΘΕΑΙ. ἀνάγκη.

TT: In what way? What sort of contradictions are you afraid of?

ST: Whenever we say that he is deceiving us about the appearance, and his skill is one of falsification, shall we say that our souls form false opinion at that time, on account of the skill of this man? Or what precisely shall we say?

TT: That's it! What else could we say?

ST: What's more, false opinion will be thinking the opposite of things that are. Is this so?

TT: Just so. It will be thinking their opposite.

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ST: So are you saying that false opinion thinks things that are not?

ΞΕ. πότερον μὴ εἶναι τὰ μὴ ὄντα δοξάζουσιν, ἢ πως εἶναι τὰ μηδαμῶς ὄντα; ΘΕΑΙ. εἶναι πως τὰ μὴ ὄντα δεῖ γε, εἴπερ ψεύσεται ποτέ τις τι καὶ κατὰ βραχύ. ΞΕ. τί δ'; οὐ καὶ μηδαμῶς εἶναι τὰ πάντως ὄντα δοξάζεται; ΘΕΑΙ. ναί. ΞΕ. καὶ τοῦτο δὴ ψεῦδος; ΘΕΑΙ. καὶ τοῦτο. ΞΕ. καὶ λόγος οἷμαι ψευδὴς οὕτω κατὰ ταῦτα νομισθήσεται

TT: It must.

ST: Does it think that things that are not, are not? Or does it think that things that are not at all, somehow are?

241a

TT: Things that are not must somehow be, if anyone is ever to speak falsely, even a little.

τά τε ὄντα λέγων μὴ εἶναι καὶ τὰ μὴ ὄντα εἶναι. ΘΕΑΙ. πῶς γὰρ ἂν ἄλλως τοιοῦτος γένοιτο; ΞΕ. σχεδὸν οὐδαμῶς ἀλλὰ ταῦτα ὁ σοφιστὴς οὐ φήσει. ἢ τίς μηχανὴ συγχωρεῖν τινα τῶν εὖ φρονούντων, ὅταν ἄφθεγκτα καὶ ἄρρητα καὶ ἄλογα καὶ ἀδιανόητα προσδιωμολογημένα ἢ τὰ πρὸ τούτων ὁμολογηθέντα; μανθάνομεν, ὦ Θεαίτητε, ἃ λέγει; ΘΕΑΙ. πῶς γὰρ οὐ μανθάνομεν ὅτι τάναντία φήσει λέγειν ἡμᾶς τοῖς νυνδὴ, ψευδῇ τολμήσαντας εἰπεῖν ὥς ἔστιν

ST: What about this? Doesn't false opinion also think that things that entirely are, are not at all?

TT: Yes.

ST: And this too is false?

TT: This too.

ST: And so I presume, on this basis, a statement will be considered false if it says that things that are, are not, or that things that are not, are.

TT: Yes, how else could a statement of this sort arise?

241b

ST: Hardly at all, but the sophist will deny this. Or is there any way that a right-minded person would accept these formulations in the light of what we agreed before? Do we understand what agreements are meant, Theaetetus?

ἐν δόξαις τε καὶ κατὰ λόγους; τῷ γὰρ μὴ ὄντι τὸ ὄν προσάπτειν ἡμᾶς πολλάκις ἀναγκάζεσθαι, διομολογησαμένους νυνδὴ τοῦτο εἶναι πάντων ἀδυνατώτατον. ΞΕ. ὀρθῶς ἀπεμνημόνευσας. ἀλλ' ὅρα δὴ βουλευέσθαι τί χρὴ δρᾶν τοῦ σοφιστοῦ περὶ τὰς γὰρ ἀντιλήψεις καὶ ἀπορίας, ἐὰν αὐτὸν διερευνῶμεν ἐν τῇ τῶν ψευδουργῶν καὶ γοήτων τέχνῃ τιθέντες, ὅρᾳς ὡς εὖποροι καὶ πολλαί. ΘΕΑΙ. καὶ μάλα. ΞΕ. μικρὸν μέρος τοίνυν αὐτῶν διεληλύθαμεν, οὐσῶν

TT: Indeed, how could we fail to understand? He will claim that we are saying the opposite of what we said a moment ago, once we dare to state that there is falsity both in opinions and based upon words. For we are constantly compelled to associate what is with what is not, despite having agreed just now that this is utterly impossible.

ST: Your recollection is correct. But now we really must consider what to do about the sophist. For you see that we are well supplied with many objections and perplexities, once we propose to track him down in the skill of falsification and beguilement.

TT: I do, indeed.

ST: And we have elaborated only a small portion of the problems which are almost limitless.

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TT: Well, if that is the case, it would seem to be impossible to capture the sophist.

ὡς ἔπος εἶπεῖν ἀπεράντων. ΘΕΑΙ. ἀδύνατόν γ' ἂν, ὡς ἔοικεν, εἶη τὸν σοφιστὴν ἐλεῖν, εἰ ταῦτα οὕτως ἔχει. ΞΕ. τί οὖν; οὕτως ἀποστησόμεθα νῦν μαλθακισθέντες; ΘΕΑΙ. οὐκ οὐκ ἔγωγέ φημι δεῖν, εἰ καὶ κατὰ σμικρὸν οἶοί τ' ἐπιλαβέσθαι πῃ τάνδρος ἐσμεν. ΞΕ. ἔξεις οὖν

συγγνώμην καὶ καθάπερ νῦν εἶπες ἀγαπήσεις ἐάν πη καὶ κατὰ βραχὺ παρασπασώμεθα οὕτως ἰσχυροῦ λόγου; ΘΕΑΙ. πῶς γὰρ οὐχ ἔξω;

ST: What next? Shall we become cowards, and give up now?

TT: I say that we should not do that if we are somehow able to get even the slightest grip on this fellow.

ST: Then you will have to be quite forgiving, and, as you have just said, be satisfied if we can somehow make even minor inroads against such a powerful argument.

TT: How could I refuse?

241d

ST: In that case, I have a further request of you.

ΞΕ. τόδε τοίνυν ἔτι μᾶλλον παραιτοῦμαί σε. ΘΕΑΙ. τὸ ποῖον; ΞΕ. μὴ με οἶον πατραλοῖαν ὑπολάβης γίγνεσθαι τινα. ΘΕΑΙ. τί δῆ; ΞΕ. τὸν τοῦ πατρὸς Παρμενίδου λόγον ἀναγκαῖον ἡμῖν ἀμυνομένοις ἔσται βασανίζειν, καὶ βιάζεσθαι τό τε μὴ ὄν ὡς ἔστι κατὰ τι καὶ τὸ ὄν αὖ πάλιν ὡς οὐκ ἔστι πη. ΘΕΑΙ. φαίνεται τὸ τοιοῦτον διαμαχετέον ἐν τοῖς λόγοις. ΞΕ. πῶς γὰρ οὐ φαίνεται καὶ τὸ λεγόμενον δὴ τοῦτο τυφλῶ;

TT: What is it?

ST: Do not presume that I am becoming some sort of parricide.

TT: What do you mean?

ST: It will be necessary in defending ourselves to probe the statement of Parmenides, our father, and force the assertion that in some respect what is not, is, and again what is, in some way, is not.

TT: It is evident that some such contention must feature in these discussions.

241e

ST: Yes, mustn't this be evident even to a blind man, as they say? For if these statements are neither refuted nor accepted, it will hardly be possible for someone to speak about false statements or false opinions

being either images, likenesses, imitations or appearances – or to speak of any skills associated with them – without looking ridiculous by being forced to contradict himself.

τούτων γὰρ μήτ' ἐλεγχθέντων μήτε ὁμολογηθέντων σχολῇ ποτέ τις οἴος τε ἔσται περὶ λόγων ψευδῶν λέγων ἢ δόξης, εἴτε εἰδῶλων εἴτε εἰκόνων εἴτε μιμημάτων εἴτε φαντασμάτων αὐτῶν, ἢ καὶ περὶ τεχνῶν τῶν ὅσαι περὶ ταῦτά εἰσι, μὴ καταγέλαστος εἶναι τά γ' ἐναντία ἀναγκαζόμενος αὐτῷ λέγειν. ΘΕΑΙ. ἀληθέστατα.

TT: Very true.

242a

ST: Well, for these reasons we must dare to attack the paternal maxim. Or if some scruple hinders us from doing this, we should abandon the matter entirely.

ΞΕ. διὰ ταῦτα μέντοι τολμητέον ἐπιτίθεσθαι τῷ πατρικῷ λόγῳ νῦν, ἢ τὸ παράπαν ἑατέον, εἰ τοῦτό τις εἴργει δρᾶν ὄκνος. ΘΕΑΙ. ἀλλ' ἡμᾶς τοῦτό γε μηδὲν μηδαμῇ εἴρξει. ΞΕ. τρίτον τοίνυν ἔτι σε σμικρόν τι παραιτήσομαι. ΘΕΑΙ. λέγε μόνον. ΞΕ. εἰπόν που νυνδὴ λέγων ὡς πρὸς τὸν περὶ ταῦτ' ἔλεγχον αἰεὶ τε ἀπειρηκῶς ἐγὼ τυγχάνω καὶ δὴ καὶ τὰ νῦν. ΘΕΑΙ. εἴπες. ΞΕ. φοβοῦμαι δὴ τὰ εἰρημένα, μὴ ποτε διὰ ταῦτά σοι μανικὸς εἶναι δόξω παρὰ πόδα μεταβαλὼν ἐμαυτὸν ἄνω καὶ

TT: Well, this should not hinder us at all.

ST: Then I shall still make a third small request of you.

TT: Just name it.

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ST: When I spoke just now, I indicated that I have always been daunted by the refutation of these, and this is especially so right now.

κάτω. σὴν γὰρ δὴ χάριν ἐλέγχειν τὸν λόγον ἐπιθησόμεθα, ἐάνπερ ἐλέγχωμεν. ΘΕΑΙ. ὡς τοίνυν ἔμοιγε μηδαμῇ δόξων μηδὲν πλημμελεῖν, ἂν ἐπὶ τὸν ἔλεγχον τοῦτον καὶ τὴν ἀπόδειξιν ἴης, θαρρῶν ἴθι τούτου γε ἔνεκα. ΞΕ. φέρε δὴ, τίνα ἀρχὴν τις ἂν ἄρξαιτο παρακινδυνευτικοῦ

λόγου; δοκῶ μὲν γὰρ τήνδ', ὧ παῖ, τὴν ὁδὸν ἀναγκαιοτάτην ἡμῖν εἶναι τρέπεσθαι. ΘΕΑΙ. ποίαν δὴ; ΞΕ. τὰ δοκοῦντα νῦν ἐναργῶς ἔχειν ἐπισκέψασθαι πρῶτον

TT: You did say that.

ST: Now, I am afraid that because of what I have said, you will think that I am mad for changing my stance back and forth. After all, we are taking on the refutation of the proposition¹⁰ for your sake, if we do actually refute it.

TT: Well, in my opinion, there is no problem at all if you embark upon this refutation and proof. Have no concern on my account.

242c

ST: Come now, where should one begin this audacious discourse? Indeed, my boy, I think that there is a certain inevitable path for us to follow.

μή πη τετραγαμένοι μὲν ὧμεν περὶ ταῦτα, ῥαδίως δ' ἀλλήλοις ὁμολογῶμεν ὡς εὐκρινῶς ἔχοντες. ΘΕΑΙ. λέγε σαφέστερον ὃ λέγεις. ΞΕ. εὐκόλως μοι δοκεῖ Παρμενίδης ἡμῖν διειλέχθαι καὶ πᾶς ὅστις πῶποτε ἐπὶ κρίσιν ὥρμησε τοῦ τὰ ὄντα διορίσασθαι πόσα τε καὶ ποῖά ἐστιν. ΘΕΑΙ. πῆ; ΞΕ. μῦθόν τινα ἕκαστος φαίνεται μοι διηγέσθαι παισὶν ὡς οὔσιν ἡμῖν, ὁ μὲν ὡς τρία τὰ ὄντα, πολεμεῖ δὲ ἀλλήλοις

TT: What is it?

ST: We should first investigate the matters that seem clear to us now, in case we have somehow been confused about them, and yet agree with one another as readily as though we had a good understanding.

TT: Explain your meaning more clearly.

ST: It seems to me that Parmenides has conversed with us quite casually, and so has anyone who has ever set about specifying how many, and of what sort, are things that are.

TT: In what way?

242d

ST: Each of them appears to me to be telling us a story, as though we were children. One says that things that are, are threefold, and some of them on occasion conduct some sort of battle with one another, and at other times become friends, marry, have children and look after their offspring. Another says there are two factors, wet and dry or hot and cold, and he sets up a household for them and marries them off, while we Eleatic folk, beginning with Xenophanes or even earlier, recount our stories as though what we refer to as 'all things' are actually one. But some Ionian and, later, some Sicilian Muses consider it safest to combine both stories, and say that what is, is both many and one, and is held together by enmity and friendship.¹¹ "Though it is separating, it is continually combining", say the more severe of these Muses.¹² But the milder ones relaxed the requirement that it always be this way, and they say that it alternates, and that the all is sometimes one and is friendly on account of Aphrodite, at other times it is many and at war with itself due to some strife. Now, some of these men may have spoken the truth in all this, or they may not, though it is difficult and problematic to attribute such a serious failing to famous men of old. But we can say one thing without reproach.

ἐνίστε αὐτῶν ἅττα πη, τοτὲ δὲ καὶ φίλα γιγνόμενα γάμους τε καὶ τόκους καὶ τροφὰς τῶν ἐκγόνων παρέχεται· δύο δὲ ἕτερος εἰπών, ὕγρὸν καὶ ξηρὸν ἢ θερμὸν καὶ ψυχρὸν, συνοικίζει τε αὐτὰ καὶ ἐκδίδωσι· τὸ δὲ παρ' ἡμῖν Ἑλεατικὸν ἔθνος, ἀπὸ Ξενοφάνους τε καὶ ἔτι πρόσθεν ἀρξάμενον, ὡς ἐνὸς ὄντος τῶν πάντων καλουμένων οὕτω διεξέρχεται τοῖς μύθοις. Ἰάδες δὲ καὶ Σικελαὶ τινες ὕστερον Μοῦσαι συνενόησαν ὅτι συμπλέκειν

242e

TT: What is it?

ἀσφαλέστατον ἀμφοτέρω καὶ λέγειν ὡς τὸ ὄν πολλά τε καὶ ἓν ἐστίν, ἔχθρα δὲ καὶ φιλία συνέχεται. ΞΕ. διαφερόμενον γὰρ αἰεὶ συμφέρεται, φασὶν αἱ συντονώτεραι τῶν Μουσῶν· αἱ δὲ μαλακώτεραι τὸ μὲν αἰεὶ

ταῦτα οὕτως ἔχειν ἐχάλασαν, ἐν μέρει δὲ τοτὲ μὲν ἐν εἰναί φασι τὸ πᾶν καὶ φίλον ὑπ’

ST: That they have shown no regard for common folk, and they despise us. For each of them pursues his own line of argument without considering at all whether we are following what they say or are being left behind.

TT: What do you mean?

243a

ST: Whenever one of them speaks and says that many or one or two is, or has become, or is becoming; or again, that heat is mixed with cold; or elsewhere proposes divisions and combinations; by the gods, Theaetetus, can you ever understand what they are saying? Indeed, when I was younger and someone mentioned what is not – the phrase that is puzzling us now – I thought I understood perfectly. But you see now just how perplexed we are about this issue.

ἀφροδίτης, τοτὲ δὲ πολλὰ καὶ πολέμιον αὐτὸ αὐτῷ διὰ νεϊκός τι. ταῦτα δὲ πάντα εἰ μὲν ἀληθῶς τις ἢ μὴ τούτων εἴρηκε, χαλεπὸν καὶ πλημμελὲς οὕτω μεγάλα κλεινοῖς καὶ παλαιοῖς ἀνδράσιν ἐπιτιμᾶν· ἐκεῖνο δὲ ἀνεπίφθονον ἀποφήνασθαι— ΘΕΑΙ. τὸ ποῖον; ΞΕ. ὅτι λίαν τῶν πολλῶν ἡμῶν ὑπεριδόντες ὠλιγώρησαν· οὐδὲν γὰρ φροντίσαντες εἴτ’ ἐπακολουθοῦμεν αὐτοῖς λέγουσιν

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TT: I see.

εἴτε ἀπολειπόμεθα, περαίνουσι τὸ σφέτερον αὐτῶν ἕκαστοι. ΘΕΑΙ. πῶς λέγεις; ΞΕ. ὅταν τις αὐτῶν φθέγγηται λέγων ὡς ἔστιν ἢ γέγονεν ἢ γίγνεται πολλὰ ἢ ἐν ἢ δύο, καὶ θερμὸν αὖ ψυχρῷ συγκεραννύμενον, ἄλλοθι πη διακρίσεις καὶ συγκρίσεις ὑποτιθεῖς, τούτων, ὧς Θεαίτητε, ἐκάστοτε σύ τι πρὸς θεῶν συνίης ὅτι λέγουσιν; ἐγὼ μὲν γὰρ ὅτε μὲν ἦν νεώτερος, τοῦτό τε τὸ νῦν ἀπορούμενον ὁπότε τις εἴποι, τὸ μὴ ὄν, ἀκριβῶς ὥμην συνιέναι. νῦν δὲ ὁρᾷς ἵν’ ἐσμὲν αὐτοῦ πέραν τῆς ἀπορίας.

ST: But when it comes to 'what is', the soul may well be in the grip of a similar predicament. We profess to be unconcerned about this and to understand this and not the other whenever someone mentions it, yet we may be equally perplexed about both.

243c

TT: Quite likely.

ΘΕΑΙ. ὁρῶ. ΞΕ. τάχα τοίνυν ἴσως οὐχ ἦττον κατὰ τὸ ὄν ταῦτόν τοῦτο πάθος εἰληφότερες ἐν τῇ ψυχῇ περὶ μὲν τοῦτο εὐπορεῖν φαμεν καὶ μανθάνειν ὁπόταν τις αὐτὸ φθέγγηται, περὶ δὲ θάτερον οὐ, πρὸς ἀμφοτέρω ὁμοίως ἔχοντες. ΘΕΑΙ. ἴσως. ΞΕ. καὶ περὶ τῶν ἄλλων δὴ τῶν προειρημένων ἡμῖν ταῦτόν τοῦτο εἰρήσθω. ΘΕΑΙ. πάνν γε. ΞΕ. τῶν μὲν τοίνυν πολλῶν πέρι καὶ μετὰ τοῦτο σκεψόμεθ’,

ST: And, indeed, the same may be said of anything else we discussed previously.

TT: Yes, indeed.

243d

ST: Well, we shall consider all those other matters later on, if you wish. But we must now investigate the important, fundamental and primary issue.

ἂν δόξη, περὶ δὲ τοῦ μεγίστου τε καὶ ἀρχηγοῦ πρώτου νῦν σκεπτέον. ΘΕΑΙ. τίνας δὴ λέγεις; ἢ δήλον ὅτι τὸ ὄν φῆς πρώτον δεῖν διερευνήσασθαι τί ποθ’ οἱ λέγοντες αὐτὸ δηλοῦν ἡγοῦνται; ΞΕ. κατὰ πόδα γε, ὧ Θεαίτητε, ὑπέλαβες. λέγω γὰρ δὴ ταύτη δεῖν ποιεῖσθαι τὴν μέθοδον ἡμᾶς, οἷον αὐτῶν παρόντων ἀναπυθνομένων ὧδε· φέρε, ὁποῖοι θερμὸν καὶ ψυχρὸν ἢ τινε δύο τοιοῦτω τὰ πάντ’ εἶναι φατε, τί ποτε

TT: Which one do you mean? Or is it obvious that you are saying that we must first examine 'what is', and what exactly those who use the phrase think that it indicates?

ST: You have understood precisely, Theaetetus. For I am saying that this is indeed the approach we should adopt. We should resort to close

questioning, as though the men were actually present, and say, "Come on, all you who say that hot and cold, or any pairs like that, are all things. What precisely are you attributing to both when you say that both are and each is? What should we understand by this 'is' of yours? Is it a third factor in addition to the other two, and should we propose on your behalf that the all is no longer two but three? For presumably you do not take one of the pair and call it being, and say that both of them equally 'are', for in either case they would effectively be one and not two."

243e

TT: What you say is true.

ἄρα τοῦτ' ἐπ' ἀμφοῖν φθέγγεσθε, λέγοντες ἄμφω καὶ ἐκάτερον εἶναι; τί τὸ εἶναι τοῦτο ὑπολάβωμεν ὑμῶν; πότερον τρίτον παρὰ τὰ δύο ἐκεῖνα, καὶ τρία τὸ πᾶν ἀλλὰ μὴ δύο ἔτι καθ' ὑμᾶς τιθῶμεν; οὐ γάρ που τοῖν γε δυοῖν καλοῦντες θάτερον ὃν ἀμφοτέρω ὁμοίως εἶναι λέγετε· σχεδὸν γὰρ ἂν ἀμφοτέρως ἔν, ἀλλ' οὐ δύο εἴτην. ΘΕΑΙ. ἀληθῆ λέγεις. ΞΕ. ἀλλ' ἄρά γε τὰ ἄμφω βούλεσθε καλεῖν ὄν; ΘΕΑΙ. ἴσως.

ST: "Well then, do you want to call the pair of them being?"

TT: Perhaps.

244a

ST: Then we shall say, "But, friends, even with this formulation you would be stating unambiguously that the two are one."

ΞΕ. ἀλλ', ὦ φίλοι, φήσομεν, κἂν οὕτω τὰ δύο λέγοιτ' ἂν σαφέστατα ἔν. ΘΕΑΙ. ὀρθότατα εἴρηκας. ΞΕ. ἐπειδὴ τοίνυν ἡμεῖς ἡπορήκαμεν, ὑμεῖς αὐτὰ ἡμῖν ἐμφανίζετε ἱκανῶς, τί ποτε βούλεσθε σημαίνειν ὁπότεν ὃν φθέγγησθε. δῆλον γὰρ ὡς ὑμεῖς μὲν ταῦτα πάλοι γινώσκετε, ἡμεῖς δὲ πρὸ τοῦ μὲν ὠόμεθα, νῦν δ' ἡπορήκαμεν. διδάσκετε οὖν πρῶτον τοῦτ' αὐτὸ ἡμᾶς, ἵνα μὴ δοξάζωμεν μανθάνειν μὲν τὰ λεγόμενα παρ' ὑμῶν, τὸ δὲ

TT: What you have said is absolutely correct.

ST: "Now, since we have become perplexed, you must clarify adequately, to our satisfaction, what precisely you wish to indicate whenever you use the word 'being'. For you have obviously known this all along, while we thought that we knew at one stage but have now become perplexed. So, explain this point to us first so that we may not presume to understand your doctrines when the very opposite is the case." Surely there would be nothing wrong, child, in saying these things, and putting them to these men, and to anyone else who maintains that all is more than one?

244b

TT: Not in the least.

τούτου γίγνηται πᾶν τούναντίον. ταῦτα δὴ λέγοντές τε καὶ ἀξιούντες παρὰ τε τούτων καὶ παρὰ τῶν ἄλλων ὅσοι πλεῖον ἐνὸς λέγουσι τὸ πᾶν εἶναι, μὴν, ὦ παῖ, τί πλημμελήσομεν; ΘΕΑΙ. ἥκιστα γε. ΞΕ. τί δέ; παρὰ τῶν ἐν τὸ πᾶν λεγόντων ἄρ' οὐ πευστέον εἰς δύναμιν τί ποτε λέγουσι τὸ ὄν; ΘΕΑΙ. πῶς γὰρ οὐ; ΞΕ. τόδε τοίνυν ἀποκρινέσθων. ἐν πού φατε μόνον εἶναι; — φαμέν γάρ, φήσουσιν. ἦ γάρ; ΘΕΑΙ. ναί. ΞΕ. τί δέ; ὄν καλεῖτέ τι; ΘΕΑΙ. ναί.

ST: And what about those who say that the all is one? Shouldn't we find out, as best we can, what precisely they mean by 'being'?

TT: How could we do otherwise?

ST: Then let them answer this question. "Do you say that one alone is?" To which they will reply, "We do say so", won't they?

TT: Yes.

ST: "And is there something which you call being?"

TT: Yes.

244c

ST: "And is it what you call one? Are you using two names for the same thing, or how does this work?"

ΞΕ. πότερον ὅπερ ἔν, ἐπὶ τῷ αὐτῷ προσχρώμενοι δυοῖν ὀνόμασιν, ἢ πῶς; ΘΕΑΙ. τίς οὖν αὐτοῖς ἢ μετὰ τοῦτ', ὧ ξένη, ἀποκρισῖς; ΞΕ. δῆλον, ὧ Θεαίτητε, ὅτι τῷ ταύτην τὴν ὑπόθεσιν ὑποθεμένῳ πρὸς τὸ νῦν ἐρωτηθὲν καὶ πρὸς ἄλλο δὲ ὅτιοῦν οὐ πάντων ῥᾶστον ἀποκρίνασθαι. ΘΕΑΙ. πῶς; ΞΕ. τό τε δύο ὀνόματα ὁμολογεῖν εἶναι μὴδὲν θέμενον πλὴν ἓν καταγέλαστόν που. ΘΕΑΙ. πῶς δ' οὐ; ΞΕ. καὶ τὸ παράπαν γε ἀποδέχεσθαι τοῦ λέγοντος ὥς

TT: What answer will they give next, stranger?

ST: Obviously, Theaetetus, it is not at all easy for someone who has proposed this hypothesis to respond to what we have just asked, or any other question for that matter.

TT: Why so?

244d

ST: Well, to agree that there are two names when you have proposed that there is nothing except one, is presumably ridiculous.

ἔστιν ὄνομα τι, λόγον οὐκ ἂν ἔχον. ΘΕΑΙ. πῆ; ΞΕ. τιθεῖς τε τοῦνομα τοῦ πράγματος ἕτερον δύο λέγει πού τινε. ΘΕΑΙ. ναί. ΞΕ. καὶ μὴν ἂν ταυτόν γε αὐτῷ τιθῇ τοῦνομα, ἢ μηδενὸς ὄνομα ἀναγκασθήσεται λέγειν, εἰ δέ τινος αὐτὸ φήσῃ, συμβήσεται τὸ ὄνομα ὀνόματος ὄνομα μόνον, ἄλλου δὲ οὐδενὸς ὄν. ΘΕΑΙ. οὕτως. ΞΕ. καὶ τὸ ἔν γε, ἐνὸς ὄνομα ὄν καὶ τοῦ ὀνόματος αὖ τὸ ἐν ὄν. ΘΕΑΙ. ἀνάγκη. ΞΕ. τί δέ; τὸ ὅλον ἕτερον τοῦ ὄντος ἐνὸς ἢ ταυτόν φήσουσι τούτῳ;

TT: Yes, it must be.

ST: And it would be altogether ridiculous to accept the assertion that there is a name, when it does not possess an account.

TT: What is ridiculous about it?

ST: Well, in proposing that the name is different from the object, he is presumably referring to two things.

TT: Yes.

ST: And, indeed, should he propose that the name is the same as the object, he will either be compelled to say that it is the name of nothing, or he will say it is the name of something, and the name will turn out to be the name of a name and of nothing else.

TT: Just so.

ST: And the one will be the name of one, as there is only one, and also the one of the name.

TT: It must be.

244e

ST: What about this? Is the whole different from what is one, or will they say it is the same as this?

ΘΕΑΙ. πῶς γὰρ οὐ φήσουσί τε καὶ φασίν; ΞΕ. εἰ τοίνυν ὅλον ἐστίν, ὥσπερ καὶ Παρμενίδης λέγει, πάντοθεν εὐκύκλου σφαίρης ἐναλίγκιον ὄγκῳ, μεσσοῦθεν ἰσοπαλὲς πάντῃ τὸ γὰρ οὔτε τι μείζονοῦτε τι βαιότερον πελέναι χρεόν ἐστι τῇ ἢ τῇ, τοιοῦτόν γε ὄν τὸ ὄν μέσον τε καὶ ἔσχατα ἔχει, ταῦτα δὲ ἔχον πᾶσα ἀνάγκη μέρη ἔχειν· ἢ πῶς; ΘΕΑΙ. οὕτως.

TT: They will have to say it is the same, and they do say so.

ST: If it is a whole, and is, as Parmenides says, equally balanced in all directions from the centre, like the mass of a well-rounded sphere, for it must not be more in one place and less in another. Then, since what is is like this, what is will have a centre and extremities. And since it has these, it certainly must have parts, must it not?

245a

TT: So it must.

ΞΕ. ἀλλὰ μὴν τό γε μεμερισμένον πάθος μὲν τοῦ ἐνὸς ἔχειν ἐπὶ τοῖς μέρεσι πᾶσιν οὐδὲν ἀποκωλύει, καὶ ταύτῃ δὴ πᾶν τε ὄν καὶ ὅλον ἐν εἶναι. ΘΕΑΙ. τί δ' οὐ; ΞΕ. τὸ δὲ πεπονθὸς ταῦτα ἄρ' οὐκ ἀδύνατον αὐτό γε τὸ ἐν αὐτὸ εἶναι; ΘΕΑΙ. πῶς; ΞΕ. ἀμερὲς δήπου δεῖ παντελῶς τό γε ἀληθῶς ἐν κατὰ τὸν ὁρθὸν λόγον εἰρῆσθαι. ΘΕΑΙ. δεῖ γὰρ οὖν.

ST: Moreover, there is nothing to prevent whatever is divided into parts from having the characteristic of the one associated with all its parts, and in this way, being all, it could also be one whole.

TT: Why not, indeed?

ST: But isn't it impossible for something with these characteristics to be just the one itself?

TT: How?

ST: Presumably what is truly one must be described as entirely without parts, according to the correct account.

TT: Yes, it must be.

245b

ST: But the sort of one which consists of many parts will not accord with this account.

ΞΕ. τὸ δέ γε τοιοῦτον ἐκ πολλῶν μερῶν ὃν οὐ συμφωνήσει τῷ ὅλῳ λόγῳ. ΘΕΑΙ. μανθάνω. ΞΕ. πότερον δὴ πάθος ἔχον τὸ ὃν τοῦ ἐνὸς οὕτως ἔν τε ἔσται καὶ ὅλον, ἢ παντάπασι μὴ λέγωμεν ὅλον εἶναι τὸ ὃν; ΘΕΑΙ. χαλεπὴν προβέβληκας αἴρεσιν. ΞΕ. ἀληθέστατα μέντοι λέγεις. πεπονθός τε γὰρ τὸ ὃν ἐν εἶναί πως οὐ ταῦτὸν ὃν τῷ ἐνὶ φανεῖται, καὶ πλεονα δὴ τὰ πάντα ἐνὸς ἔσται. ΘΕΑΙ. ναί.

TT: I understand.

ST: Now will 'what is' be both one and whole, as it possesses the character of the one, or should we utterly deny that 'what is' is a whole?

TT: That's a difficult choice you are offering.

ST: Well, that is certainly true. For 'what is', having been somehow characterised as one, will appear not to be the same as the one, and so all things will be more than one.

TT: Yes.

245c

ST: However, if 'what is' is not a whole on account of being characterised as one, and yet the whole itself is, then 'what is' turns out to be missing part of itself.

ΞΕ. καὶ μὴν ἓάν γε τὸ ὄν ἢ μὴ ὅλον διὰ τὸ πεπονθέναι τὸ ὑπ' ἐκείνου πάθος, ἢ δὲ αὐτὸ τὸ ὅλον, ἐνδεὲς τὸ ὄν ἑαυτοῦ συμβαίνει. ΘΕΑΙ. πάνυ γε. ΞΕ. καὶ κατὰ τοῦτον δὴ τὸν λόγον ἑαυτοῦ στερόμενον οὐκ ὄν ἔσται τὸ ὄν. ΘΕΑΙ. οὕτως. ΞΕ. καὶ ἐνός γε αὖ πλείω τὰ πάντα γίγνεται, τοῦ τε ὄντος καὶ τοῦ ὅλου χωρὶς ἰδίαν ἐκατέρου φύσιν εἰληφότος. ΘΕΑΙ. ναί. ΞΕ. μὴ ὄντος δέ γε τὸ παράπαν τοῦ ὅλου, ταῦτά τε

TT: Certainly.

ST: And based upon this argument, 'what is' will be non-being, as it is deprived of itself.

TT: Just so.

ST: Furthermore, all things become more than one, as both 'what is' and the whole have each acquired a separate, distinct nature.

TT: Yes.

245d

ST: But if the whole is not at all, then the very same applies to 'what is', and so in addition to its not being, it could never come into being either.

ταῦτα ὑπάρχει τῷ ὄντι, καὶ πρὸς τῷ μὴ εἶναι μὴδ' ἂν γενέσθαι ποτὲ ὄν. ΘΕΑΙ. τί δή; ΞΕ. τὸ γινόμενον αἰεὶ γέγονεν ὅλον· ὥστε οὔτε οὐσίαν οὔτε γένεσιν ὥς οὔσαν δεῖ προσαγορεύειν τὸ ἐν ἢ τὸ ὅλον ἐν τοῖς οὔσι μὴ τιθέντα. ΘΕΑΙ. παντάπασιν ἔοικε ταῦθ' οὕτως ἔχειν. ΞΕ. καὶ μὴν οὐδ' ὅποσονοῦν τι δεῖ τὸ μὴ ὅλον εἶναι· ποσόν τι γὰρ ὄν, ὅπόσον ἂν ἢ, τοσοῦτον ὅλον ἀναγκαῖον αὐτὸ εἶναι. ΘΕΑΙ. κομιδῇ γε. ΞΕ. καὶ τοίνυν ἄλλα μυρία ἀπεράντους ἀπορίας ἕκαστον

TT: Why so?

ST: Whatever has come to be has always come to be as a whole. Consequently, we cannot talk about being or becoming as if they are

without including the one or the whole among things that are.

TT: That certainly seems to be the case.

ST: And, indeed, whatever is not a whole cannot be something with any number at all. For if it had number, whatever that number might be, it would have to correspond to that number as a whole.

TT: Precisely.

245e

ST: And, indeed, a myriad of other issues, each involving endless perplexities, will present themselves to anyone who maintains that 'what is' is either some two or only one.

εἰληφὸς φανεῖται τῷ τὸ ὄν εἶτε δύο τινὲ εἶτε ἓν μόνον εἶναι λέγοντι. ΘΕΑΙ. δηλοῖ σχεδὸν καὶ τὰ νῦν ὑποφαίνοντα· συνάπτεται γὰρ ἕτερον ἐξ ἄλλου, μείζω καὶ χαλεπωτέραν φέρον περὶ τῶν ἔμπροσθεν ἀεὶ ῥηθέντων πλάνην. ΞΕ. τοὺς μὲν τοίνυν διακριβολουμένους ὄντος τε πέρι καὶ μή, πάντας μὲν οὐ διεληλύθαμεν, ὅμως δὲ ἱκανῶς ἐχέτω· τοὺς δὲ ἄλλως λέγοντας αὖ θεατέον, ἵν' ἐκ πάντων ἴδωμεν

TT: Yes, the issues that are now arising make this quite evident. One leads on to another, bringing a larger and more problematic lack of direction to whatever has already been said.

246a

ST: Now, we have not talked about everyone who gives a precise account of being and non-being, but let this be enough. Next, we should consider those who give a more general account, so that we may see, by reviewing them all, that it is no easier to say precisely what 'what is' is than to say what 'what is not' is.

ὅτι τὸ ὄν τοῦ μὴ ὄντος οὐδὲν εὐπορώτερον εἰπεῖν ὅτι ποτ' ἔστιν. ΘΕΑΙ. οὐκοῦν πορεύεσθαι χρὴ καὶ ἐπὶ τούτους. ΞΕ. καὶ μὴν ἔοικέ γε ἓν αὐτοῖς οἷον γιγαντομαχία τις εἶναι διὰ τὴν ἀμφισβήτησιν περὶ τῆς οὐσίας πρὸς ἀλλήλους. ΘΕΑΙ. πῶς; ΞΕ. οἱ μὲν εἰς γῆν ἐξ οὐρανοῦ καὶ τοῦ ἀοράτου πάντα ἔλκουσι, ταῖς χερσὶν ἀτεχνῶς πέτρας καὶ δρυὲς περιλαμβάνοντες.

τῶν γὰρ τοιούτων ἐφαπτόμενοι πάντων δισχυρίζονται τοῦτο εἶναι μόνον ὃ παρέχει προσβολὴν καὶ ἐπαφήν

TT: Yes, we should proceed to consider these too.

ST: And, indeed, there seems to be a sort of battle between gods and giants among them in their dispute with one another about being.¹³

TT: How?

246b

ST: Well, some are dragging everything from heaven and the unseen down to earth, literally grabbing trees and rocks in their hands. Indeed, they lay hold of all such objects and strenuously maintain that that alone is, which gives rise to some contact and touch. They define body and being as the same, and if any of the others say that there is anything without a body, they are utterly contemptuous and they want to hear no more.

τινα, ταῦτ' ὃν σῶμα καὶ οὐσίαν ὀριζόμενοι, τῶν δὲ ἄλλων εἴ τίς τι φήσει μὴ σῶμα ἔχον εἶναι, καταφρονοῦντες τὸ παράπαν καὶ οὐδὲν ἐθέλοντες ἄλλο ἀκούειν. ΘΕΑΙ. ἦ δεινούς εἴρηκας ἄνδρας· ἤδη γὰρ καὶ ἐγὼ τούτων συχνοῖς προσέτυχον. ΞΕ. τοιγαροῦν οἱ πρὸς αὐτοὺς ἀμφισβητοῦντες μάλα εὐλαβῶς ἄνωθεν ἐξ ἀοράτου ποθὲν ἀμύνονται, νοητὰ ἄττα καὶ ἀσώματα εἶδη βιαζόμενοι τὴν ἀληθινὴν οὐσίαν εἶναι· τὰ δὲ ἐκείνων σώματα καὶ τὴν λεγομένην ὑπ' αὐτῶν ἀλήθειαν

TT: Yes, you are describing fearsome men, and indeed I myself have met many of them before.

246c

ST: Yes. That's why those who oppose them conduct their defence very cautiously, from above, from the unseen, maintaining forcibly that true being consists of certain bodiless forms which can be known by reason. And they gradually break the bodies of those other men into little pieces in their discussions, and what the others maintain to be true they refer to as a sort of becoming in motion, rather than being.

And there is always a huge battle going on between both parties about these issues, Theaetetus.

κατὰ σμικρὰ διαθραύοντες ἐν τοῖς λόγοις γένεσιν ἀντ' οὐσίας φερομένην τινὰ προσαγορεύουσιν. ἐν μέσῳ δὲ περὶ ταῦτα ἄπλετος ἀμφοτέρων μάχη τις, ᾧ Θεαίτητε, ἀεὶ συνέστηκεν. ΘΕΑΙ. ἀληθῆ. ΞΕ. παρ' ἀμφοῖν τοίνυν τοῖν γενοῖν κατὰ μέρος λάβωμεν λόγον ὑπὲρ ἧς τίθενται τῆς οὐσίας. ΘΕΑΙ. πῶς οὖν δὴ ληψόμεθα; ΞΕ. παρὰ μὲν τῶν ἐν εἴδεσιν αὐτὴν τιθεμένων ῥᾶον, ἡμερώτεροι γάρ· παρὰ δὲ τῶν εἰς σῶμα πάντα ἐλκόντων

TT: True.

ST: Then let's obtain, from both sides in turn, the account of being that they favour.

TT: How shall we obtain them?

246d

ST: It will be easier in the case of those who propose that being consists of forms, for they are gentler people. However, it is more difficult, perhaps almost impossible, from those who drag everything by force to the physical. But I think they should be dealt with as follows.

βίᾳ χαλεπώτερον, ἴσως δὲ καὶ σχεδὸν ἀδύνατον. ἀλλ' ὧδέ μοι δεῖν δοκεῖ περὶ αὐτῶν δρᾶν. ΘΕΑΙ. πῶς; ΞΕ. μάλιστα μὲν, εἴ πῃ δυνατὸν ἦν, ἔργῳ βελτίους αὐτοὺς ποιεῖν· εἰ δὲ τοῦτο μὴ ἐγχωρεῖ, λόγῳ ποιῶμεν, ὑποτιθέμενοι νομιμώτερον αὐτοὺς ἢ νῦν ἐθέλοντας ἂν ἀποκρίνασθαι. τὸ γὰρ ὁμολογηθὲν παρὰ βελτιόνων που κυριώτερον ἢ τὸ παρὰ χειρόνων· ἡμεῖς δὲ οὐ τούτων φροντίζομεν, ἀλλὰ τάληθές ζητοῦμεν.

TT: How?

ST: The best thing would be to make better people of them, if that were somehow possible. But if this is not to be, let's make up a story, assuming that they would be willing to answer questions more fully than now. For agreement with reformed individuals will be preferable

to agreement with worse. However, we are not interested in the people themselves. We are seeking the truth.

246e

TT: Quite so.

ΘΕΑΙ. ὀρθότατα. ΞΕ. κέλευε δὴ τοὺς βελτίους γεγονότας ἀποκρίνασθαί σοι, καὶ τὸ λεχθὲν παρ' αὐτῶν ἀφερμήνευε. ΘΕΑΙ. ταῦτ' ἔσται. ΞΕ. λεγόντων δὴ θνητὸν ζῶον εἶ φασιν εἶναι τι. ΘΕΑΙ. πῶς δ' οὐ; ΞΕ. τοῦτο δὲ οὐ σῶμα ἔμψυχον ὁμολογοῦσιν; ΘΕΑΙ. πάνυ γε. ΞΕ. τιθέντες τι τῶν ὄντων ψυχὴν;

ST: Then call upon these reformed folk to answer you, and you should interpret what is said.

TT: I shall.

ST: Well, let them say whether they maintain there is such a thing as a mortal, living being.

TT: How could they deny this?

ST: And won't they agree that this is a body with a soul in it?

TT: Yes, certainly.

247a

ST: And do they include soul among things that are?

ΘΕΑΙ. ναί. ΞΕ. τί δέ; ψυχὴν οὐ τὴν μὲν δικαίαν, τὴν δὲ ἄδικόν φασιν εἶναι, καὶ τὴν μὲν φρόνιμον, τὴν δὲ ἄφρονα; ΘΕΑΙ. τί μὴν; ΞΕ. ἀλλ' οὐ δικαιοσύνης ἔξει καὶ παρουσίᾳ τοιαύτην αὐτῶν ἐκάστην γίγνεσθαι, καὶ τῶν ἐναντίων τὴν ἐναντίαν; ΘΕΑΙ. ναί, καὶ ταῦτα σύμφασιν. ΞΕ. ἀλλὰ μὴν τό γε δυνατόν τῳ παραγίγνεσθαι καὶ ἀπογίγνεσθαι πάντως εἶναι τι φήσουσιν. ΘΕΑΙ. φασὶ μὲν οὖν.

TT: Yes.

ST: What about this? Don't they agree that a soul can be just or unjust, and can be wise or ignorant?

TT: Of course.

ST: But isn't it from the possession and presence of justice and wisdom that each of these souls becomes like this, while their opposites do the opposite?

TT: Yes, they agree with all this too.

ST: And they will surely agree that whatever is capable of being present or absent is something.

TT: They do say so.

247b

ST: So, if they accept that there is justice, wisdom and excellence in general, and their opposites, and also soul in which they arise, do they say that any of these is visible and tangible, or are they all unseen?

ΞΕ. οὔσης οὖν δικαιοσύνης καὶ φρονήσεως καὶ τῆς ἄλλης ἀρετῆς καὶ τῶν ἐναντίων, καὶ δὴ καὶ ψυχῆς ἐν ᾗ ταῦτα ἐγγίγνεται, πότερον ὁρατὸν καὶ ἀπτόν εἶναι φασί τι αὐτῶν ἢ πάντα ἀόρατα; ΘΕΑΙ. σχεδὸν οὐδὲν τούτων γε ὁρατόν. ΞΕ. τί δὲ τῶν τοιούτων; μὴν σῶμά τι λέγουσιν ἴσχειν; ΘΕΑΙ. τοῦτο οὐκέτι κατὰ ταῦτα ἀποκρίνονται πᾶν, ἀλλὰ τὴν μὲν ψυχὴν αὐτὴν δοκεῖν σφίσι σῶμά τι κεκτηῖσθαι, φρόνησιν δὲ καὶ τῶν ἄλλων ἕκαστον ὧν ἡρώτηκας, αἰσχύονται

TT: Hardly any of these is visible.

ST: What about this? Do they say that anything of this sort has a body?

TT: They do not answer the entire question in the same way. Although they think that the soul has acquired a body of some sort, when it comes to wisdom and the other qualities you asked about, they are ashamed either to admit that these are not included among things that are, or to maintain emphatically that they are all physical.

247c

ST: Well, Theaetetus, we can see that these men have been reformed. For the original stock, their earth-born ancestors, would not have been ashamed of anything. Instead, they would insist that whatever they are unable to squeeze with their hands is nothing at all.

τὸ τολμᾶν ἢ μηδὲν τῶν ὄντων αὐτὰ ὁμολογεῖν ἢ πάντ' εἶναι σώματα διισχυρίζεσθαι. ΞΕ. σαφῶς γὰρ ἡμῖν, ὦ Θεαίτητε, βελτίους γεγόνασιν ἄνδρες· ἐπεὶ τούτων οὐδ' ἂν ἐν ἐπαισχυνηθεῖεν οἱ γε αὐτῶν σπαρτοὶ τε καὶ αὐτόχθονες, ἀλλὰ διατείνονται ἂν πᾶν ὃ μὴ δυνατοὶ ταῖς χερσὶ συμπιέζειν εἰσίν, ὥς ἄρα τοῦτο οὐδὲν τὸ παράπαν ἐστίν. ΘΕΑΙ. σχεδὸν οἷα διανοοῦνται λέγεις. ΞΕ. πάλιν τοίνυν ἀνερωτῶμεν αὐτούς· εἰ γάρ τι καὶ

TT: Yes, you have expressed their attitude fairly well.

247d

ST: Then let's question them once more. Indeed, if they are prepared to concede that there is even a small non-physical portion of things that are, that is sufficient. For they must explain the shared nature that has arisen simultaneously in the non-physical, and also in anything physical, with reference to which they say that they both are. Perhaps this may leave them perplexed. And if that is what happens to them, then consider this. Would they be willing to accept a suggestion from us and agree that 'what is' is as follows?

σμικρὸν ἐθέλουσι τῶν ὄντων συγχωρεῖν ἄσώματον, ἐξαρκεῖ. τὸ γὰρ ἐπὶ τε τούτοις ἅμα καὶ ἐπ' ἐκείνοις ὅσα ἔχει σῶμα συμφυὲς γεγονός, εἰς ὃ βλέποντες ἀμφοτέρω εἶναι λέγουσι, τοῦτο αὐτοῖς ῥητέον. τάχ' οὖν ἴσως ἂν ἀποροῖεν· εἰ δὴ τι τοιοῦτον πεπόνθασι, σκόπει, προτεινομένων ἡμῶν, ἅρ' ἐθέλοιεν ἂν δέχεσθαι καὶ ὁμολογεῖν τοιόνδ' εἶναι τὸ ὄν. ΘΕΑΙ. τὸ ποῖον δὴ; λέγε, καὶ τάχα εἰσόμεθα. ΞΕ. λέγω δὴ τὸ καὶ ὅποιανοῦν τινα κεκτημένον δύναιμι

TT: What is the suggestion? Tell us and we shall know immediately.

247e

ST: Well, I am saying that anything actually is, once it has acquired some sort of power, either to affect anything else at all, or to be affected, even slightly, by something totally trivial, even if only once. Indeed, I propose to give a definition, defining things that are as nothing else except power.

εἴτ' εἰς τὸ ποιεῖν ἕτερον ὀτιοῦν πεφυκὸς εἴτ' εἰς τὸ παθεῖν καὶ σμικρότατον ὑπὸ τοῦ φαυλοτάτου, κἂν εἰ μόνον εἰς ἅπαξ, πᾶν τοῦτο ὄντως εἶναι· τίθεται γὰρ ὅρον ὀρίζειν τὰ ὄντα ὡς ἔστιν οὐκ ἄλλο τι πλὴν δύναμις. ΘΕΑΙ. ἀλλ' ἐπεὶπερ αὐτοὶ γε οὐκ ἔχουσιν ἐν τῷ παρόντι τούτου βέλτιον λέγειν, δέχονται τοῦτο. ΞΕ. καλῶς· ἴσως γὰρ ἂν εἰς ὕστερον ἡμῖν τε καὶ τούτοις

TT: Then, since they do not have anything better to suggest right now, they accept this.

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ST: Very well, though perhaps a different suggestion may occur both to us or them later. For the present, let this stand as it has been agreed by both parties.

ἕτερον ἂν φανείη. πρὸς μὲν οὖν τούτους τοῦτο ἡμῖν ἐνταῦθα μενέτω συνομολογηθέν. ΘΕΑΙ. μένει. ΞΕ. πρὸς δὴ τοὺς ἑτέρους ἴωμεν, τοὺς τῶν εἰδῶν φίλους· σὺ δ' ἡμῖν καὶ τὰ παρὰ τούτων ἀφερμήνευε. ΘΕΑΙ. ταῦτ' ἔσται. ΞΕ. γένεσιν, τὴν δὲ οὐσίαν χωρὶς που διελόμενοι λέγετε; ἦ γάρ; ΘΕΑΙ. ναί. ΞΕ. καὶ σώματι μὲν ἡμᾶς γενέσει δι' αἰσθήσεως κοινωνεῖν, διὰ λογισμοῦ δὲ ψυχῇ πρὸς τὴν ὄντως οὐσίαν, ἣν αἰεὶ κατὰ ταῦτα ὡσαύτως ἔχειν φατέ, γένεσιν δὲ ἄλλοτε ἄλλως.

TT: Let it stand.

ST: Now, let us move on to the others, the friends of the forms, and you should interpret their doctrines for us too.

TT: I shall.

ST: "Presumably you make a distinction between becoming and being, and you refer to them as separate. Is this so?"

TT: "Yes."

ST: "And you say our communion with becoming is through the body, by means of sense perception, while it is by means of reasoning through the soul that we commune with actual being, which you say is always just the same as it is, while becoming is always changing."

248b

TT: "Yes. That is what we say."

ΘΕΑΙ. φαμέν γὰρ οὖν. ΞΕ. τὸ δὲ δὴ κοινωνεῖν, ὃ πάντων ἄριστοι, τί τοῦθ' ὑμᾶς ἐπ' ἀμφοῖν λέγειν φῶμεν; ἄρ' οὐ τὸ νυνδὴ παρ' ἡμῶν ῥηθέν; ΘΕΑΙ. τὸ ποῖον; ΞΕ. πάθημα ἢ ποίημα ἐκ δυνάμεώς τινος ἀπὸ τῶν πρὸς ἄλληλα συνιόντων γιγνόμενον. τάχ' οὖν, ὦ Θεαίτητε, αὐτῶν τὴν πρὸς ταῦτα ἀπόκρισιν σὺ μὲν οὐ κατακούεις, ἐγὼ δὲ ἴσως διὰ συνήθειαν. ΘΕΑΙ. τίν' οὖν δὴ λέγουσι λόγον;

ST: "Now, best of all men, the communing which you ascribe to both, isn't it what we mentioned a moment ago?"

TT: What was that?

ST: "An action or an effect arising from some power, from their coming together with one another." You probably do not hear their response to this so clearly, Theaetetus, but perhaps I can hear it, as I am quite familiar with them.

TT: What then? What account do they give?

248c

ST: They do not agree with what we said just now to the earth-born men about being.

ΞΕ. οὐ συγχωροῦσιν ἡμῖν τὸ νυνδὴ ῥηθέν πρὸς τοὺς γηγενεῖς οὐσίας πέρι. ΘΕΑΙ. τὸ ποῖον; ΞΕ. ἱκανὸν ἔθεμεν ὅρον που τῶν ὄντων, ὅταν τῷ παρῇ ἢ τοῦ πάσχειν ἢ δρᾶν καὶ πρὸς τὸ μικρότατον δύναμις; ΘΕΑΙ. ναί. ΞΕ. πρὸς δὴ ταῦτα τόδε λέγουσιν, ὅτι γενέσει μὲν μέτεστι τοῦ πάσχειν καὶ ποιεῖν δυνάμεως, πρὸς δὲ οὐσίαν τούτων οὐδετέρου τὴν δύναμιν ἀρμόττειν φασίν. ΘΕΑΙ. οὐκοῦν λέγουσί τι; ΞΕ. πρὸς ὃ γε λεκτέον ἡμῖν ὅτι δεόμεθα παρ' αὐτῶν

TT: What was that?

ST: We somehow proposed an adequate enough definition of things that are: whenever the power to be affected or to affect, even to the

slightest extent, is present in something, that something is something that is.

Tt: Yes.

St: Now to this they reply that the power to be affected and to affect is a feature of becoming, but they say that neither power attaches to being.

Tt: Don't they have a point?

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St: A point which makes us say that we still need to find out more clearly from them whether they also concede that the soul knows, and that being is known.

ἔτι πυθέσθαι σαφέστερον εἰ προσομολογοῦσι τὴν μὲν ψυχὴν γινώσκειν, τὴν δ' οὐσίαν γινώσκεσθαι. ΘΕΑΙ. φασὶ μὴν τοῦτό γε. ΞΕ. τί δέ; τὸ γινώσκειν ἢ τὸ γινώσκεσθαι φατε ποῖημα ἢ πάθος ἢ ἀμφοτέρων; ἢ τὸ μὲν πάθημα, τὸ δὲ θάτερον; ἢ παντάπασιν οὐδέτερον οὐδετέρου τούτων μεταλαμβάνειν; ΘΕΑΙ. δῆλον ὡς οὐδέτερον οὐδετέρου· τάναντία γὰρ ἂν τοῖς ἔμπροσθεν λέγοιεν. ΞΕ. μανθάνω· τόδε γε, ὡς τὸ γινώσκειν εἴπερ ἔσται

Tt: They will surely assent to that.

St: "What about this? Do you say that the knowing, or being known, is an action, an effect, or both? Or is one an action, and the other an effect? Or do neither of them have anything to do with action and effect?"

Tt: Obviously they would say neither, otherwise they would be contradicting what they said before.

248e

St: I understand. Instead, they would say that if knowing is indeed some action, it follows that whatever is known must, for its part, be affected. Indeed, based on this account, since being is known by the act

of knowing, insofar as it is known, it is changed to that extent because it is affected, which we insist does not happen to the quiescent.

ποιεῖν τι, τὸ γινωσκόμενον ἀναγκαῖον αὖ συμβαίνει πάσχειν. τὴν οὐσίαν δὴ κατὰ τὸν λόγον τοῦτον γινωσκομένην ὑπὸ τῆς γνώσεως, καθ' ὅσον γινώσκεται, κατὰ τοσοῦτον κινεῖσθαι διὰ τὸ πάσχειν, ὃ δὴ φάμεν οὐκ ἂν γενέσθαι περὶ τὸ ἡρεμοῦν. ΘΕΑΙ. ὀρθῶς. ΞΕ. τί δὲ πρὸς Διός; ὥς ἀληθῶς κίνησιν καὶ ζωὴν καὶ ψυχὴν καὶ φρόνησιν ἢ ῥαδίως πεισθησόμεθα τῷ παντελῶς

TT: Correct.

ST: But, by Zeus, what are we saying? Are we actually going to be persuaded so easily that change, life, soul and thought are absent from what altogether is, that it neither lives nor thinks, but abides unchanging, solemn and pure, devoid of intelligence?

249a

TT: No, stranger. That would be an awful proposition were we to accept it.

ὄντι μὴ παρεῖναι, μηδὲ ζῆν αὐτὸ μηδὲ φρονεῖν, ἀλλὰ σεμνὸν καὶ ἅγιον, νοῦν οὐκ ἔχον, ἀκίνητον ἐστὸς εἶναι; ΘΕΑΙ. δεινὸν μεντᾶν, ὦ ξέने, λόγον συγχωροῖμεν. ΞΕ. ἀλλὰ νοῦν μὲν ἔχειν, ζωὴν δὲ μὴ φῶμεν; ΘΕΑΙ. καὶ πῶς; ΞΕ. ἀλλὰ ταῦτα μὲν ἀμφοτέρω ἐνόντ' αὐτῷ λέγομεν, οὐ μὴν ἐν ψυχῇ γε φήσομεν αὐτὸ ἔχειν αὐτά; ΘΕΑΙ. καὶ τίς ἂν ἕτερον ἔχοι τρόπον; ΞΕ. ἀλλὰ δεῖτα νοῦν μὲν καὶ ζωὴν καὶ ψυχὴν ἔχειν, ἀκίνητον μέντοι τὸ παράπαν ἔμψυχον ὃν ἐστάναι;

ST: But would we say that it has intelligence, but does not have life?

TT: How could we?

ST: But if we say that both of these are within it, shall we then deny that it has them in a soul?

TT: How else could it have them?

249b

ST: But if it actually has intelligence, life and soul, does it remain totally unchanging, although it has a soul?

ΘΕΑΙ. πάντα ἔμοιγε ἄλογα ταῦτ' εἶναι φαίνεται. ΞΕ. καὶ τὸ κινούμενον δὴ καὶ κίνησιν συγχωρητέον ὥς ὄντα. ΘΕΑΙ. πῶς δ' οὐ; ΞΕ. συμβαίνει δ' οὖν, ὃ Θεαίτητε, ἀκινήτων τε ὄντων νοῦν μηδενὶ περὶ μηδενὸς εἶναι μηδαμοῦ. ΘΕΑΙ. κομιδῇ μὲν οὖν. ΞΕ. καὶ μὴν ἐὰν αὖ φερόμενα καὶ κινούμενα πάντ' εἶναι συγχωρῶμεν, καὶ τούτῳ τῷ λόγῳ ταῦτόν τοῦτο ἐκ τῶν ὄντων ἐξαίρησομεν. ΘΕΑΙ. πῶς; ΞΕ. τὸ κατὰ ταῦτά καὶ ὡσαύτως καὶ περὶ τὸ αὐτὸ δοκεῖ

TT: This all sounds unreasonable to me.

ST: And, of course, we must concede that change, and what is changed, both are.

TT: How could we deny it?

ST: It follows, therefore, Theaetetus, that if there is no change, there is no intelligence in anything, or about anything at all.

TT: Certainly.

249c

ST: And yet, if we concede instead that everything is moving and changing, by this argument too we shall be removing intelligence from things that are.

σοι χωρὶς στάσεως γενέσθαι ποτ' ἄν; ΘΕΑΙ. οὐδαμῶς. ΞΕ. τί δ'; ἄνευ τούτων νοῦν καθορᾶς ὄντα ἢ γενόμενον ἂν καὶ ὅπου οὖν; ΘΕΑΙ. ἤκιστα. ΞΕ. καὶ μὴν πρὸς γε τοῦτον παντὶ λόγῳ μαχετέον, ὃς ἂν ἐπιστήμην ἢ φρόνησιν ἢ νοῦν ἀφανίζων ἰσχυρίζεται περὶ τινος ὀπρῶν. ΘΕΑΙ. σφόδρα γε. ΞΕ. τῷ δὴ φιλοσόφῳ καὶ ταῦτα μάλιστα τιμῶντι πᾶσα, ὡς ἔοικεν, ἀνάγκη διὰ ταῦτα μήτε τῶν ἐν ἢ καὶ τὰ πολλὰ

TT: How?

ST: Do you think there could ever be sameness of characteristics or manner or relation, without rest?

Tt: Not at all.

St: But in the absence of these, can you see how there could be intelligence, or how it could ever come into being anywhere?

Tt: Not in the least.

249d

St: Well then, we must do battle, using every possible argument, against the man who would make strong assertions about anything at all, having done away with knowledge, thought and intelligence.

εἶδη λεγόντων τὸ πᾶν ἐστηκὸς ἀποδέχεσθαι, τῶν τε αὖ πανταχῇ τὸ ὄν κινούντων μηδὲ τὸ παράπαν ἀκούειν, ἀλλὰ κατὰ τὴν τῶν παίδων εὐχὴν, ὅσα ἀκίνητα καὶ κεκινημένα, τὸ ὄν τε καὶ τὸ πᾶν συναμφοτέρα λέγειν. ΘΕΑΙ. ἀληθέστατα. ΞΕ. τί οὖν; ἄρ' οὐκ ἐπεικῶς ἤδη φαινόμεθα περιειληφέναι τῷ λόγῳ τὸ ὄν; ΘΕΑΙ. πάνυ μὲν οὖν. ΞΕ. βαβαὶ μέντ' ἂν ἄρα, ὦ Θεαίτητε, ὥς μοι δοκοῦμεν νῦν αὐτοῦ γνῶσεσθαι περί τὴν ἀπορίαν τῆς σκέψεως.

Tt: Definitely.

St: Now, all these issues are necessarily, it seems, of the utmost importance to the philosopher, and because of these he must not accept that the universe is at rest, whether it is said to be one or to consist of many forms. Nor should he listen at all to those who say that 'what is' is changing everywhere. Instead, he should invoke the childish prayer, 'I want everything', and should say that 'the all' and 'what is' are a combination of both the unchanging and the changing.

Tt: Very true.

249e

St: Well then, is it likely that we have at last come to grips with 'what is' by this argument?

ΘΕΑΙ. πῶς αὖ καὶ τί τοῦτ' εἴρηκας; ΞΕ. ὦ μακάριε, οὐκ ἐννοεῖς ὅτι νῦν ἔσμεν ἐν ἀγνοίᾳ τῇ πλείστη περὶ αὐτοῦ, φαινόμεθα δέ τι λέγειν ἡμῖν

αὐτοῖς; ΘΕΑΙ. ἐμοὶ γοῦν· ὅπη δ' αὖ λελήθαμεν οὕτως ἔχοντες, οὐ πάνυ συνίημι. ΞΕ. σκόπει δὴ σαφέστερον εἰ τὰ νῦν συνομολογοῦντες

TT: Yes, certainly.

ST: Oh dear, Theaetetus, perhaps not! I think that we are just about to appreciate the perplexity involved in this enquiry.

TT: How? Why have you said this?

ST: Bless you! Do you not realise that we are now in utter ignorance about this, though we seem to ourselves to be talking sense?

TT: Well, so it seems to me, but I do not quite understand how we got into this condition without noticing it.

250a

ST: Well, in agreeing with what has been said, consider carefully whether we may justifiably be open to the very questions which we ourselves put previously to those who say that the universe is heat and cold.

δικαίως ἂν ἐπερωτηθεῖμεν ἅπερ αὐτοὶ τότε ἠρωτῶμεν τοὺς λέγοντας εἶναι τὸ πᾶν θερμὸν καὶ ψυχρόν. ΘΕΑΙ. ποῖα; ὑπόμνησόν με. ΞΕ. πάνυ μὲν οὖν· καὶ πειράσομαί γε δρᾶν τοῦτο ἐρωτῶν σὲ καθάπερ ἐκείνους τότε, ἵνα ἅμα τι καὶ προῖωμεν. ΘΕΑΙ. ὀρθῶς. ΞΕ. εἶεν δὴ, κίνησιν καὶ στάσιν ἅρ' οὐκ ἐναντιώτατα λέγεις ἀλλήλοις; ΘΕΑΙ. πῶς γὰρ οὔ; ΞΕ. καὶ μὴν εἶναί γε ὁμοίως φῆς ἀμφοτέρω αὐτὰ καὶ ἐκότερον;

TT: What questions? Remind me.

ST: Yes, certainly. And I shall try to do this at any rate by questioning you, just as we questioned the others, so that we may also make some progress at the same time.

TT: Right.

ST: Very well then. Don't you say that motion and rest are completely opposite to one another?

TT: They must be.

250b

ST: And do you also say that in like manner they both are, and that each of them is?

ΘΕΑΙ. φημί γὰρ οὖν. ΞΕ. ἄρα κινεῖσθαι λέγων ἀμφοτέρα καὶ ἐκάτερον, ὅταν εἶναι συγχωρῆς; ΘΕΑΙ. οὐδαμῶς. ΞΕ. ἀλλ' ἐστάναι σημαίνεις λέγων αὐτὰ ἀμφοτέρα εἶναι; ΘΕΑΙ. καὶ πῶς; ΞΕ. τρίτον ἄρα τι παρὰ ταῦτα τὸ ὄν ἐν τῇ ψυχῇ τιθεῖς, ὡς ὑπ' ἐκείνου τήν τε στάσιν καὶ τὴν κίνησιν περιεχομένην, συλλαβὼν καὶ ἀπιδὼν αὐτῶν πρὸς τὴν τῆς οὐσίας κοινωνίαν, οὕτως εἶναι προσεῖπας ἀμφοτέρα;

TT: Yes, I do say that.

ST: And when you accept that they are, do you mean that both of them and each of them is moving?

TT: Not at all.

ST: Then, in saying that both of them are, are you indicating that they are both at rest?

TT: No, how could they be?

ST: So, are you proposing that being is some third thing in the soul besides these two, and having understood that both rest and motion are encompassed by this, do you look to their commonality of being, and thus make the statement that they both are?

250c

TT: Yes. It is quite likely that we do, in truth, have an intuition that 'what is' is some third entity, whenever we say that motion and rest are.

ΘΕΑΙ. κινδυνεύομεν ὡς ἀληθῶς τρίτον ἀπομαντεύεσθαι τι τὸ ὄν, ὅταν κίνησιν καὶ στάσιν εἶναι λέγωμεν. ΞΕ. οὐκ ἄρα κίνησις καὶ στάσις ἐστὶ συναμφοτέρον τὸ ὄν ἀλλ' ἕτερον δὴ τι τούτων. ΘΕΑΙ. ἔοικεν. ΞΕ. κατὰ τὴν αὐτοῦ φύσιν ἄρα τὸ ὄν οὔτε ἔστηκεν οὔτε κινεῖται. ΘΕΑΙ. σχεδόν. ΞΕ. ποῖ δὴ χρὴ τὴν διάνοιαν ἔτι τρέπειν τὸν βουλούμενον ἐναργές τι περὶ

αὐτοῦ παρ' ἑαυτῷ βεβαιώσασθαι; ΘΕΑΙ. ποῖ γάρ; ΞΕ. οἶμαι μὲν οὐδαμῶς
ἔτι ῥάδιον. εἰ γάρ τι μὴ

ST: So 'what is' is not the two together, motion and rest, but something different from them.

TT: So it seems.

ST: Then, based upon its own nature, 'what is' is neither at rest nor in motion.

TT: Hardly.

ST: Well then, where is there still left for someone's mind to turn who wishes to establish anything clear and certain about this for himself?

TT: Where indeed?

250d

ST: I do not think there is any easy option left, for if something is not moving, how can it not be at rest? Or if it is not at rest at all, then how can it not be moving? Yet 'what is' has just appeared before us, outside of both motion and rest. But is this possible?

κινεῖται, πῶς οὐχ ἔστηκεν; ἢ τὸ μηδαμῶς ἔστος πῶς οὐκ αὖ κινεῖται; τὸ δὲ ὄν ἡμῖν νῦν ἐκτὸς τούτων ἀμφοτέρων ἀναπέφανται. ἢ δυνατόν οὖν τοῦτο; ΘΕΑΙ. πάντων μὲν οὖν ἀδυνατώτατον. ΞΕ. τόδε τοίνυν μνησθῆναι δίκαιον ἐπὶ τούτοις. ΘΕΑΙ. τὸ ποῖον; ΞΕ. ὅτι τοῦ μὴ ὄντος ἐρωτηθέντες τοῦνομα ἐφ' ὅτι ποτὲ δεῖ φέρειν, πάσῃ συνεσχόμεθα ἀπορίᾳ. μέμνησαι; ΘΕΑΙ. πῶς γὰρ οὔ;

TT: No, it is totally impossible.

ST: However, it would be right to recall something about these.

TT: What is it?

ST: That we ended up in utter perplexity when we were asked what precisely the phrase 'what is not' should be applied to. Do you remember?

TT: How could I forget?

250e

ST: And are we now in any less perplexity in relation to what is?

ΞΕ. μῶν οὖν ἐν ἐλάττονί τινι νῦν ἔσμεν ἀπορίᾳ περὶ τὸ ὄν; **ΘΕΑΙ.** ἔμοι μέν, ὦ ξέने, εἰ δυνατόν εἰπεῖν, ἐν πλείονι φαινόμεθα. **ΞΕ.** τοῦτο μὲν τοίνυν ἐνταῦθα κείσθω διηπορημένον· ἐπειδὴ δὲ ἐξ ἴσου τό τε ὄν καὶ τὸ μὴ ὄν ἀπορίας μετειλήφατον, νῦν ἐλπίς ἤδη καθάπερ ἂν αὐτῶν θάτερον εἴτε ἀμυδρότερον εἴτε σαφέστερον ἀναφαίνεται, καὶ θάτερον οὕτως

ΤΤ: Well, stranger, it seems to me that we are in even greater perplexity, if that is possible.

ST: Let's take it, then, that this is where our difficulty lies. However, since what is and what is not are equally involved in perplexity, there is now some hope. For as one of them becomes more dimly or clearly evident, the other will do the same. And if we prove unable to discern either, we shall scrutinise the description of both at once, as appropriately as we can.

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ΤΤ: Very good.

ἀναφαίνεσθαι· καὶ ἐὰν αὖ μηδέτερον ἰδεῖν δυνώμεθα, τὸν γοῦν λόγον ὅπηπερ ἂν οἰοί τε ὦμεν εὐπρεπέστατα διωσόμεθα οὕτως ἀμφοῖν ἅμα. **ΘΕΑΙ.** καλῶς. **ΞΕ.** λέγωμεν δὴ καθ' ὅντινά ποτε τρόπον πολλοῖς ὀνόμασι ταῦτόν τοῦτο ἐκάστοτε προσαγορεύομεν. **ΘΕΑΙ.** οἷον δὴ τί; παράδειγμα εἰπέ. **ΞΕ.** λέγομεν ἄνθρωπον δήπου πόλλ' ἄττα ἐπονομάζοντες, τὰ τε χρώματα ἐπιφέροντες αὐτῷ καὶ τὰ σχήματα καὶ μεγέθη καὶ κακίας καὶ ἀρετάς, ἐν οἷς πᾶσι καὶ ἑτέροις μυρίοις οὐ μόνον

ST: Then let's explain how it happens that we refer to the same thing by many names, depending on the occasion.

ΤΤ: What sort of thing do you mean? Give an example.

ST: You know that we speak of a man, calling him lots of different things, attributing colours to him, and also shapes, dimensions, excellences and vices. In all these cases, and numerous others, we are saying not only that he is a man, but also that he is good, and countless

other things. And in other cases, by the same argument, we propose that each is one, and then refer to it as many, and so we describe it by many names.

251b

Tt: What you say is true.

ἄνθρωπον αὐτὸν εἶναι φαμεν, ἀλλὰ καὶ ἀγαθὸν καὶ ἕτερα ἄπειρα, καὶ τᾶλλα δὴ κατὰ τὸν αὐτὸν λόγον οὕτως ἐν ἑκαστον ὑποθέμενοι πάλιν αὐτὸ πολλὰ καὶ πολλοῖς ὀνόμασι λέγομεν. ΘΕΑΙ. ἀληθῆ λέγεις. ΞΕ. ὅθεν γε οἶμαι τοῖς τε νέοις καὶ τῶν γερόντων τοῖς ὀψιμαθέσι θοίνην παρεσκευάκαμεν· εὐθύς γὰρ ἀντιλαβέσθαι παντὶ πρόχειρον ὥς ἀδύνατον τά τε πολλὰ ἐν καὶ τὸ ἐν πολλὰ εἶναι, καὶ δήπου χαίρουσιν οὐκ ἐῶντες ἀγαθὸν λέγειν

St: Well, at any rate, I believe we have provided a feast for the young and for the old men whose learning came late in their lives. For it is easy for anyone to appreciate quite readily that it is impossible for the many to be one and also for one to be many, and indeed they delight in forbidding man from being called good, and they only allow good to be called good and man to be called man. Indeed, Theaetetus, I imagine you have often met those who take this sort of thing seriously. Sometimes older men who are amazed at such marvels, due to the poverty-stricken state of their intellect, actually believe that they have discovered the very repository of all wisdom.

251c

Tt: They certainly do.

ἄνθρωπον, ἀλλὰ τὸ μὲν ἀγαθὸν ἀγαθόν, τὸν δὲ ἄνθρωπον ἄνθρωπον. ἐντυχάνεις γάρ, ὦ Θεαίτητε, ὥς ἐγῶμαι, πολλάκις τὰ τοιαῦτα ἐσπουδακόσιν, ἐνίοτε πρεσβυτέροις ἀνθρώποις, καὶ ὑπὸ πενίας τῆς περὶ φρόνησιν κτήσεως τὰ τοιαῦτα τεθαυμακόσι, καὶ δή τι καὶ πάσσοφον οἰομένοις τοῦτο αὐτὸ ἀνηυρηκέναι. ΘΕΑΙ. πάνυ μὲν οὖν. ΞΕ. ἵνα τοίνυν πρὸς ἅπαντας ἡμῖν ὁ λόγος ᾗ τοῦς

St: Then, so that our discussion may be all inclusive, we should direct our questioning now to all those who have ever discoursed on being in

any way at all, and to those with whom we discussed this earlier.

TT: And the questions are?

ST: "Whether we may neither attach being to motion and rest, nor attach anything at all to anything else, and should we therefore propose, in our own discussions, that these are unmixed, and it is impossible for them to participate in one another? Or should we have grouped them all together as the same, in their capacity for communion with one another? Or can some have this capacity while others do not?" Well, Theaetetus, can we say which of these options they would choose?

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TT: I cannot answer these questions on their behalf at all.

πώποτε περὶ οὐσίας καὶ ὅτιοῦν διαλεχθέντας, ἔστω καὶ πρὸς τούτους καὶ πρὸς τοὺς ἄλλους, ὅσοις ἔμπροσθεν διειλέγμεθα, τὰ νῦν ὡς ἐν ἐρωτήσῃ λεχθησόμενα. ΘΕΑΙ. τὰ ποῖα δὴ; ΞΕ. πότερον μήτε τὴν οὐσίαν κινήσει καὶ στάσει προσάπτωμεν μήτε ἄλλο ἄλλῳ μηδὲν μηδενί, ἀλλ' ὡς ἄμεικτα ὄντα καὶ ἀδύνατον μεταλαμβάνειν ἀλλήλων οὕτως αὐτὰ ἐν τοῖς παρ' ἡμῖν λόγοις τιθῶμεν; ἢ πάντα εἰς ταὐτὸν συναγάγωμεν ὡς δυνατὰ ἐπικοινωνεῖν ἀλλήλοις; ἢ τὰ μέν, τὰ δὲ μή; τούτων,

ST: Then why don't you answer them one by one, and see what the consequences are in each case?

TT: A good suggestion.

ST: First, if you wish, let's propose that they say that nothing has any power of communion with anything else at all. In that case, movement and rest will have no share of being, will they?

TT: Not in that case.

ST: But will either of them be, if they have no communion with being?

TT: They will not.

251e

ST: Well, all parties have been instantly overthrown by this concession it seems, including the 'universe is motion' people, those who say it is one and at rest, and anyone who maintains that things that are consist of forms which are always just the same as they are. Indeed, all of these people associate being with something, some by saying that the universe is actually movement, others by saying that it is actually rest.

ὦ Θεαίτητε, τί ποτ' ἂν αὐτοὺς προαιρεῖσθαι φήσομεν; ΘΕΑΙ. ἐγὼ μὲν ὑπὲρ αὐτῶν οὐδὲν ἔχω πρὸς ταῦτα ἀποκρίνασθαι. ΞΕ. τί οὖν οὐ καθ' ἑν ἀποκρινόμενος ἐφ' ἑκάστου τὰ συμβαίνοντα ἐσκέψω; ΘΕΑΙ. καλῶς λέγεις. ΞΕ. καὶ τιθῶμέν γε αὐτοὺς λέγειν, εἰ βούλει, πρῶτον μηδενὶ μηδὲν μηδεμίαν δύναμιν ἔχειν κοινωνίας εἰς μηδέν. οὐκοῦν κίνησίς τε καὶ στάσις οὐδαμῇ μεθέξετον οὐσίας;

TT: Quite so.

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ST: And, indeed, those who propose to combine all things at one time and to separate them at some other time, either by having unlimited things coming from one and returning to one, or else by dividing all things into finite elements and making combinations of these, regardless of whether they propose that this happens successively or continuously, these people would be talking nonsense in all cases, if, in fact, there is no comingling.

ΘΕΑΙ. οὐ γὰρ οὖν. ΞΕ. τί δέ; ἔσται πότερον αὐτῶν οὐσίας μὴ προσκοινωνοῦν; ΘΕΑΙ. οὐκ ἔσται. ΞΕ. ταχὺ δὴ ταύτη γε τῇ συνομολογίᾳ πάντα ἀνάστατα γέγονεν, ὥς ἔοικεν, ἅμα τε τῶν τὸ πᾶν κινούντων καὶ τῶν ὥς ἑν ιστάντων καὶ ὅσοι κατ' εἶδη τὰ ὄντα κατὰ ταῦτα ὡσαύτως ἔχοντα εἶναι φασιν αἰεὶ πάντες γὰρ οὗτοι τό γε εἶναι προσάπτουσιν, οἱ μὲν ὄντως κινεῖσθαι λέγοντες, οἱ δὲ ὄντως ἐστηκότ' εἶναι. ΘΕΑΙ. κομιδῇ μὲν οὖν.

TT: Correct.

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ST: And what's more, the people who pursue this question, in the most ridiculous manner, are those who allow nothing to be referred to as

different because it shares a different characteristic.

ΞΕ. καὶ μὴν καὶ ὅσοι τοτὲ μὲν συντιθέασι τὰ πάντα, τοτὲ δὲ διαιροῦσιν, εἴτε εἰς ἓν καὶ ἐξ ἑνὸς ἄπειρα εἴτε εἰς πέρας ἔχοντα στοιχεῖα διαιρούμενοι καὶ ἐκ τούτων συντιθέντες, ὁμοίως μὲν ἂν ἐν μέρει τοῦτο τιθῶσι γιγνόμενον, ὁμοίως δὲ καὶ ἂν ἀεί, κατὰ πάντα ταῦτα λέγοιεν ἂν οὐδέν, εἴπερ μηδεμία ἔστι σύμμειξις. ΘΕΑΙ. ὁρθῶς. ΞΕ. ἔτι τοίνυν ἂν αὐτοὶ πάντων καταγελαστότατα μετίοιεν τὸν λόγον οἱ μὴδὲν ἑῶντες κοινωνία παθήματος ἐτέρου θάτερον προσαγορεύειν. ΘΕΑΙ. πῶς; ΞΕ. τῷ τε εἶναί που περὶ πάντα ἀναγκάζονται χρῆσθαι καὶ τῷ χωρὶς καὶ τῷ τῶν ἄλλων καὶ τῷ καθ' αὐτὸ καὶ μυρίοις ἐτέροις, ὧν ἀκρατεῖς ὄντες εἴργεσθαι καὶ μὴ συνάπτειν ἐν τοῖς λόγοις οὐκ ἄλλων δέονται τῶν ἐξελεγχόντων, ἀλλὰ τὸ λεγόμενον οἴκοθεν τὸν πολέμιον καὶ ἐναντιωσόμενον ἔχοντες, ἐντὸς ὑποφθεγγόμενον ὥσπερ τὸν ἄτοπον Εὐρυκλέα περιφέροντες ἀεὶ πορεύονται.

TT: How?

ST: Well, presumably they are compelled to use 'to be' in relation to everything. They cannot help employing 'apart' and 'the others' and 'itself', and very many more expressions, and connecting them when they speak, and so they are refuting themselves. The enemy and future opponent is within themselves, as the saying goes, and they walk about carrying his voice inside them like the strange ventriloquist, Eurycles.¹⁴

252d

TT: The comparison you make is both accurate and true.

ΘΕΑΙ. κομιδῇ λέγεις ὁμοίον τε καὶ ἀληθές. ΞΕ. τί δ', ἂν πάντα ἀλλήλοις ἑῶμεν δύναμιν ἔχειν ἐπικοινωνίας; ΘΕΑΙ. τοῦτο μὲν οἷός τε κάγω διαλύειν. ΞΕ. πῶς; ΘΕΑΙ. ὅτι κίνησίς τε αὐτὴ παντάπασιν ἴσται' ἂν καὶ στάσις αὖ πάλιν αὐτὴ κινεῖτο, εἴπερ ἐπιγιγνοῖσθην ἐπ' ἀλλήλοις. ΞΕ. ἀλλὰ μὴν τοῦτό γέ που ταῖς μεγίσταις ἀνάγκαις ἀδύνατον, κίνησίν τε ἴστασθαι καὶ στάσιν κινεῖσθαι; ΘΕΑΙ. πῶς γὰρ οὐ; ΞΕ. τὸ τρίτον δὴ μόνον λοιπόν. ΘΕΑΙ. ναί.

ST: Well then, should we concede to all things the capacity for intercommunion with one another?

TT: Even I would be able to do away with that suggestion.

ST: How?

TT: Well, movement itself would be totally at rest, while rest itself would, in turn, be moving if they were to come together with one another.

ST: And, presumably, it must be utterly impossible that movement be at rest, and rest in motion?

TT: It must be.

ST: Only the third option is left then.

TT: Yes.

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ST: Well, it must be some one of the following: either everything will mix together or nothing will, or some will and others will not.

ΞΕ. καὶ μὴν ἔν γέ τι τούτων ἀναγκαῖον, ἢ πάντα ἢ μηδὲν ἢ τὰ μὲν ἐθέλειν, τὰ δὲ μὴ συμμείγνυσθαι. ΘΕΑΙ. πῶς γὰρ οὐ; ΞΕ. καὶ μὴν τά γε δύο ἀδύνατον ἡρέεθαι. ΘΕΑΙ. ναί. ΞΕ. πᾶς ἄρα ὁ βουλόμενος ὀρθῶς ἀποκρίνεσθαι τὸ λοιπὸν τῶν τριῶν θήσει. ΘΕΑΙ. κομιδῇ μὲν οὖν. ΞΕ. ὅτε δὴ τὰ μὲν ἐθέλει τοῦτο δρᾶν, τὰ δ' οὐ, σχεδὸν

TT: There are no other options.

ST: And yet the first two were found to be impossible.

TT: Yes.

ST: So anyone who wishes to give the right answer will select the last of the three.

TT: Exactly.

253a

ST: Now, since some things will do this and others will not, they would be behaving much like the letters of the alphabet, for some of them will not fit together with one another, while others will fit together.

οἷον τὰ γράμματα πεπονθότ' ἂν εἴη. καὶ γὰρ ἐκείνων τὰ μὲν ἀναρμοστεῖ που πρὸς ἄλληλα, τὰ δὲ συναρμόττει. ΘΕΑΙ. πῶς δ' οὐ; ΞΕ. τὰ δέ γε φωνήεντα διαφερόντως τῶν ἄλλων οἷον δεσμός διὰ πάντων κεχώρηκεν, ὥστε ἄνευ τινὸς αὐτῶν ἀδύνατον ἀρμόττειν καὶ τῶν ἄλλων ἕτερον ἐτέρῳ. ΘΕΑΙ. καὶ μάλα γε. ΞΕ. πᾶς οὖν οἶδεν ὅποια ὅποιοις δυνατὰ κοινωνεῖν, ἢ τέχνης δεῖ τῷ μέλλοντι δρᾶν ἱκανῶς αὐτό; ΘΕΑΙ. τέχνης. ΞΕ. ποίας; ΘΕΑΙ. τῆς γραμματικῆς.

TT: Of course.

ST: And the vowels are better at this than the other letters. They are like a bond running through them all so that it is impossible for one of the others to attach to anything else without at least one of the vowels.

TT: Certainly.

ST: Does everyone know what letters can combine with what, or is a skill required by someone who is to do this properly?

TT: There is a skill.

ST: What is it?

TT: Grammar.

253b

ST: And isn't it the same where high and low notes are concerned? Does the musical person have the skill to recognise which notes go together and which do not, while the unmusical person does not understand this?

ΞΕ. τί δέ; περὶ τοὺς τῶν ὀξέων καὶ βαρέων φθόγγους ἄρ' οὐχ οὕτως; ὁ μὲν τοὺς συγκεραννυμένους τε καὶ μὴ τέχνην ἔχων γινώσκειν μουσικός, ὁ δὲ μὴ συνιεὶς ἄμουσος; ΘΕΑΙ. οὕτως. ΞΕ. καὶ κατὰ τῶν ἄλλων δὴ τεχνῶν καὶ ἀτεχνῶν τοιαῦτα εὐρήσομεν ἕτερα. ΘΕΑΙ. πῶς δ'

οὐ; ΞΕ. τί δ'; ἐπειδὴ καὶ τὰ γένη πρὸς ἄλληλα κατὰ ταῦτ' αὖ μείξεως ἔχειν ὁμολογήκαμεν, ἄρ' οὐ μετ' ἐπιστήμης τινὸς ἀναγκαῖον διὰ τῶν λόγων πορεύεσθαι τὸν ὁρθῶς μέλλοντα δείξιν ποῖα ποίοις συμφωνεῖ τῶν γενῶν καὶ ποῖα ἄλληλα οὐ δέχεται; καὶ δὴ καὶ διὰ πάντων εἰ συνέχοντ' ἅττ' αὐτ' ἐστίν, ὥστε συμμείγνυσθαι δυνατὰ εἶναι, καὶ πάλιν ἐν ταῖς διαιρέσεσιν, εἰ δι' ὅλων ἕτερα τῆς διαιρέσεως αἴτια; ΘΕΑΙ. πῶς γὰρ οὐκ ἐπιστήμης δεῖ, καὶ σχεδόν γε ἴσως τῆς μεγίστης; ΞΕ. τίν' οὖν αὖ νῦν προσερούμεν, ὦ Θεαίτητε, ταύτην; ἢ πρὸς Διὸς ἐλάθομεν εἰς τὴν τῶν ἐλευθέρων ἐμπεσόντες ἐπιστήμην, καὶ κινδυνεύομεν ζητοῦντες τὸν σοφιστὴν πρότερον ἀνηυρηκέναι τὸν φιλόσοφον; ΘΕΑΙ. πῶς λέγεις;

TT: Yes, it is the same.

ST: And we shall find that similar distinctions between skill and lack of skill apply to other subjects.

TT: Of course.

ST: Yes. And since we have agreed that the kinds can also mix with one another in this same way, mustn't a man who is going to show correctly which of the kinds accord with one another or reject one another proceed through the arguments with some knowledge? And will he also need some knowledge to show whether there are certain kinds which pervade all the kinds and keep them together, so that they can be mixed together, and again, in the case of division, whether the causes of division are entirely different?

253d

TT: How could he do it without knowledge, perhaps even the supreme knowledge?

ST: Well now, Theaetetus, what are we going to call this knowledge? Or, by Zeus, have we stumbled unwittingly upon the knowledge belonging to free men? And is it possible that we have found first the philosopher, whilst looking for the sophist?

TT: What do you mean?

ST: This division on the basis of kinds, without thinking that the same form is a different form or that a different one is the same, should we not say that this belongs to dialectical knowledge?

TT: Yes, we should.

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ST: Therefore, someone who can do this readily discerns one characteristic extending entirely through many things, each of which is separate and one; and many characteristics which are different from one another, encompassed externally by one characteristic; furthermore, one characteristic connected in one kind through multiplicities that are wholes; and many characteristics which are distinct and completely separate. This is knowing how to distinguish, kind by kind, which way they commune and which way they do not.

ΞΕ. τὸ κατὰ γένη διαιρεῖσθαι καὶ μήτε ταῦτὸν εἶδος ἕτερον ἡγήσασθαι μήτε ἕτερον ὃν ταῦτὸν μῶν οὐ τῆς διαλεκτικῆς φήσομεν ἐπιστήμης εἶναι; ΘΕΑΙ. ναί, φήσομεν. ΞΕ. οὐκοῦν ὃ γε τοῦτο δυνατὸς δρᾶν μίαν ἰδέαν διὰ πολλῶν, ἐνὸς ἐκάστου κειμένου χωρίς, πάντη διατεταμένην ἱκανῶς διαισθάνεται, καὶ πολλὰς ἐτέρας ἀλλήλων ὑπὸ μιᾶς ἔξωθεν περιεχομένας, καὶ μίαν αὖ δι' ὅλων πολλῶν ἐν ἐνὶ συνημμένην, καὶ πολλὰς χωρίς πάντη διωρισμένας τοῦτο δ'

TT: Entirely so.

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ST: And I am sure that you will never grant this dialectical skill to anyone except a man who loves wisdom, purely and righteously.

ἔστιν, ἥ τε κοινωνεῖν ἕκαστα δύναται καὶ ὅπη μή, διακρίνειν κατὰ γένος ἐπίσταςθαι. ΘΕΑΙ. παντάπασι μὲν οὖν. ΞΕ. ἀλλὰ μὴν τό γε διαλεκτικὸν οὐκ ἄλλω δώσεις, ὡς ἐγώ μαι, πλὴν τῷ καθαρῶς τε καὶ δικαίως φιλοσοφοῦντι. ΘΕΑΙ. πῶς γὰρ ἂν ἄλλω δοίῃ τις; ΞΕ. τὸν μὲν δὴ φιλόσοφον ἐν τοιούτῳ τινὶ τόπῳ καὶ νῦν καὶ ἔπειτα ἀνευρήσομεν ἐὰν ζητῶμεν, ἰδεῖν μὲν χαλεπὸν

TT: Indeed, how could one grant it to anyone else?

ST: It is in some such place as this that we shall find the philosopher, both now and hereafter, if we search for him. It is, indeed, difficult to see this person plainly, but the difficulty of seeing the sophist is of a different sort from this.

TT: How?

254a

ST: Well, the sophist runs away into the darkness of non-being, attaching himself to this by practice, and he is hard to discern because of the darkness of the place. Is this so?

ἐναργῶς καὶ τοῦτον, ἕτερον μὴν τρόπον ἢ τε τοῦ σοφιστοῦ χαλεπότης ἢ τε τούτου. ΘΕΑΙ. πῶς; ΞΕ. ὁ μὲν ἀποδιδράσκων εἰς τὴν τοῦ μὴ ὄντος σκοτεινότητα, τριβῇ προσαπτόμενος αὐτῆς, διὰ τὸ σκοτεινὸν τοῦ τόπου κατανοῆσαι χαλεπός· ἢ γάρ; ΘΕΑΙ. ἔοικεν. ΞΕ. ὁ δέ γε φιλόσοφος, τῇ τοῦ ὄντος ἀεὶ διὰ λογισμῶν προσκείμενος ἰδέᾳ, διὰ τὸ λαμπρὸν αὐτῆς χώρας οὐδαμῶς εὐπετῆς ὀφθῆναι· τὰ γὰρ τῆς τῶν πολλῶν ψυχῆς ὄμματα

TT: So it seems.

ST: However the philosopher is always devoted, through reasoning, to the characteristic of what is. And he is also not at all easy to see because of the brightness of that region, as it is impossible for the eyes of the common soul to sustain the gaze that looks towards the divine.

TT: Yes, all this is no less likely to be so than what was said about the sophist.

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ST: Well, we shall consider the philosopher in more detail presently, if we so desire. But it is obvious, I presume, that we must not give up on the sophist until we can see him properly.

καρτερεῖν πρὸς τὸ θεῖον ἀφορῶντα ἀδύνατα. ΘΕΑΙ. καὶ ταῦτα εἰκὸς οὐχ ἦττον ἐκείνων οὕτως ἔχειν. ΞΕ. οὐκοῦν περὶ μὲν τούτου καὶ τάχα ἐπισκεψόμεθα σαφέστερον, ἂν ἔτι βουλομένοις ἡμῖν ἢ περὶ δὲ τοῦ σοφιστοῦ που δῆλον ὡς οὐκ ἀνετέον πρὶν ἂν ἰκανῶς αὐτὸν θεασώμεθα.

ΘΕΑΙ. καλῶς εἶπες. ΞΕ. ὅτ' οὖν δὴ τὰ μὲν ἡμῖν τῶν γενῶν ὡμολόγηται κοινωνεῖν ἐθέλειν ἀλλήλοις, τὰ δὲ μή, καὶ τὰ μὲν ἐπ' ὀλίγον, τὰ δ' ἐπὶ πολλά, τὰ δὲ καὶ διὰ πάντων οὐδὲν κωλύειν τοῖς

ΤΤ: Very good.

254c

ST: Indeed, we have actually agreed now that some of the kinds will combine with one another, while others will not, and some will combine with few, others with many, and also that some are all-pervasive and are allowed to combine with everything. So we should proceed to the next issue by considering the following question, not about all the forms, lest we get confused by the multiplicity, but selecting some of those which are said to be the most important. We should first ask what sort each is, and then what their power to commune with one another is. In this way, we shall at least understand something about being and non-being, as far as our current method of enquiry allows, even if we cannot apprehend them with total clarity, and we may somehow be allowed to say that 'what is not', is actually non-being, and avoid reproach.

πᾶσι κεκοινωνηκέναι, τὸ δὴ μετὰ τοῦτο συνεπισπώμεθα τῷ λόγῳ τῇδε σκοποῦντες, μὴ περὶ πάντων τῶν εἰδῶν, ἵνα μὴ ταραττώμεθα ἐν πολλοῖς, ἀλλὰ προελόμενοι τῶν μεγίστων λεγομένων ἅττα, πρῶτον μὲν ποῖα ἕκαστά ἐστιν, ἔπειτα κοινωνίας ἀλλήλων πῶς ἔχει δυνάμεως, ἵνα τό τε ὄν καὶ μὴ ὄν εἰ μὴ πάση σαφηνεῖα δυνάμεθα λαβεῖν, ἀλλ' οὖν λόγου γε ἐνδεεῖς μηδὲν γινώμεθα περὶ αὐτῶν, καθ' ὅσον ὁ τρόπος ἐνδέχεται τῆς νῦν σκέψεως, ἐὰν ἄρα ἡμῖν πη

ΤΤ: Yes, we must do this.

254d

ST: Now, the most important kinds are those we have just mentioned – being itself, rest and motion.

παρειακάθῃ τὸ μὴ ὄν λέγουσιν ὡς ἔστιν ὄντως μὴ ὄν ἀθώοις ἀπαλλάττειν. ΘΕΑΙ. οὐκοῦν χρή. ΞΕ. μέγιστα μὴν τῶν γενῶν ἃ νυνδὴ διῆμμεν τό τε ὄν αὐτὸ καὶ στάσις καὶ κίνησις. ΘΕΑΙ. πολὺ γε. ΞΕ. καὶ μὴν

τώ γε δύο φαμέν αὐτοῖν ἀμείκτω πρὸς ἀλλήλῳ. ΘΕΑΙ. σφόδρα γε. ΞΕ. τὸ δέ γε ὃν μεικτὸν ἀμφοῖν ἐστὸν γὰρ ἄμφω που. ΘΕΑΙ. πῶς δ' οὐ; ΞΕ. τρία δὴ γίγνεται ταῦτα. ΘΕΑΙ. τί μήν; ΞΕ. οὐκοῦν αὐτῶν ἕκαστον τοῖν μὲν δυοῖν ἕτερόν ἐστιν, αὐτὸ δ' ἑαυτῷ ταῦτόν.

TT: Very much so.

ST: And we also say that two of them do not mix with one another.

TT: They do not.

ST: And yet being mixes with both, for presumably both are.

TT: Of course.

ST: So there are these three.

TT: Of course.

ST: And of these, each of the two is different from the other, and the same as itself.

254e

TT: Quite so.

ΘΕΑΙ. οὕτως. ΞΕ. τί ποτ' αὖ νῦν οὕτως εἰρήκαμεν τό τε ταῦτόν καὶ θάτερον; πότερα δύο γένη τινὲ αὐτῷ, τῶν μὲν τριῶν ἄλλω, συμμειγνυμένῳ μὴν ἐκείνοις ἐξ ἀνάγκης αἰεὶ, καὶ περὶ πέντε ἄλλ' οὐ περὶ τριῶν ὥς ὄντων αὐτῶν σκεπτέον, ἢ τό τε ταῦτόν

255a

ST: Well now, what precisely are the 'same' and the 'different' which we have just mentioned? Are they two additional kinds, apart from the first three, two kinds which must necessarily combine with the three, and should we investigate them as though there were five and not three? Or is this 'same' and 'different' something belonging to the other three, which we are referring to without noticing it?

τοῦτο καὶ θάτερον ὥς ἐκείνων τι προσαγορεύοντες λανθάνομεν ἡμᾶς αὐτούς; ΘΕΑΙ. ἴσως. ΞΕ. ἀλλ' οὐ τι μὴν κίνησίς γε καὶ στάσις οὐθ' ἕτερον οὔτε ταῦτόν ἐστι. ΘΕΑΙ. πῶς; ΞΕ. ὅτιπερ ἂν κοινῇ προσείπωμεν κίνησιν

καὶ στάσιν, τοῦτο οὐδέτερον αὐτοῖν οἶόν τε εἶναι. ΘΕΑΙ. τί δῆ; ΞΕ. κίνησις τε στήσεται καὶ στάσις αὖ κινηθήσεται· περὶ γὰρ ἀμφοτέρα θάτερον ὅποτερον οὖν γιγνόμενον αὐτοῖν ἀναγκάσει μεταβάλλειν αὖ θάτερον ἐπὶ τὸναντίον τῆς αὐτοῦ

TT: Perhaps.

ST: But of course, motion and rest are neither different nor the same.

TT: How so?

ST: Whatever we attribute to motion and rest jointly cannot itself be either of the two.

TT: Why is that?

255b

ST: Because motion would then be at rest, and rest would be moving. For the involvement of either of the two with both of them will compel the other one to change to the opposite of its own nature, since it is partaking of its opposite.

φύσεως, ἅτε μετασχὼν τοῦ ἐναντίου. ΘΕΑΙ. κομιδῇ γε. ΞΕ. μετέχετον μὴν ἄμφω ταύτου καὶ θατέρου. ΘΕΑΙ. ναί. ΞΕ. μὴ τοίνυν λέγωμεν κίνησιν γ' εἶναι ταῦτον ἢ θάτερον, μηδ' αὖ στάσιν. ΘΕΑΙ. μὴ γάρ. ΞΕ. ἀλλ' ἄρα τὸ ὄν καὶ τὸ ταῦτον ὡς ἓν τι διανοητέον ἡμῖν; ΘΕΑΙ. ἴσως. ΞΕ. ἀλλ' εἰ τὸ ὄν καὶ τὸ ταῦτον μηδὲν διάφορον σημαίνετον, κίνησιν αὖ πάλιν καὶ στάσιν ἀμφοτέρα εἶναι λέγοντες

TT: Exactly.

ST: However, both partake of the same and the different.

TT: Yes.

ST: Therefore, we may not say that either motion or rest is the same or the different.

TT: No.

ST: Well then, should we think of 'what is' and 'the same' as one thing?

TT: Perhaps.

255c

ST: But if 'what is' and 'the same' do not signify anything different, then saying once more that motion and rest both are will amount to referring to them both as the same.

ἀμφοτέρα οὕτως αὐτὰ ταὐτὸν ὥς ὄντα προσερούμεν. ΘΕΑΙ. ἀλλὰ μὴν τοῦτό γε ἀδύνατον. ΞΕ. ἀδύνατον ἄρα ταὐτὸν καὶ τὸ ὄν ἐν εἶναι. ΘΕΑΙ. σχεδόν. ΞΕ. τέταρτον δὴ πρὸς τοῖς τρισὶν εἶδεσιν τὸ ταὐτὸν τιθῶμεν; ΘΕΑΙ. πάνυ μὲν οὖν. ΞΕ. τί δέ; τὸ θάτερον ἄρα ἡμῖν λεκτέον πέμπτον; ἢ τοῦτο καὶ τὸ ὄν ὥς δύο ἅττα ὀνόματα ἐφ' ἐνὶ γένει διανοεῖσθαι δεῖ; ΘΕΑΙ. τάχ' ἄν. ΞΕ. ἀλλ' οἶμαί σε συγχωρεῖν τῶν ὄντων τὰ μὲν αὐτὰ καθ' αὐτά, τὰ δὲ πρὸς ἄλλα ἀεὶ λέγεσθαι. ΘΕΑΙ. τί δ' οὔ;

TT: Yes, but that is impossible.

ST: So it is impossible for 'the same' and 'what is' to be one.

TT: Quite.

ST: Well, should we propose that the same is a fourth form in addition to the other three?

TT: Yes, certainly.

ST: Yes, but should we say that the different is a fifth? Or must we think of the different, and what is, as two names for one kind?

TT: Perhaps.

ST: But I think you concede that some things that are, are always spoken of just by themselves, while some are always spoken of in relation to others.

TT: So they are.

255d

ST: And different is always in relation to another. Is this so?

ΞΕ. τὸ δέ γ' ἕτερον ἀεὶ πρὸς ἕτερον ἢ γάρ; ΘΕΑΙ. οὕτως. ΞΕ. οὐκ ἄν, εἴ γε τὸ ὄν καὶ τὸ θάτερον μὴ πάμπολυ διεφερέτην· ἀλλ' εὔπερ θάτερον

ἀμφοῖν μετεῖχε τοῖν εἰδοῖν ὥσπερ τὸ ὄν, ἦν ἂν ποτέ τι καὶ τῶν ἐτέρων ἕτερον οὐ πρὸς ἕτερον· νῦν δὲ ἀτεχνῶς ἡμῖν ὅτιπερ ἂν ἕτερον ἦ, συμβέβηκεν ἐξ ἀνάγκης ἐτέρου τοῦτο ὅπερ ἐστὶν εἶναι. ΘΕΑΙ. λέγεις καθάπερ ἔχει. ΞΕ. πέμπτον δὴ τὴν θατέρου φύσιν λεκτέον ἐν τοῖς

TT: Just so.

ST: But this would not be the case if what is and different were not utterly distinct. But if different, like what is, were to partake of both relations, some of the different things would sometimes be different, but not in relation to another. But now we find, simply, that whatever is different necessarily turns out to be the very thing it is, namely, different from something else.

TT: It is exactly as you say.

255e

ST: Then we must say that the nature of the different is a fifth form among these forms we are selecting.

εἴδεσιν οὕσαν, ἐν οἷς προαιρούμεθα. ΘΕΑΙ. ναί. ΞΕ. καὶ διὰ πάντων γε αὐτὴν αὐτῶν φήσομεν εἶναι διεληλυθυῖαν· ἕν ἕκαστον γὰρ ἕτερον εἶναι τῶν ἄλλων οὐ διὰ τὴν αὐτοῦ φύσιν, ἀλλὰ διὰ τὸ μετέχειν τῆς ιδέας τῆς θατέρου. ΘΕΑΙ. κομιδῇ μὲν οὖν. ΞΕ. ὥδε δὴ λέγωμεν ἐπὶ τῶν πέντε καθ' ἐν ἀναλαμβάνοντες. ΘΕΑΙ. πῶς; ΞΕ. πρῶτον μὲν κίνησιν, ὡς ἔστι παντάπασιν ἕτερον στάσεως, ἢ πῶς λέγομεν; ΘΕΑΙ. οὕτως. ΞΕ. οὐ στάσις ἄρ' ἐστίν. ΘΕΑΙ. οὐδαμῶς.

TT: Yes.

ST: And we shall say that this pervades all the others, for each one is different from the others, not because of its own nature, but because of participation in the characteristic of different.

TT: Yes, precisely.

ST: Now, let us say the following about these five, taking them up one by one.

TT: What?

ST: First, that motion is completely different from rest. Is this so?

TT: It is so.

ST: So it is not rest.

TT: Not at all.

ST: And yet, because of participation in being, it is.

TT: It is.

256a

ST: Then again, motion is different from the same.

ΞΕ. ἔστι δέ γε διὰ τὸ μετέχειν τοῦ ὄντος. ΘΕΑΙ. ἔστιν. ΞΕ. αὖθις δὴ πάλιν ἢ κίνησις ἕτερον ταύτου ἔστιν. ΘΕΑΙ. σχεδόν. ΞΕ. οὐ ταῦτὸν ἄρα ἐστίν. ΘΕΑΙ. οὐ γὰρ οὖν. ΞΕ. ἀλλὰ μὴν αὕτη γ' ἦν ταῦτὸν διὰ τὸ μετέχειν αὐτὸ πάντ' αὐτοῦ. ΘΕΑΙ. καὶ μάλα. ΞΕ. τὴν κίνησιν δὴ ταῦτόν τ' εἶναι καὶ μὴ ταῦτὸν ὁμολογητέον καὶ οὐ δυσχεραντέον. οὐ γὰρ ὅταν εἴπωμεν αὐτὴν ταῦτόν καὶ μὴ ταῦτόν, ὁμοίως εἰρήκαμεν, ἀλλ' ὁπόταν μὲν

TT: I dare say.

ST: So it is not the same.

TT: No, it is not.

ST: And yet it is the same as itself, because everything partakes of the same.

TT: Yes, indeed.

ST: So we should accept that motion is the same and not the same, without making difficulties. For when we say it is the same and then not the same, we are not speaking in a similar manner. Rather, when we say it is the same, it is because of its participation in the same in relation to itself. And when we say it is not the same, it is because of its communion with different, a communion by which it is separated from the same and becomes not the same but different. So that it is correct, in turn, to say that it is not the same after all.

256b

Tt: Yes, certainly.

ταυτόν, διὰ τὴν μέθεξιν ταύτου πρὸς ἑαυτὴν οὕτω λέγομεν, ὅταν δὲ μὴ ταυτόν, διὰ τὴν κοινωνίαν αὐτὸ θατέρου, δι' ἣν ἀποχωριζομένη ταύτου γέγονεν οὐκ ἐκεῖνο ἀλλ' ἕτερον, ὥστε ὀρθῶς αὐτὸ λέγεται πάλιν οὐ ταυτόν. ΘΕΑΙ. πάνυ μὲν οὖν. ΞΕ. οὐκοῦν κἂν εἴ πη μετελάμβανεν αὐτὴ κίνησις στάσεως, οὐδὲν ἂν ἄτοπον ἦν στάσιμον αὐτὴν προσαγορεύειν; ΘΕΑΙ. ὀρθότατά γε, εἴπερ τῶν γενῶν συγχωρησόμεθα τὰ μὲν ἀλλήλοις ἐθέλιν μείγνυσθαι, τὰ δὲ μή.

St: Yes, and if motion itself were somehow to partake of rest, it would not be strange to say that motion was resting.

Tt: And that is perfectly valid, provided we are going to accept that some of the kinds will mix with one another, and some will not.

St: And, indeed, we arrived at a proof of this before now, establishing that this process is in accordance with nature.

Tt: Of course.

256c

St: Then let's say this once more. Motion is different from the different, just as it was other than the same and rest.

ΞΕ. καὶ μὴν ἐπὶ γε τὴν τούτου πρότερον ἀπόδειξιν ἢ τῶν νῦν ἀφικόμεθα, ἐλέγχοντες ὡς ἔστι κατὰ φύσιν αὕτη. ΘΕΑΙ. πῶς γὰρ οὐ; ΞΕ. λέγωμεν δὴ πάλιν· ἡ κίνησις ἐστὶν ἕτερον τοῦ ἐτέρου, καθάπερ ταύτου τε ἦν ἄλλο καὶ τῆς στάσεως; ΘΕΑΙ. ἀναγκαῖον. ΞΕ. οὐχ ἕτερον ἄρ' ἐστὶ πη καὶ ἕτερον κατὰ τὸν νυνδὴ λόγον. ΘΕΑΙ. ἀληθῆ. ΞΕ. τί οὖν δὴ τὸ μετὰ τοῦτο; ἄρ' αὐτῶν μὲν τριῶν ἕτερον αὐτὴν φήσομεν εἶναι, τοῦ δὲ τετάρτου μὴ φῶμεν,

Tt: Yes, it must be.

St: So, in a sense then, it is not different and it is different, according to the current argument.

Tt: True.

ST: Then, what about the next point? Shall we say that motion is different from three of the kinds but not from the fourth, though we have agreed that there are five items concerning which, and among which, we propose to conduct our enquiry?

TT: How could we? For we cannot accept that their number is less than what was shown a moment ago.

256d

ST: So, should we persist fearlessly in maintaining that motion is different from being?

ὁμολογήσαντες αὐτὰ εἶναι πέντε, περὶ ὧν καὶ ἐν οἷς προυθέμεθα σκοπεῖν; ΘΕΑΙ. καὶ πῶς; ἀδύνατον γὰρ συγχωρεῖν ἐλάττω τὸν ἀριθμὸν τοῦ νυνδὴ φανέντος. ΞΕ. ἀδεῶς ἄρα τὴν κίνησιν ἕτερον εἶναι τοῦ ὄντος διαμαχόμενοι λέγωμεν; ΘΕΑΙ. ἀδεέστατα μὲν οὔν. ΞΕ. οὐκοῦν δὴ σαφῶς ἡ κίνησις ὄντως οὐκ ὄν ἐστι καὶ ὄν, ἐπείπερ τοῦ ὄντος μετέχει; ΘΕΑΙ. σαφέστατά γε. ΞΕ. ἔστιν ἄρα ἐξ ἀνάγκης τὸ μὴ ὄν ἐπὶ τε κινήσεως εἶναι καὶ κατὰ πάντα τὰ γένη κατὰ πάντα γὰρ ἡ θατέρου

TT: Yes, with no fear at all.

ST: Well then, it is clear that motion is actually 'non-being'. And yet it is, since in fact it partakes of being.

TT: Yes, that is perfectly clear.

256e

ST: So, of necessity, what is not is, both in the case of motion and all of the kinds, for in all cases the nature of the different, by rendering each different from what is, makes it what is not. And, indeed, in this way, we are right to say, on the same basis, that all of them are not, and again, because they partake of being, that they are and have being.

φύσις ἕτερον ἀπεργαζομένη τοῦ ὄντος ἕκαστον οὐκ ὄν ποιεῖ, καὶ σύμπαντα δὴ κατὰ ταῦτα οὕτως οὐκ ὄντα ὀρθῶς ἐροῦμεν, καὶ πάλιν, ὅτι μετέχει τοῦ ὄντος, εἶναι τε καὶ ὄντα. ΘΕΑΙ. κινδυνεύει. ΞΕ. περὶ ἕκαστον ἄρα τῶν εἰδῶν πολὺ μὲν ἐστι τὸ ὄν, ἁπείρον δὲ πλήθει τὸ μὴ ὄν. ΘΕΑΙ. ἔοικεν.

TT: Very likely.

ST: So, in the case of each of the forms, 'what is' is many, and 'what is not' is unlimited in multiplicity.

TT: So it seems.

257a

ST: Well then, we must also say that what is, itself, is different from the others.

ΞΕ. οὐκοῦν καὶ τὸ ὄν αὐτὸ τῶν ἄλλων ἕτερον εἶναι λεκτέον. ΘΕΑΙ. ἀνάγκη. ΞΕ. καὶ τὸ ὄν ἄρ' ἡμῖν, ὅσαπέρ ἐστι τὰ ἄλλα, κατὰ τοσαῦτα οὐκ ἔστιν· ἐκεῖνα γὰρ οὐκ ὄν ἐν μὲν αὐτό ἐστιν, ἀπέραντα δὲ τὸν ἀριθμὸν τᾶλλα οὐκ ἔστιν αὐτό. ΘΕΑΙ. σχεδὸν οὕτως. ΞΕ. οὐκοῦν δὴ καὶ ταῦτα οὐ δυσχεραντέον, ἐπεὶ περ ἔχει κοινωνίαν ἀλλήλοις ἢ τῶν γενῶν φύσις. εἰ δέ τις ταῦτα μὴ συγχωρεῖ, πείσας ἡμῶν τοὺς ἔμπροσθεν λόγους οὕτω πειθέτω τὰ μετὰ ταῦτα. ΘΕΑΙ. δικαιοτάτα εἴρηκας.

TT: We must.

ST: And we also found that as many as the others are, to that extent what is, is not. For on the one hand, not being those others it is itself one, and furthermore, it is not, in respect of number, those unlimited others.

TT: Quite so.

ST: Now, we should not make difficulties over these either since the nature of the kinds involves communion with one another. But if anyone does not accept this, he must prevail over our previous arguments and then take on their consequences.

TT: What you propose is very fair.

257b

ST: Well, let us note the following.

ΞΕ. ἴδωμεν δὴ καὶ τόδε. ΘΕΑΙ. τὸ ποῖον; ΞΕ. ὅποταν τὸ μὴ ὄν λέγωμεν, ὥς ἔοικεν, οὐκ ἐναντίον τι λέγομεν τοῦ ὄντος ἀλλ' ἕτερον μόνον. ΘΕΑΙ. πῶς; ΞΕ. οἷον ὅταν εἴπωμέν τι μὴ μέγα, τότε μᾶλλον τί σοι φαινόμεθα

τὸ σμικρὸν ἢ τὸ ἴσον δηλοῦν τῷ ῥήματι; ΘΕΑΙ. καὶ πῶς; ΞΕ. οὐκ ἄρ', ἐναντίον ὅταν ἀπόφασις λέγῃται σημαίνειν, συγχωρησόμεθα, τοσοῦτον δὲ μόνον, ὅτι τῶν ἄλλων τὶ μηνύει

TT: What?

ST: When we speak of 'what is not', it seems we are not speaking of something opposite to 'what is', but only of something different.

TT: In what way?

ST: For example, when we say that something is 'not large', are we indicating by this phrase that it is small rather than equal? Is that how it seems to you?

TT: How could it?

257c

ST: So, whenever it is said that a negative signifies an opposite, we shall not accept that. We shall only go so far as to say that prefixing 'not' or 'non' indicates something else apart from the words which follow, or rather, apart from the things to which the words uttered after the negatives may refer.

τὸ μὴ καὶ τὸ οὐ προτιθέμενα τῶν ἐπιόντων ὀνομάτων, μᾶλλον δὲ τῶν πραγμάτων περὶ ἅττ' ἂν κέηται τὰ ἐπιφθεγγόμενα ὕστερον τῆς ἀποφάσεως ὀνόματα. ΘΕΑΙ. παντάπασι μὲν οὖν. ΞΕ. τόδε δὲ διανοηθῶμεν, εἰ καὶ σοὶ συνδοκεῖ. ΘΕΑΙ. τὸ ποῖον; ΞΕ. ἡ θατέρου μοι φύσις φαίνεται κατακεκερματίσθαι καθάπερ ἐπιστήμη. ΘΕΑΙ. πῶς; ΞΕ. μία μὲν ἐστὶ που καὶ ἐκείνη, τὸ δ' ἐπὶ τῷ γιγνόμενον μέρος αὐτῆς ἕκαστον ἀφορισθὲν ἐπωνυμίαν ἴσχει τινὰ

TT: Entirely so.

ST: Let's think this through as follows, if you agree.

TT: In what way?

ST: It seems to me that the nature of different is broken up in the same way that knowledge is.

TT: How?

ST: Well, presumably knowledge is one, and so is the nature of different, but each portion of knowledge applicable to something in particular has been separated off and given its own particular title. That's why so many skills and branches of knowledge are referred to.

257d

TT: Yes, certainly.

ἐαυτῆς ἰδίαν· διὸ πολλὰ τέχνη τ' εἰσὶ λεγόμεναι καὶ ἐπιστῆμαι. ΘΕΑΙ. πάνυ μὲν οὖν. ΞΕ. οὐκοῦν καὶ τὰ τῆς θατέρου φύσεως μόρια μιᾶς οὔσης ταῦτόν πέπονθε τοῦτο. ΘΕΑΙ. τάχ' ἄν' ἄλλ' ὅπη δὴ λέγωμεν; ΞΕ. ἔστι τῷ καλῷ τι θατέρου μόριον ἀντιτιθέμενον; ΘΕΑΙ. ἔστιν. ΞΕ. τοῦτ' οὖν ἀνώνυμον ἐροῦμεν ἢ τιν' ἔχον ἐπωνυμίαν; ΘΕΑΙ. ἔχον· ὃ γὰρ μὴ καλὸν ἐκάστοτε φθεγγόμεθα, τοῦτο οὐκ ἄλλου τινὸς ἕτερόν ἐστιν ἢ τῆς τοῦ καλοῦ φύσεως. ΞΕ. ἴθι νυν τόδε μοι λέγε.

ST: And although the nature of different is one, the same thing happens to the parts.

TT: Very likely, but how should we describe it?

ST: Is there some part of different which contrasts with beauty?

TT: There is.

ST: Now should we say that this is nameless, or does it have a title of its own?

TT: It has. For each time we mention 'non-beauty', this is different from the nature of beauty, and from nothing else.

257e

ST: Come now, tell me this.

ΘΕΑΙ. τὸ ποῖον; ΞΕ. ἄλλο τι τῶν ὄντων τινὸς ἐνὸς γένους ἀφορισθὲν καὶ πρὸς τι τῶν ὄντων αὖ πάλιν ἀντιτεθὲν οὕτω συμβέβηκεν εἶναι τὸ μὴ καλόν; ΘΕΑΙ. οὕτως. ΞΕ. ὄντος δὴ πρὸς ὃν ἀντίθεσις, ὡς ἔοικ', εἶναι τις συμβαίνει τὸ μὴ καλόν. ΘΕΑΙ. ὀρθότατα. ΞΕ. τί οὖν; κατὰ τοῦτον τὸν

λόγον ἄρα μᾶλλον μὲν τὸ καλὸν ἡμῖν ἐστὶ τῶν ὄντων, ἥττον δὲ τὸ μὴ καλόν; ΘΕΑΙ. οὐδέν.

TT: What?

ST: On this basis, has non-beauty turned out to be some distinct part of a single kind among things that are, and does it, in turn, stand in contrast to another kind among things that are?

TT: It does.

ST: Then it seems non-beauty turns out to be a contrast of 'what is' with 'what is'.

TT: Quite right.

ST: Well then, based on this account, is beauty more included among things that are, and non-beauty less so?

TT: It is not.

258a

ST: So, should we say, on the same basis, that there is non-largeness and largeness itself?

ΞΕ. ὁμοίως ἄρα τὸ μὴ μέγα καὶ τὸ μέγα αὐτὸ εἶναι λεκτέον; ΘΕΑΙ. ὁμοίως. ΞΕ. οὐκοῦν καὶ τὸ μὴ δίκαιον τῷ δικαίῳ κατὰ ταῦτα θετέον πρὸς τὸ μηδέν τι μᾶλλον εἶναι θάτερον θατέρου; ΘΕΑΙ. τί μὴν; ΞΕ. καὶ τᾶλλα δὴ ταύτη λέξομεν, ἐπείπερ ἡ θατέρου φύσις ἐφάνη τῶν ὄντων οὕσα, ἐκείνης δὲ οὔσης ἀνάγκη δὴ καὶ τὰ μόρια αὐτῆς μηδενὸς ἥττον ὄντα τιθέναι. ΘΕΑΙ. πῶς γὰρ οὐ; ΞΕ. οὐκοῦν, ὥς ἔοικεν, ἡ τῆς θατέρου μορίου φύσεως

TT: On the same basis.

ST: And should we therefore place non-justice in the same relation towards justice, in that one is no more than the other is?

TT: Of course.

ST: Well, we shall also describe the others in the same way. Since, in fact, the nature of different has been shown to be included among

things that are, and since it is, we must necessarily propose that the parts of it are also things that are, no less.

TT: Yes, we must.

258b

ST: Therefore, it seems, when part of the nature of different, and part of the nature of 'what is' are set against one another, the contrast is no less being than what is, itself, if such a statement is legitimate, and this contrast is not indicating the opposite of 'what is', but only something different from that.

καὶ τῆς τοῦ ὄντος πρὸς ἄλληλα ἀντικειμένων ἀντίθεσις οὐδὲν ἦττον, εἰ θέμις εἰπεῖν, αὐτοῦ τοῦ ὄντος οὐσία ἐστίν, οὐκ ἐναντίον ἐκείνῳ σημαίνουσα ἀλλὰ τοσοῦτον μόνον, ἕτερον ἐκείνου. ΘΕΑΙ. σαφέστατά γε. ΞΕ. τίς οὖν αὐτὴν προσείπωμεν; ΘΕΑΙ. δῆλον ὅτι τὸ μὴ ὄν, ὃ διὰ τὸν σοφιστὴν ἐζητοῦμεν, αὐτό ἐστι τοῦτο. ΞΕ. πότερον οὖν, ὥσπερ εἶπες, ἔστιν οὐδενὸς τῶν ἄλλων οὐσίας ἐλλειπόμενον, καὶ δεῖ θαρροῦντα ἤδη λέγειν ὅτι τὸ μὴ ὄν βεβαίως ἐστὶ τὴν αὐτοῦ φύσιν ἔχον, ὥσπερ τὸ μέγα

TT: Yes, that is very clear.

ST: So, what should we call this?

TT: Obviously it is 'what is not', the very thing we were seeking because of the sophist.

258c

ST: And does it, as you say, have no less being than anything else? And should we now declare boldly that 'what is not' certainly is, and has its own nature? And just as largeness was large and beauty was beautiful, and the same applied to non-largeness and non-beauty, should we say on the same basis that 'what is not' was and is 'what is not', a single form counted among the many things that are? Do we still have any doubt about this, Theaetetus?

ἦν μέγα καὶ τὸ καλὸν ἦν καλὸν καὶ τὸ μὴ μέγα μὴ μέγα καὶ τὸ μὴ καλὸν μὴ καλόν, οὕτω δὲ καὶ τὸ μὴ ὄν κατὰ ταῦτόν ἦν τε καὶ ἔστι μὴ ὄν, ἐνάριθμον τῶν πολλῶν ὄντων εἶδος ἓν; ἢ τίνα ἔτι πρὸς αὐτό, ὧ

Θεαίτητε, ἀπιστίαν ἔχομεν; ΘΕΑΙ. οὐδεμίαν. ΞΕ. οἷσθ' οὖν ὅτι Παρμενίδῃ μακροτέρως τῆς ἀπορρήσεως ἠπιστήκαμεν; ΘΕΑΙ. τί δῆ; ΞΕ. πλεῖον ἢ 'κεῖνος ἀπεῖπε σκοπεῖν, ἡμεῖς εἰς τὸ πρόσθεν ἔτι ζητήσαντες ἀπεδείξαμεν αὐτῷ. ΘΕΑΙ. πῶς;

TT: Not at all.

258d

ST: Now, do you realise that we have shown little regard for Parmenides' prohibition?

ΞΕ. ὅτι ὁ μὲν πού φησιν—οὐ γὰρ μήποτε τοῦτο δαμῇ, εἶναι μὴ ἔόντα, ἀλλὰ σὺ τῆσδ' ἀφ' ὁδοῦ διζήσιος εἶργε νόημα. ΘΕΑΙ. λέγει γὰρ οὖν οὕτως. ΞΕ. ἡμεῖς δέ γε οὐ μόνον τὰ μὴ ὄντα ὡς ἔστιν ἀπεδείξαμεν, ἀλλὰ καὶ τὸ εἶδος ὃ τυγχάνει ὄν τοῦ μὴ ὄντος ἀπεφηνάμεθα τὴν γὰρ θατέρου φύσιν ἀποδείξαντες οὐσάν

TT: In what way?

ST: In our previous enquiry, we have forged ahead in our search, and presented the man with something he forbade us to consider.

TT: How?

ST: Well, he says, "*For never shall this be proved that things that are not, are, but do thou, in thine enquiry, hold back thy thought from this way.*"

258e

TT: Yes, that is what he says.

τε καὶ κατακεκερματισμένην ἐπὶ πάντα τὰ ὄντα πρὸς ἄλληλα, τὸ πρὸς τὸ ὄν ἕκαστον μῶριον αὐτῆς ἀντιτιθέμενον ἐτολμήσαμεν εἰπεῖν ὡς αὐτὸ τοῦτό ἐστιν ὄντως τὸ μὴ ὄν. ΘΕΑΙ. καὶ παντάπασί γε, ὦ ξέने, ἀληθέστατά μοι δοκοῦμεν εἰρηκέναι. ΞΕ. μὴ τοίνυν ἡμᾶς εἴπη τις ὅτι τούναντίον τοῦ ὄντος τὸ μὴ ὄν ἀποφαινόμενοι τολμῶμεν λέγειν ὡς ἔστιν. ἡμεῖς γὰρ περὶ μὲν ἐναντίου τινὸς αὐτῷ χαίρειν πάλαι λέγομεν,

ST: Yet we have shown not only that things that are not, are. We have also revealed the form upon which 'what is not' happens to be based. In fact, having shown that the nature of different is, and is divided up

among all things that are in relation to one another, we have dared to maintain that each part of different that contrasts with what is, is really 'what is not'.

259a

TT: Yes, stranger, and the statements we have made seem to me to be entirely true.

εἴτ' ἔστιν εἴτε μή, λόγον ἔχον ἢ καὶ παντάπασιν ἄλογον· ὃ δὲ νῦν εἰρήκαμεν εἶναι τὸ μὴ ὄν, ἢ πεισάτω τις ὡς οὐ καλῶς λέγομεν ἐλέγξας, ἢ μέχριπερ ἂν ἀδυνατῇ, λεκτέον καὶ ἐκείνῳ καθάπερ ἡμεῖς λέγομεν, ὅτι συμμείγνυται τε ἀλλήλοις τὰ γένη καὶ τό τε ὄν καὶ θάτερον διὰ πάντων καὶ δι' ἀλλήλων διεληλυθότε τὸ μὲν ἕτερον μετασχὼν τοῦ ὄντος ἔστι μὲν διὰ ταύτην τὴν μέθεξιν, οὐ μὴν ἐκείνῳ γε οὗ μετέσχεν ἄλλ' ἕτερον, ἕτερον δὲ τοῦ ὄντος ὃν ἔστι σαφέστατα ἐξ ἀνάγκης εἶναι μὴ ὄν· τὸ δὲ ὄν αὖ θατέρου μετεληφὸς ἕτερον τῶν ἄλλων ἂν εἴη γενῶν, ἕτερον δ' ἐκείνων ἀπάντων ὃν οὐκ ἔστιν ἕκαστον αὐτῶν οὐδὲ σύμπαντα τὰ ἄλλα πλὴν αὐτό, ὥστε τὸ ὄν ἀναμφισβητήτως αὖ μυρία ἐπὶ μυρίοις οὐκ ἔστι, καὶ τᾶλλα δὴ καθ' ἕκαστον οὕτω καὶ σύμπαντα πολλαχῇ μὲν ἔστι, πολλαχῇ δ' οὐκ ἔστιν. ΘΕΑΙ. ἀληθῆ. ΞΕ. καὶ ταύταις δὴ ταῖς ἐναντιώσεσιν εἴτε ἀπιστεῖ τις, σκεπτέον αὐτῷ καὶ λεκτέον βέλτιόν τι τῶν νῦν εἰρημένων·

ST: Then let no one say that we have dared to maintain that 'what is not' is the opposite of 'what is'. For we long since said farewell to talk of opposite of 'what is', whether there is or is not such a thing, and whether it has an account or is utterly devoid of one. Now, in relation to 'what is not' which we have proposed to be, let someone refute us, and either persuade us that we have not formulated it correctly, or, until he is able to refute it, he must say what we say, that the kinds combine with one another, and 'what is' and the different go through them all, and through one another, and the different, by partaking of 'what is', is, because of that participation, although it is not what it partakes of, but is different. And being different from 'what is', clearly it must be possible for it to be 'what is not'. And, in turn, 'what is', by

partaking of the different, will be other from the other kinds, and since it is different from all of them, it is not each of them, nor all of them together except for itself. Consequently, 'what is' undoubtedly is not, in countless instances, and the others, individually and collectively, are in many cases, but are not in many cases.

259c

Tt: True.

εἴτε ὥς τι χαλεπὸν κατανενοηκῶς χαίρει τοτὲ μὲν ἐπὶ θάτερα τοτὲ δ' ἐπὶ θάτερα τοὺς λόγους ἔλκων, οὐκ ἄξια πολλῆς σπουδῆς ἐσπούδακεν, ὡς οἱ νῦν λόγοι φασί. τοῦτο μὲν γὰρ οὔτε τι κομψὸν οὔτε χαλεπὸν εὐρεῖν, ἐκεῖνο δ' ἤδη καὶ χαλεπὸν ἅμα καὶ καλόν. ΘΕΑΙ. τὸ ποῖον; ΞΕ. ὃ καὶ πρόσθεν εἴρηται, τὸ ταῦτα ἐάσαντα ὡς δυνατὰ τοῖς λεγομένοις οἶόν τ' εἶναι καθ' ἕκαστον ἐλέγχοντα ἐπακολουθεῖν, ὅταν τέ τις ἕτερον ὄν πη ταῦτόν

St: And one who is at a loss to believe these contradictions must consider these matters for himself and offer a better account than we have just given. But if he has taken hold of something difficult, and finds pleasure now in dragging the arguments to one extreme and now to another, his exertions are not worth taking very seriously, as our current arguments would suggest. For this is neither inventive nor difficult to discover. But what is difficult, and beautiful, is something else.

Tt: What is it?

259d

St: What we said before, allowing such considerations as ineffective; to be able to follow what is said, refuting it stage by stage; if anyone proposes that the different is somehow the same, or the same different, in the very respect in which, and the very way that he says one experiences the other. But by saying that the same is somehow different, and the different is the same, and the great is small, and the like is unlike, and to derive pleasure from constantly bringing forward such oppositions in arguments, this is no real refutation. Indeed, it is

obvious that someone who has just appeared on the scene is grasping at a beginning understanding of things that are.

εἶναι φῆ καὶ ὅταν ταῦτόν ὄν ἕτερον, ἐκείνη καὶ κατ' ἐκεῖνο ὃ φησι τούτων πεπονθέναι πότερον. τὸ δὲ ταῦτόν ἕτερον ἀποφαίνειν ἀμῆ γέ πη καὶ τὸ θάτερον ταῦτόν καὶ τὸ μέγα σμικρὸν καὶ τὸ ὅμοιον ἀνόμοιον, καὶ χαίρειν οὕτω τάναντία ἀεὶ προφέροντα ἐν τοῖς λόγοις, οὔτε τις ἔλεγχος οὗτος ἀληθινὸς ἄρτι τε τῶν ὄντων τινὸς ἐφαπτομένου δῆλος νεογενῆς ὢν. ΘΕΑΙ. κομιδῇ μὲν οὖν. ΞΕ. καὶ γάρ, ὠγαθέ, τό γε πᾶν ἀπὸ παντὸς ἐπιχειρεῖν

259e

Tt: Yes, that is so.

ἀποχωρίζειν ἄλλως τε οὐκ ἐμμελές καὶ δὴ καὶ παντάπασιν ἀμούσου τινὸς καὶ ἀφιλοσόφου. ΘΕΑΙ. τί δὴ; ΞΕ. τελεωτάτη πάντων λόγων ἐστὶν ἀφάνισις τὸ διαλύειν ἕκαστον ἀπὸ πάντων· διὰ γὰρ τὴν ἀλλήλων τῶν εἰδῶν συμπλοκὴν ὁ λόγος γέγονεν ἡμῖν. ΘΕΑΙ. ἀληθῆ.

St: Well now, my friend, the attempt to separate everything from everything else is, in general, an inappropriate response and is, in fact, the activity of someone who is uneducated and unphilosophical.

Tt: Why is that?

St: Yes, this very approach of dissociating each thing from everything else is the total disappearance of all argument. Indeed, the interweaving of forms with one another is the basis from which our discourse arises.

260a

Tt: True.

ΞΕ. σκόπει τοίνυν ὡς ἐν καιρῷ νυνδὴ τοῖς τοιούτοις διεμαχόμεθα καὶ προσηναγκάζομεν ἑᾶν ἕτερον ἐτέρῳ μείγνυσθαι. ΘΕΑΙ. πρὸς δὴ τί; ΞΕ. πρὸς τὸ τὸν λόγον ἡμῖν τῶν ὄντων ἐν τι γενῶν εἶναι. τούτου γὰρ στερηθέντες, τὸ μὲν μέγιστον, φιλοσοφίας ἂν στερηθεῖμεν· ἔτι δ' ἐν τῷ παρόντι δεῖ λόγον ἡμᾶς διομολογήσασθαι τί ποτ' ἔστιν, εἰ δὲ

ἀφηρέθημεν αὐτὸ μηδ' εἶναι τὸ παράπαν, οὐδὲν ἂν ἔτι που λέγειν οἱοί τ' ἦμεν.

ST: So, consider the timely battle which we waged just now against people like that, and how we have compelled them to allow one to mix with another.

TT: To what end?

ST: So that argument may continue to exist for us. For we would have been deprived of this if we had also deprived ourselves of the interweaving of forms with one another. Indeed, our argument has somehow arisen for us from the interweaving of forms with one another.

260b

TT: True.

ἀφηρέθημεν δ' ἂν, εἰ συνεχωρήσαμεν μηδεμίαν εἶναι μεῖζιν μηδενὶ πρὸς μηδέν. ΘΕΑΙ. ὀρθῶς τοῦτό γε· λόγον δὲ δι' ὅτι νῦν διομολογητέον οὐκ ἔμαθον. ΞΕ. ἀλλ' ἴσως τῇδ' ἐπόμενος ῥᾶστ' ἂν μάθοις. ΘΕΑΙ. πῃ; ΞΕ. τὸ μὲν δὴ μὴ ὄν ἡμῖν ἔν τι τῶν ἄλλων γένος ὄν ἀνεφάνη, κατὰ πάντα τὰ ὄντα διεσπαρμένον. ΘΕΑΙ. οὕτως. ΞΕ. οὐκοῦν τὸ μετὰ τοῦτο σκεπτέον εἰ δόξη τε καὶ λόγῳ μείγνυται. ΘΕΑΙ. τί δή;

ST: Now since we have got rid of this difficulty, but at the same time agreed that being is to be associated with non-being, perhaps we should now try to consider speech.

TT: How so?

ST: If 'what is not' has nothing to do with speech, all argument is necessarily false, while in fact it has been associated with it, and so there is false speech, and false thinking.

TT: Just so.

ST: But if there is falsity, deception arises.

TT: Yes.

260c

ST: And if there is deception, everything is necessarily full of images, likenesses and appearances.

ΞΕ. μὴ μειγνυμένου μὲν αὐτοῦ τούτοις ἀναγκαῖον ἀληθῆ πάντ' εἶναι, μειγνυμένου δὲ δόξα τε ψευδὴς γίγνεται καὶ λόγος· τὸ γὰρ τὰ μὴ ὄντα δοξάζειν ἢ λέγειν, τοῦτ' ἔστι· που τὸ ψεῦδος ἐν διανοίᾳ τε καὶ λόγοις γιγνόμενον. ΘΕΑΙ. οὕτως. ΞΕ. ὄντος δέ γε ψεύδους ἔστιν ἀπάτη. ΘΕΑΙ. ναί. ΞΕ. καὶ μὴν ἀπάτης οὔσης εἰδώλων τε καὶ εἰκόνων ἤδη καὶ φαντασίας πάντα ἀνάγκη μεστὰ εἶναι. ΘΕΑΙ. πῶς γὰρ οὐ; ΞΕ. τὸν δέ γε σοφιστὴν ἔφαμεν ἐν τούτῳ· που τῷ τόπῳ καταπεφευγέναι μὲν, ἔξαρνον δὲ γεγονέναι τὸ παράπαν μὴδ' εἶναι ψεῦδος· τὸ γὰρ μὴ ὄν οὔτε διανοεῖσθαι τινα οὔτε λέγειν· οὐσίας γὰρ οὐδὲν οὐδαμῇ τὸ μὴ ὄν μετέχειν. ΘΕΑΙ. ἦν ταῦτα. ΞΕ. νῦν δέ γε τοῦτο μὲν ἐφάνη μετέχον τοῦ ὄντος, ὥστε ταύτῃ μὲν ἴσως οὐκ ἂν μάχοιτο ἔτι· τάχα δ' ἂν φαίη τῶν εἰδῶν τὰ μὲν μετέχειν τοῦ μὴ ὄντος, τὰ δ' οὐ, καὶ λόγον δὴ καὶ δόξαν εἶναι τῶν οὐ μετεχόντων, ὥστε τὴν εἰδωλοποιικὴν καὶ φανταστικὴν, ἐν ἧ φάμεν αὐτὸν εἶναι, διαμάχοιτ' ἂν πάλιν ὥς παντάπασιν οὐκ ἔστιν, ἐπεὶ δὲ δόξα καὶ λόγος οὐ κοινωνεῖ τοῦ μὴ ὄντος· ψεῦδος γὰρ τὸ παράπαν οὐκ εἶναι ταύτης μὴ συνισταμένης τῆς κοινωνίας. ΞΕ. διὰ ταῦτ' οὖν λόγον πρῶτον καὶ δόξαν καὶ φαντασίαν διερευνητέον ὅτι ποτ' ἔστιν, ἵνα φανέντων καὶ τὴν κοινωνίαν αὐτῶν τῷ

TT: Of course.

ST: And we said that the sophist took refuge in some such place, but he completely denied that there is falsity at all. For he said that 'what is not' could not be thought or stated, since 'what is not' does not partake of being in any way.

TT: Just so.

ST: And now it has appeared that 'what is not' partakes of being, so he probably will not contest the matter further on that basis. Yet he might say that some of the forms partake of 'what is not', while others do not, and speech and opinion are among those which do not. So in opting again for the contention that the skills of image-making and

appearance-making, in which we said he was contained, do not exist at all, he might also argue that there is no false opinion or speech. For opinion and speech have no communion with 'what is not'. And in the absence of this association, there is no possibility of any falsity. That's why we must first investigate speech, opinion and appearance, to see precisely what they are, so that, having seen them, we shall recognise their communion with 'what is not', and having recognised this, we shall prove that there is falsity, and having proved this, we shall imprison the sophist there, if we can keep our hold of him, and if we cannot, we shall release him and search in another kind.

261a

TT: Stranger, this expression about the sophist at the outset did indeed appear to be true, that this kind is hard to hunt. For he turns out to be replete with stratagems, and whenever he employs them, he must be vanquished before he can be caught. But now, although he has barely been overcome, he is already objecting that 'what is not', is not. For he is a wonder.

μη ὄντι κατίδωμεν, κατιδόντες δὲ τὸ ψεῦδος ὃν ἀποδείξωμεν, ἀποδείξαντες δὲ τὸν σοφιστὴν εἰς αὐτὸ ἐνδήσωμεν, εἴπερ ἔνοχός ἐστιν, ἢ καὶ ἀπολύσαντες ἐν ἄλλῳ γένει ζητῶμεν. ΘΕΑΙ. κομιδῇ δέ γε, ὃ ξένη, ἔοικεν ἀληθὲς εἶναι τὸ περὶ τὸν σοφιστὴν κατ' ἀρχὰς λεχθέν, ὅτι δυσθήρευτον εἶη τὸ γένος. φαίνεται γὰρ οὖν προβλημάτων γέμειν, ὧν ἐπειδάν τι προβάλλῃ, τοῦτο πρότερον ἀναγκαῖον διαμάχεσθαι πρὶν ἐπ' αὐτὸν ἐκείνον ἀφικέσθαι. νῦν γὰρ μόγις μὲν τὸ μη ὄν ὡς οὐκ ἔστι προβληθὲν διεπεράσαμεν, ἕτερον δὲ

ST: Well, my friend, it is the man with greater experience who will be best able to give the more accurate account, since whoever has been confounded for the longest time, often, is more vexed.

261b

TT: A good point.

προβέβληται, καὶ δεῖ δὴ ψεῦδος ὡς ἔστι καὶ περὶ λόγον καὶ περὶ δόξαν ἀποδείξαι, καὶ μετὰ τοῦτο ἴσως ἕτερον, καὶ ἔτ' ἄλλο μετ' ἐκείνου· καὶ

πέρας, ὡς ἔοικεν, οὐδὲν φανήσεται ποτε. ΞΕ. θαρρεῖν, ὦ Θεαίτητε, χρὴ τὸν καὶ σμικρόν τι δυνάμενον εἰς τὸ πρόσθεν αἰεὶ προϊέναι. τί γὰρ ὁ γ' ἄθυμῶν ἐν τούτοις δράσειεν ἂν ἐν ἄλλοις, ἢ μηδὲν ἐν ἐκείνοις ἀνύτων ἢ καὶ πάλιν εἰς τοῦπισθεν ἀπωσθείς; σχολῇ που, τὸ κατὰ

ST: Well, let's continue with the present argument and not get vexed.

TT: Why should we?

ST: Indeed, what comes first, in my view, is the question of speech, just as it was earlier in the case of the forms. For this is what we need to consider now: is 'what is not' associated with this too, or is speech entirely true, with no falsity ever arising in this?

TT: Yes, this is what we should consider.

261c

ST: Come now, since we said as much in relation to the forms and letters of the alphabet, let's consider names again in the same way.

τὴν παροιμίαν λεγόμενον, ὅ γε τοιοῦτος ἂν ποτε ἔλοι πόλιν. νῦν δ' ἐπεὶ, ὡγαθέ, τοῦτο ὃ λέγεις διαπεπέρανται, τό τοι μέγιστον ἡμῖν τεῖχος ἡρημένον ἂν εἴη, τὰ δ' ἄλλα ἤδη ῥάω καὶ σμικρότερα. ΘΕΑΙ. καλῶς εἶπες. ΞΕ. λόγον δὴ πρῶτον καὶ δόξαν, καθάπερ ἐρρήθη νυνδὴ, λάβωμεν, ἵνα ἐναργέστερον ἀπολογισώμεθα πότερον αὐτῶν ἅπτεται τὸ μὴ ὂν ἢ παντάπασιν ἀληθῆ μὲν ἐστὶν ἀμφοτέρω ταῦτα, ψεῦδος δὲ οὐδέποτε οὐδέτερον. ΘΕΑΙ. ὀρθῶς.

TT: Yes, but what should we look for in them?

ST: Whether they all combine with one another, none of them combine, or some can do so, while others cannot.

TT: Well, this is clear in any case: that some can and some cannot.

ST: Perhaps you mean the following: that any words which are uttered in succession and indicate something are combined, while those which are not significant when uttered in succession are not combined.

261d

TT: What you say? Why?

ΞΕ. φέρε δή, καθάπερ περὶ τῶν εἰδῶν καὶ τῶν γραμμάτων ἐλέγομεν, περὶ τῶν ὀνομάτων πάλιν ὡσαύτως ἐπισκεψώμεθα. φαίνεται γάρ πη ταύτῃ τὸ νῦν ζητούμενον. ΘΕΑΙ. τὸ ποῖον οὖν δὴ περὶ τῶν ὀνομάτων ὑπακουστέον; ΞΕ. εἴτε πάντα ἀλλήλοις συναρμόττει εἴτε μηδέν, εἴτε τὰ μὲν ἐθέλει, τὰ δὲ μή. ΘΕΑΙ. δῆλον τοῦτό γε, ὅτι τὰ μὲν ἐθέλει, τὰ δ' οὐ. ΞΕ. τὸ τοιόνδε λέγεις ἴσως, ὅτι τὰ μὲν ἐφεξῆς λεγόμενα

ST: I imagined that you were making the same response that I have actually had in mind. Indeed, we recognise two kinds of vocal expressions about being.

TT: How?

ST: One is referred to as a name, and the other as a verb.

TT: Tell me what each of these is.

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ST: The expression that applies to actions, we presumably refer to as a verb.

καὶ δηλοῦντά τι συναρμόττει, τὰ δὲ τῇ συνεχείᾳ μηδέν σημαίνοντα ἀναρμοστεῖ. ΘΕΑΙ. πῶς τί τοῦτ' εἶπας; ΞΕ. ὅπερ ὠήθην ὑπολαβόντα σε προσομολογεῖν. ἔστι γὰρ ἡμῖν που τῶν τῇ φωνῇ περὶ τὴν οὐσίαν δηλωμάτων διττὸν γένος. ΘΕΑΙ. πῶς;

TT: Yes.

ST: While the vocal label applicable to those who perform such actions is a name.

TT: Quite so.

ST: Well, no statement can ever arise from a string of names that are uttered in succession, or even of verbs separated from names.

TT: I do not understand.

262a

ST: Yes, it was clear when you responded just now that what I am saying is different. For my point was that the sequence does not

constitute a statement.

ΞΕ. τὸ μὲν ὀνόματα, τὸ δὲ ῥήματα κληθέν. ΘΕΑΙ. εἰπὲ ἑκάτερον. ΞΕ. τὸ μὲν ἐπὶ ταῖς πράξεσιν ὃν δήλωμα ῥήμα που λέγομεν. ΘΕΑΙ. ναί. ΞΕ. τὸ δέ γ' ἐπ' αὐτοῖς τοῖς ἐκείνας πράττουσι σημεῖον τῆς φωνῆς ἐπιτεθὲν ὄνομα. ΘΕΑΙ. κομιδῇ μὲν οὖν. ΞΕ. οὐκοῦν ἐξ ὀνομάτων μὲν μόνων συνεχῶς λεγομένων οὐκ ἔστι ποτὲ λόγος, οὐδ' αὖ ῥημάτων χωρὶς ὀνομάτων λεχθέντων. ΘΕΑΙ. ταῦτ' οὐκ ἔμαθον. ΞΕ. δῆλον γὰρ ὡς πρὸς ἕτερόν τι βλέπων ἄρτι συνωμολόγεις· ἐπεὶ τοῦτ' αὐτὸ ἐβουλόμην εἰπεῖν, ὅτι συνεχῶς ὧδε λεγόμενα ταῦτα οὐκ ἔστι λόγος. ΘΕΑΙ. πῶς; ΞΕ. οἷον βαδίζει τρέχει καθεύδει, καὶ τᾶλλα ὅσα πράξεις σημαίνει ῥήματα, καὶ πάντα τις ἐφεξῆς αὐτ' εἴπῃ, λόγον οὐδέν τι μᾶλλον ἀπεργάζεται. ΘΕΑΙ. πῶς γάρ; ΞΕ. οὐκοῦν καὶ πάλιν ὅταν λέγῃται λέων ἔλαφος ἵππος, ὅσα τε ὀνόματα τῶν τὰς πράξεις αὐτῶν πραττόντων

TT: How?

ST: Take for instance "walks, runs, sleeps", and the other verbs which signify actions: even if someone were to recite them all in turn, that would not constitute any statement at all.

TT: Why not?

ST: So again, when "lion, stag, horse" are uttered, and any other names of those who perform actions, this sequence does not constitute a statement either. Indeed, neither in the first case nor in this one are the spoken words associated with any action, or in actuality, of one who acts or does not act. Nor will it ever do so, until someone mixes verbs with names. And as soon as he does so, the joining together produces a statement, the first and the smallest of statements, I dare say.

262c

TT: What do you mean by this?

ὠνομάσθη, καὶ κατὰ ταύτην δὴ τὴν συνέχειαν οὐδεὶς πω συνέστη λόγος· οὐδεμίαν γὰρ οὔτε οὕτως οὔτ' ἐκείνως πράξιν οὐδ' ἀπραξίαν οὐδὲ οὐσίαν ὄντος οὐδὲ μὴ ὄντος δηλοῖ τὰ φωνηθέντα, πρὶν ἄν τις τοῖς

ὀνόμασι τὰ ῥήματα κεράσῃ. τότε δ' ἤρμοσέν τε καὶ λόγος ἐγένετο εὐθύς ἢ πρώτη συμπλοκή, σχεδὸν τῶν λόγων ὁ πρῶτός τε καὶ σμικρότατος. ΘΕΑΙ. πῶς ἄρ' ὧδε λέγεις; ΞΕ. ὅταν εἴπῃ τις ἄνθρωπος μανθάνει, λόγον εἶναι φῆς τοῦτον ἐλάχιστόν τε καὶ πρῶτον;

ST: Whenever someone says, "a man understands", do you say that this is the shortest and the first statement?

TT: I do.

ST: Indeed, it now provides some information about what is, becomes, has become or is to become, and not just naming, but enacting something by combining verbs with names. That is why we have said that it has spoken, and not merely named. And what is more, this combination is the very thing to which we attached the title 'speech'.

TT: Correct.

262d

ST: Now, just as some things fit together with one another, while others do not, the same applies to vocal expressions, some of which do not fit together, while those that do fit together produce statements.

ΘΕΑΙ. ἔγωγε. ΞΕ. δηλοῖ γὰρ ἤδη που τότε περὶ τῶν ὄντων ἢ γιγνομένων ἢ γεγονότων ἢ μελλόντων, καὶ οὐκ ὀνομάζει μόνον ἀλλὰ τι περαίνει, συμπλέκων τὰ ῥήματα τοῖς ὀνόμασι. διὸ λέγειν τε αὐτὸν ἀλλ' οὐ μόνον ὀνομάζειν εἵπομεν, καὶ δὴ καὶ τῷ πλέγματι τούτῳ τὸ ὄνομα ἐφθελγᾶμεθα λόγον. ΘΕΑΙ. ὀρθῶς. ΞΕ. οὕτω δὲ καθάπερ τὰ πράγματα τὰ μὲν ἀλλήλοις ἤρμωσεν, τὰ δ' οὐ, καὶ περὶ τὰ τῆς φωνῆς αὐτῶν σημεῖα τὰ μὲν

TT: Just so.

ST: But there is still one further consideration.

TT: What?

ST: Whenever there is a statement, it must be a statement about something. Indeed, a statement about nothing is impossible.

TT: Just so.

ST: And it must, of course, also have a particular quality.

TT: Of course.

ST: So now, let's take note of ourselves.

TT: Yes, we should.

262e

ST: Then I shall make a statement to you, putting things and actions together by means of a name and a verb. You should indicate to me what the statement is about.

οὐχ ἀρμόττει, τὰ δὲ ἀρμόττοντα αὐτῶν λόγον ἀπηργάσατο. ΘΕΑΙ. παντάπασι μὲν οὖν. ΞΕ. ἔτι δὴ σμικρὸν τόδε. ΘΕΑΙ. τὸ ποῖον; ΞΕ. λόγον ἀναγκαῖον, ὅτανπερ ἦ, τινὸς εἶναι λόγον, μὴ δὲ τινὸς ἀδύνατον. ΘΕΑΙ. οὕτως. ΞΕ. οὐκοῦν καὶ ποιόν τινα αὐτὸν εἶναι δεῖ; ΘΕΑΙ. πῶς δ' οὐ; ΞΕ. προσέχωμεν δὴ τὸν νοῦν ἡμῖν αὐτοῖς. ΘΕΑΙ. δεῖ γοῦν. ΞΕ. λέξω τοίνυν σοι λόγον συνθεῖς πρᾶγμα πράξει δι' ὀνόματος καὶ ῥήματος· ὅτου δ' ἂν ὁ λόγος ἦ, σύ μοι φράζειν.

TT: Yes, just as far as I can.

ST: "Theaetetus is sitting." Surely that is not a long statement?

TT: No, it has just the right measure.

ST: Now it is your turn to say what it is about, and to whom it refers.

TT: Quite clear that it is about me, and refers to me.

263a

ST: Then what about this one?

ΘΕΑΙ. ταῦτ' ἔσται κατὰ δύναμιν. ΞΕ. Θεαίτητος κάθηται. μῶν μὴ μακρὸς ὁ λόγος; ΘΕΑΙ. οὐκ, ἀλλὰ μέτριος. ΞΕ. σὸν ἔργον δὴ φράζειν περὶ οὗ τ' ἐστὶ καὶ ὅτου. ΘΕΑΙ. δῆλον ὅτι περὶ ἐμοῦ τε καὶ ἐμός. ΞΕ. τί δὲ ὅδ' αὖ; ΘΕΑΙ. ποῖος; ΞΕ. Θεαίτητος, ᾧ νῦν ἐγὼ διαλέγομαι, πέτεται. ΘΕΑΙ. καὶ τοῦτον οὐδ' ἂν εἷς ἄλλως εἴποι πλὴν ἐμόν τε καὶ περὶ ἐμοῦ. ΞΕ. ποιὸν δὲ γέ τινά φαμεν ἀναγκαῖον ἕκαστον εἶναι τῶν λόγων.

TT: What?

ST: "Theaetetus, with whom I am conversing right now, is flying."

TT: No one could deny that this too is mine, and refers to me.

ST: And we maintain that each of these is necessarily of some quality.

TT: Yes.

ST: Now, what quality should we say each of these has?

TT: One is false, the other true.

ST: And the true one indicates the things that are, as they are, in your case.

263b

TT: Just so.

ΘΕΑΙ. ναί. ΞΕ. τούτων δὴ ποῖόν τινα ἐκάτερον φατέον εἶναι; ΘΕΑΙ. τὸν μὲν ψευδῇ που, τὸν δὲ ἀληθῇ. ΞΕ. λέγει δὲ αὐτῶν ὁ μὲν ἀληθὲς τὰ ὄντα ὡς ἔστιν περὶ σοῦ. ΘΕΑΙ. τί μὴν; ΞΕ. ὁ δὲ δὴ ψευδὲς ἕτερα τῶν ὄντων. ΘΕΑΙ. ναί. ΞΕ. τὰ μὴ ὄντ' ἄρα ὡς ὄντα λέγει. ΘΕΑΙ. σχεδόν. ΞΕ. ὄντων δέ γε ὄντα ἕτερα περὶ σοῦ. πολλὰ μὲν γὰρ ἔφαμεν ὄντα περὶ ἕκαστον εἶναί που, πολλὰ δὲ οὐκ ὄντα. ΘΕΑΙ. κομιδῇ μὲν οὖν.

ST: While the false one indicates things that are different from things that are.

TT: Yes.

ST: Then it speaks of things that are not, as if they are.

TT: Just so.

ST: But it speaks of things that are, though they are different from things that are about you. For we have said, you remember, that in the case of each, there are many things that are, and also many that are not.

TT: Entirely so.

263c

ST: Now, the second statement I made about you, in the first place, based on the way we have defined statement, must necessarily be one of the shortest.

ΞΕ. ὃν ὕστερον δὴ λόγον εἶρηκα περὶ σοῦ, πρῶτον μὲν, ἐξ ὧν ὠρισάμεθα τί ποτ' ἔστι λόγος, ἀναγκαιότατον αὐτὸν ἓνα τῶν βραχυτάτων εἶναι. ΘΕΑΙ. νυνδὴ γοῦν ταύτη συνωμολογήσαμεν. ΞΕ. ἔπειτα δέ γε τινός. ΘΕΑΙ. οὕτως. ΞΕ. εἰ δὲ μὴ ἔστιν σός, οὐκ ἄλλου γε οὐδενός. ΘΕΑΙ. πῶς γάρ; ΞΕ. μηδενὸς δέ γε ὧν οὐδ' ἂν λόγος εἴη τὸ παράπαν· ἀπεφίναμεν γὰρ ὅτι τῶν ἀδυνάτων ἦν λόγον ὄντα μηδενὸς εἶναι λόγον. ΘΕΑΙ. ὀρθότατα.

TT: Well, that's how it was agreed just now anyway.

ST: And, then, in turn, the statement must be about someone.

TT: Yes.

ST: And if it is not about you, surely it is not about anyone else.

TT: Indeed not.

ST: And it would not even be a statement at all if it were about no one. For we showed that it was impossible for there to be a statement which is a statement about nothing.

TT: Quite right.

263d

ST: Then, in this statement about you, when different things are stated as the same and 'what is not' as 'what is', it appears that the combination of verbs with names absolutely turns out to be a real and true false statement.

ΞΕ. περὶ δὴ σοῦ λεγόμενα, λεγόμενα μέντοι θάτερα ὥς τὰ αὐτὰ καὶ μὴ ὄντα ὥς ὄντα, παντάπασιν ὥς ἔοικεν ἡ τοιαύτη σύνθεσις ἔκ τε ῥημάτων γιγνομένη καὶ ὀνομάτων ὄντως τε καὶ ἀληθῶς γίγνεσθαι λόγος ψευδής. ΘΕΑΙ. ἀληθέστατα μὲν οὖν. ΞΕ. τί δὲ δὴ; διάνοιά τε καὶ δόξα καὶ φαντασία, μῶν οὐκ ἦδη δῆλον ὅτι ταυτά γε ψευδῆ τε καὶ ἀληθῆ πάνθ'

ἡμῶν ἐν ταῖς ψυχαῖς ἐγγίγνεται; ΘΕΑΙ. πῶς; ΞΕ. ὥδ' εἴση ῥᾶον, ἂν
πρῶτον λάβῃς αὐτὰ τί ποτ' ἔστιν

TT: Very true.

ST: Now, what about thought, opinion and appearance? Isn't it already clear that all of these become both true and false in our souls?

TT: How?

263e

ST: You will recognise this more easily if you first realise what each of these is, and how each differs from one another.

καὶ τί διαφέρουσιν ἕκαστα ἀλλήλων. ΘΕΑΙ. δίδου μόνον. ΞΕ. οὐκοῦν
διάνοια μὲν καὶ λόγος ταυτόν· πλὴν ὁ μὲν ἐντὸς τῆς ψυχῆς πρὸς αὐτὴν
διάλογος ἄνευ φωνῆς γιγνόμενος τοῦτ' αὐτὸ ἡμῖν ἐπωνομάσθη,
διάνοια; ΘΕΑΙ. πάνυ μὲν οὖν. ΞΕ. τὸ δέ γ' ἀπ' ἐκείνης ῥεῦμα διὰ τοῦ
στόματος ἰὸν μετὰ φθόγγου κέκληται λόγος; ΘΕΑΙ. ἀληθῆ. ΞΕ. καὶ μὴν
ἐν λόγοις γε αὖ ἴσμεν ἐνὸν— ΘΕΑΙ. τὸ ποῖον; ΞΕ. φάσιν τε καὶ ἀπόφασιν.
ΘΕΑΙ. ἴσμεν.

TT: Just tell me.

ST: Now, are not thought and speech the same, except that the silent dialogue of the soul with itself has been given the name 'thought'?

TT: Quite so.

ST: And the flow from the soul to the mouth which is vocally expressed has been given the name 'speech'.

TT: True.

264a

ST: And what's more, we know that the following arises in speech.

ΞΕ. ὅταν οὖν τοῦτο ἐν ψυχῇ κατὰ διάνοιαν ἐγγίγνηται μετὰ σιγῆς, πλὴν
δόξης ἔχεις ὅτι προσείπῃς αὐτό; ΘΕΑΙ. καὶ πῶς; ΞΕ. τί δ' ὅταν μὴ καθ'
αὐτὸ ἀλλὰ δι' αἰσθήσεως παρῇ τινι, τὸ τοιοῦτον αὖ πάθος ἄρ' οἷόν τε
ὀρθῶς εἰπεῖν ἕτερόν τι πλὴν φαντασίαν; ΘΕΑΙ. οὐδέν. ΞΕ. οὐκοῦν

ἐπείπερ λόγος ἀληθῆς ἦν καὶ ψευδής, τούτων δ' ἐφάνη διάνοια μὲν αὐτῆς πρὸς ἑαυτὴν ψυχῆς διάλογος,

TT: What is that?

ST: Affirmation and denial.

TT: Yes, we know that.

ST: So when this happens in the soul through thought, in silence, can you call it anything other than opinion?

TT: What else?

ST: What about this? Whenever such an experience arises in someone, not through himself but on account of perception, is there another appropriate name for this experience, except 'appearance'?

TT: There is not.

264b

ST: Then, since speech turned out to be both true and false, and we showed that thought is the discourse of the soul with itself; and that opinion is the conclusion of thought; and what we mean by 'it appears' is a combination of perception and opinion; isn't it the case that any of these must be false sometimes since they are kindred to speech?

δόξα δὲ διανοίας ἀποτελεύτησις, φαίνεται δὲ ὁ λέγομεν σύμμειξις αἰσθήσεως καὶ δόξης, ἀνάγκη δὲ καὶ τούτων τῷ λόγῳ συγγενῶν ὄντων ψευδῇ τε αὐτῶν ἔνια καὶ ἐνίστε εἶναι. ΘΕΑΙ. πῶς δ' οὐ; ΞΕ. κατανοεῖς οὖν ὅτι πρότερον ἠύρεθι ψευδῆς δόξα καὶ λόγος ἢ κατὰ τὴν προσδοκίαν ἦν ἐφοβήθημεν ἄρτι, μὴ παντάπασιν ἀνήνυτον ἔργον ἐπιβαλλοίμεθα ζητοῦντες αὐτό; ΘΕΑΙ. κατανοῶ. ΞΕ. μὴ τοίνυν μὴδ' εἰς τὰ λοιπὰ ἀθυμῶμεν. ἐπειδὴ

TT: Of course.

264c

ST: Then do you appreciate that there has been an earlier discovery of false opinion and speech than was expected, when we feared that we

were taking on an entirely impossible task by setting out in search of it?

γὰρ πέφανται ταῦτα, τῶν ἔμπροσθεν ἀναμνησθῶμεν κατ' εἶδη διαιρέσεων. ΘΕΑΙ. ποίων δῆ; ΞΕ. διειλόμεθα τῆς εἰδωλοποιικῆς εἶδη δύο, τὴν μὲν εἰκαστικὴν, τὴν δὲ φανταστικὴν. ΘΕΑΙ. ναί. ΞΕ. καὶ τὸν σοφιστὴν εἴπομεν ὡς ἀποροῖμεν εἰς ὁποτέραν θήσομεν. ΘΕΑΙ. ἦν ταῦτα. ΞΕ. καὶ τοῦθ' ἡμῶν ἀπορουμένων ἔτι μείζων κατεχύθη σκοτοδινία, φανέντος τοῦ λόγου τοῦ πᾶσιν ἀμφισβητοῦντος ὡς οὔτε εἰκῶν οὔτε εἰδῶλον οὔτε φάντασμι' εἴη τὸ παράπαν

TT: I do.

ST: Then we should not become disheartened by what remains. For since these have become apparent, we should recall the previous divisions on the basis of forms.

TT: Which ones?

ST: Well, we divided image-making into two forms: likeness-making and appearance-making.

TT: Yes.

264d

ST: And we said that we were perplexed about which of these we would place the sophist in.

οὐδὲν διὰ τὸ μηδαμῶς μηδέποτε μηδαμοῦ ψευδὸς εἶναι. ΘΕΑΙ. λέγεις ἀληθῆ. ΞΕ. νῦν δέ γ' ἐπειδὴ πέφανται μὲν λόγος, πέφανται δ' οὔσα δόξα ψευδής, ἐγχωρεῖ δὴ μιμήματα τῶν ὄντων εἶναι καὶ τέχνην ἐκ αὐτῆς γίνεσθαι τῆς διαθέσεως ἀπατητικὴν. ΘΕΑΙ. ἐγχωρεῖ. ΞΕ. καὶ μὴν ὅτι γ' ἦν ὁ σοφιστὴς τούτων πότερον, διωμολογημένον ἡμῖν ἐν τοῖς πρόσθεν ἦν. ΘΕΑΙ. ναί. ΞΕ. πάλιν τοῖνυν ἐπιχειρῶμεν, σχίζοντες διχῆ τὸ

TT: So we did.

ST: And while we were unsure about this, even greater confusion arose for us, with the appearance of the argument which would dispute these, and maintain that there is no such thing as a likeness, image or

appearance, since in no case at all is there any falsity, either in any way or at any time.

TT: What you say is true.

ST: But now, since false speech and false opinion have appeared, it is possible for there to be imitations of things that are, and from this disposition, a skill in deception arises.

264e

TT: Yes, it is possible.

προτεθὲν γένος, πορεύεσθαι κατὰ τοῦπὶ δεξιὰ ἀεὶ μέρος τοῦ τμηθέντος, ἔχόμενοι τῆς τοῦ σοφιστοῦ κοινωνίας, ἕως ἂν αὐτοῦ τὰ κοινὰ πάντα περιελόντες, τὴν οἰκείαν λιπόντες

ST: And, indeed, we agreed earlier that the sophist was located in one of the divisions mentioned.

TT: Yes.

ST: Then let's try again, take the proposed kind and divide it in two, all the while proceeding to the right-hand part of what is being divided, holding on to the communion of the sophist, until we strip away whatever is common to the others, leaving only his own particular nature, which we shall display, first to ourselves, and then to those who are by nature most kindred to such a method.

265a

TT: Right.

φύσιν ἐπιδείξωμεν μάλιστα μὲν ἡμῖν αὐτοῖς, ἔπειτα καὶ τοῖς ἐγγυτάτω γένει τῆς τοιαύτης μεθόδου πεφυκόσιν. ΘΕΑΙ. ὀρθῶς. ΞΕ. οὐκοῦν τότε μὲν ἡρχόμεθα ποιητικὴν καὶ κτητικὴν τέχνην διαιρούμενοι; ΘΕΑΙ. ναί. ΞΕ. καὶ τῆς κτητικῆς ἐν θηρευτικῇ καὶ ἀγωνίᾳ καὶ ἐμπορικῇ καὶ τισιν ἐν τοιούτοις εἵδεσιν ἐφαντάζεθ' ἡμῖν; ΘΕΑΙ. πάνυ μὲν οὖν. ΞΕ. νῦν δέ γ' ἐπειδὴ μιμητικὴ περιείληφεν αὐτὸν τέχνη, δηλὸν ὡς αὐτὴν τὴν ποιητικὴν δίχα διαιρετέον πρῶτην.

ST: Now, didn't we begin by dividing skill at that time into productive and acquisitive?

TT: Yes.

ST: And the sophist appeared to us in the acquisitive parts of hunting, contest, retailing, and certain kinds of that sort.

TT: Yes, certainly.

265b

ST: But now, since he has been included under the skill of imitation, it is clear that we should first divide the productive skill in two. For presumably the skill of imitation is some kind of making, except that we shall say that it makes images, but not actual things. Is this so?

ή γάρ που μίμησις ποίησίς τις ἔστιν, εἰδῶλων μέντοι, φαμέν, ἀλλ' οὐκ αὐτῶν ἐκάστων· ἥ γάρ; ΘΕΑΙ. παντάπασι μὲν οὖν. ΞΕ. ποιητικῆς δὴ πρῶτον δύ' ἔστω μέρη. ΘΕΑΙ. ποίω; ΞΕ. τὸ μὲν θεῖον, τὸ δ' ἀνθρώπινον. ΘΕΑΙ. οὐπω μεμάθηκα. ΞΕ. ποιητικὴν, εἴπερ μεμνήμεθα τὰ κατ' ἀρχὰς λεχθέντα, πᾶσαν ἔφαμεν εἶναι δύναμιν ἣτις ἂν αἰτία γίγνηται τοῖς μὴ πρότερον οὖσιν ὕστερον γίγνεσθαι. ΘΕΑΙ. μεμνήμεθα.

TT: Yes, entirely so.

ST: Now, in the first place, let there be two parts of the productive skill.

TT: What are they?

ST: The divine and the human.

TT: I do not yet understand.

ST: If you remember what was said at the start, we said that all production is the power which gives rise to whatever was not, previously.

TT: We remember.

265c

ST: Now, with regard to all mortal animals, and as for all things that grow on earth from seeds and roots, and the lifeless bodies, with or without souls, that are formed within the earth: shall we say that some other than god is the producer who gives rise to them from non-being? Or are we to say what most people say and accept?

ΞΕ. ζῶα δὴ πάντα θνητά, καὶ δὴ καὶ φυτὰ ὅσα τ' ἐπὶ γῆς ἐκ σπερμάτων καὶ ῥιζῶν φύεται, καὶ ὅσα ἄψυχα ἐν γῇ συνίσταται σώματα τηκτὰ καὶ ἄτηκτα, μῶν ἄλλου τινὸς ἢ θεοῦ δημιουργοῦντος φήσομεν ὕστερον γίγνεσθαι πρότερον οὐκ ὄντα; ἢ τῷ τῶν πολλῶν δόγματι καὶ ῥήματι χρώμενοι— **ΘΕΑΙ.** ποίῳ τῷ; **ΞΕ.** τὴν φύσιν αὐτὰ γεννᾶν ἀπὸ τινος αἰτίας αὐτομάτης καὶ ἄνευ διανοίας φουούσης, ἢ μετὰ λόγου τε καὶ ἐπιστήμης θείας ἀπὸ θεοῦ γιγνομένης;

TT: What?

ST: That nature gives rise to them through some spontaneous cause that produces them without intelligence. Or are they produced with reasoning and divine knowledge that comes from god?

265d

TT: I myself, perhaps due to my age, often shift my views from one of these positions to the other. However, looking at you now, and noticing that you think that these things have arisen through divine agency, I myself also believe this is the case.

ΘΕΑΙ. ἐγὼ μὲν ἴσως διὰ τὴν ἡλικίαν πολλάκις ἀμφότερα μεταδοξάζω· νῦν μὴν βλέπων εἰς σὲ καὶ ὑπολαμβάνων οἶεσθαί σε κατὰ γε θεὸν αὐτὰ γίγνεσθαι, ταύτη καὶ αὐτὸς νενόμικα. **ΞΕ.** καλῶς γε, ὦ Θεαίτητε. καὶ εἰ μὲν γέ σε ἡγούμεθα τῶν εἰς τὸν ἔπειτ' ἂν χρόνον ἄλλως πως δοξαζόντων εἶναι, νῦν ἂν τῷ λόγῳ μετὰ πειθοῦς ἀναγκαίας ἐπεχειροῦμεν ποιεῖν ὁμολογεῖν· ἐπειδὴ δέ σου καταμανθάνω τὴν φύσιν, ὅτι καὶ

ST: Good, Theaetetus, and if we thought that you were one of those people who would think differently in the future, we would now try, by means of an argument involving compelling persuasiveness, to

make you agree. But since I am aware of your nature and recognise that even without our arguments, it is moving on by itself in the direction you say it is now inclined, I shall let the matter rest, for it would be a waste of time. Instead, let me propose that what are said to be the products of nature are produced by divine skill, while products that come from these products and are produced by humans, are produced by human skill. And, based on this account, there are two kinds of productive skill, the human and the divine.

265e

TT: Right.

ἄνευ τῶν παρ' ἡμῶν λόγων αὐτὴ πρόσσεισιν ἐφ' ἅπερ νῦν ἔλκεσθαι φής, ἔάσω· χρόνος γὰρ ἐκ περιττοῦ γίγνοιτ' ἄν. ἀλλὰ θήσω τὰ μὲν φύσει λεγόμενα ποιεῖσθαι θεία τέχνη, τὰ δ' ἐκ τούτων ὑπ' ἀνθρώπων συνιστάμενα ἀνθρωπίνη, καὶ κατὰ τοῦτον δὴ τὸν λόγον δύο ποιητικῆς γένη, τὸ μὲν ἀνθρώπινον εἶναι, τὸ δὲ θεῖον. ΘΕΑΙ. ὀρθῶς. ΞΕ. τέμνε δὴ δυοῖν οὔσαιν δίχα ἐκατέραν αὖθις. ΘΕΑΙ. πῶς;

ST: Now, since there are two of these, divide each of them again in two.

TT: How?

ST: As though you were dividing the whole production skill widthwise just now, divide it lengthwise this time.

TT: Take it as done.

266a

ST: In this way, there are now four parts in total: the two human parts on our side, and the two divine parts on the side of the gods.

ΞΕ. οἷον τότε μὲν κατὰ πλάτος τέμνων τὴν ποιητικὴν πᾶσαν, νῦν δὲ αὖ κατὰ μῆκος. ΘΕΑΙ. τετμήσθω. ΞΕ. τέτταρα μὲν αὐτῆς οὕτω τὰ πάντα μέρη γίγνεται, δύο μὲν τὰ πρὸς ἡμῶν, ἀνθρώπεια, δύο δ' αὖ τὰ πρὸς θεῶν, θεῖα. ΘΕΑΙ. ναί. ΞΕ. τὰ δέ γ' ὥς ἐτέρως αὖ διηρημένα, μέρος μὲν ἐν ἅφ' ἐκατέρας τῆς μερίδος αὐτοποιητικόν, τῷ δ' ὑπολοίπῳ σχεδὸν μάλιστ' ἂν λεγοίσθην εἰδωλοποιικόν· καὶ κατὰ ταῦτα δὴ πάλιν ἡ ποιητικὴ διχῇ διαιρεῖται.

Tt: Yes.

St: And, in turn, when divided in the other way, one part of each section is itself a making, while what remains in both cases is most accurately referred to as an image-making, and so production becomes two-fold again.

Tt: Tell me again how this division goes.

266b

St: Well, presumably we ourselves, and the other animals, and the things from which natural objects come – fire, water and their kindred – we know that all of these are produced by the god, who has made each of them. Is this so?

ΘΕΑΙ. λέγε ὅπῃ ἑκατέρω αὐτοῖς. ΞΕ. ἡμεῖς μὲν ποὺ καὶ τᾶλλα ζῶα καὶ ἐξ ὧν τὰ πεφυκότ' ἐστίν, πῦρ καὶ ὕδωρ καὶ τὰ τούτων ἀδελφά, θεοῦ γεννήματα πάντα ἴσμεν αὐτὰ ἀπειργασμένα ἕκαστα· ἢ πῶς; ΘΕΑΙ. οὕτως. ΞΕ. τούτων δέ γε ἐκάστων εἶδωλα ἀλλ' οὐκ αὐτὰ παρέπεται, δαιμονία καὶ ταῦτα μηχανῇ γεγονότα. ΘΕΑΙ. ποῖα; ΞΕ. τὰ τε ἐν τοῖς ὕπνοις καὶ ὅσα μεθ' ἡμέραν φαντάσματα αὐτοφυῇ λέγεται, σκιὰ μὲν ὅταν ἐν τῷ πυρὶ σκότος

Tt: Yes.

St: Following each of these, there are images, not the things themselves, and they have also come about through divine ingenuity.

Tt: What are they?

St: The phantoms that appear in dreams, and those that arise of their own accord during the day, such as a shadow when darkness occurs in firelight, and the doubles produced when one's own light, falling on bright and smooth surfaces, encounters the light from objects facing it, gives rise to an appearance opposite to the usual sight.

266c

Tt: These two are, indeed, products of divine making; the actual object and the image which follows in each case.

ἐγγίγνηται, διπλοῦν δὲ ἡνίκ' ἂν φῶς οἰκεῖόν τε καὶ ἀλλότριον περὶ τὰ λαμπρὰ καὶ λεῖα εἰς ἓν συνελθὼν τῆς ἔμπροσθεν εἰωθυίας ὄψεως ἐναντίαν αἴσθησιν παρέχον εἶδος ἀπεργάζεται. ΘΕΑΙ. δύο γὰρ οὖν ἐστὶ ταῦτα θείας ἔργα ποιήσεως, αὐτό τε καὶ τὸ παρακολουθοῦν εἶδωλον ἐκάστω. ΞΕ. τί δὲ τὴν ἡμετέραν τέχνην; ἄρ' οὐκ αὐτὴν μὲν οἰκίαν οἰκοδομικῇ φήσομεν ποιεῖν, γραφικῇ δέ τιν' ἑτέραν, οἷον ὄναρ ἀνθρώπινον ἐργηγορόσιν ἀπειργασμένην;

ST: What about our skill? Won't we say that on the one hand it produces the house itself by the skill of building, while on the other, by the skill of painting, it produces another, which is some sort of human-made dream for those who are awake.

TT: Just so.

ST: Then, on the same basis, all the other products of our productive activity also come in twos according to our account: there is the thing itself produced by the making skill, and the image produced by the image-making skill.

266d

TT: I understand better now. And I now propose that there are two twofold productive skills: the divine and the human, based on one division, and the other yields the things themselves and a sort of likeness of these.

ΘΕΑΙ. πάνυ μὲν οὖν. ΞΕ. οὐκοῦν καὶ τᾶλλα οὕτω κατὰ δύο διττὰ ἔργα τῆς ἡμετέρας αὐτῇ ποιητικῆς πράξεως, τὸ μὲν αὐτό, φαμέν, αὐτουργική, τὸ δὲ εἶδωλον εἰδωλοποιική. ΘΕΑΙ. νῦν μᾶλλον ἔμαθον, καὶ τίθημι δύο διχῇ ποιητικῆς εἶδει· θεῖαν μὲν καὶ ἀνθρωπίνην κατὰ θάτερον τμήμα, κατὰ δὲ θάτερον τὸ μὲν αὐτῶν ὄν, τὸ δὲ ὁμοιωμάτων τινῶν γέννημα. ΞΕ. τῆς τοίνυν εἰδωλουργικῆς ἀναμνησθῶμεν ὅτι τὸ μὲν εἰκαστικόν, τὸ δὲ φανταστικὸν ἔμελλεν εἶναι γένος, εἰ τὸ

ST: Now let's recall that we said there are two forms of image-making: one is likeness-making, while the other is appearance-making,

provided false had been shown to be truly false, and to belong by nature, among things that are.

TT: Yes, it was so.

ST: And this has appeared, and so on this basis shall we now propose, without dispute, that there are two forms?

TT: Yes.

266e

ST: Then let's divide the appearance-making, in turn, in two.

ψεῦδος ὄντως ὃν ψεῦδος καὶ τῶν ὄντων ἓν τι φανείη πεφυκός. ΘΕΑΙ. ἦν γὰρ οὖν. ΞΕ. οὐκοῦν ἐφάνη τε καὶ διὰ ταῦτα δὴ καταριθμήσομεν αὐτῶ νῦν ἀναμφισβητήτως εἶδη δύο; ΘΕΑΙ. ναί.

TT: How?

ST: One is the appearance produced by instruments, while the other is when the maker of the appearance presents himself as the instrument.

TT: What do you mean?

ST: Whenever someone uses his own body or voice to make something appear like your body or your voice, I think this part of appearance-making is, in general, called imitation.

TT: Yes.

267a

ST: Let us call this part imitation, and set it aside, and we shall be lazy and entrust the entire remainder to someone else, to make this one into one form and assign it an appropriate name.

ΞΕ. τὸ τοίνυν φανταστικὸν αὖθις διορίζωμεν δίχα. ΘΕΑΙ. πῆ; ΞΕ. τὸ μὲν δι' ὀργάνων γιγνόμενον, τὸ δὲ αὐτοῦ παρέχοντος ἑαυτὸν ὄργανον τοῦ ποιοῦντος τὸ φάντασμα. ΘΕΑΙ. πῶς φῆς; ΞΕ. ὅταν οἶμαι τὸ σὸν σχῆμά τις τῷ ἑαυτοῦ χρώμενος σώματι προσόμοιον ἢ φωνὴν φωνῇ φαίνεσθαι ποιῇ, μίμησις τοῦτο τῆς φανταστικῆς μάλιστα κέκληταί που. ΘΕΑΙ. ναί.

ΞΕ. μιμητικὸν δὴ τοῦτο αὐτῆς προσειπόντες ἀπονειμώμεθα· τὸ δ' ἄλλο πᾶν ἀφῶμεν μαλακισθέντες καὶ παρέντες

TT: Yes, that's how we should distinguish them and pass on the other.

ST: And yet, Theaetetus, it is appropriate to think of this also as two-fold. Now consider the reason why.

TT: Tell me.

ST: Of those who imitate, some do so with knowledge of what they imitate, others without knowledge of it. And what distinction shall we make that is greater than that between knowledge and ignorance?

TT: None.

267b

ST: Now, the imitation we just mentioned belonged to those who know. For someone who knows you and your character would imitate you.

ἐτέρῳ συναγαγεῖν τε εἰς ἓν καὶ πρέπουσαν ἐπωνυμίαν ἀποδοῦναί τιν' αὐτῷ. ΘΕΑΙ. νενεμήσθω, τὸ δὲ μεθείσθω. ΞΕ. καὶ μὴν καὶ τοῦτο ἔτι διπλοῦν, ὧ Θεαίτητε, ἄξιον ἡγεῖσθαι δι' ἃ δέ, σκόπει. ΘΕΑΙ. λέγε. ΞΕ. τῶν μιμουμένων οἱ μὲν εἰδότες ὃ μιμοῦνται τοῦτο πράττουσιν, οἱ δ' οὐκ εἰδότες. καίτοι τίνα μείζω διαίρεσιν ἀγνωσίας τε καὶ γνώσεως θήσομεν; ΘΕΑΙ. οὐδεμίαν. ΞΕ. οὐκοῦν τό γε ἄρτι λεχθὲν εἰδόντων ἦν μίμημα; τὸ γὰρ σὸν σχῆμα καὶ σὲ γιγνώσκων ἄν τις μιμήσαιο.

TT: Of course.

ST: But what about the appearance of justice and excellence in general? Don't many, who are ignorant of these but somehow have some opinion about them, give the appearance of inhabiting them by being eager to imitate what they themselves think, in word and deed, as much as possible?

TT: Yes, there are very many indeed.

ST: So, do they all fail in seeming to be just, although they are not at all? Or is the opposite the case?

TT: Quite the opposite.

267c

ST: I think then, we should say that this person is an imitator who is different from the other, the ignorant one from the one who knows.

ΘΕΑΙ. πῶς δ' οὐ; ΞΕ. τί δὲ δικαιοσύνης τὸ σχῆμα καὶ ὅλης συλλήβδην ἀρετῆς; ἄρ' οὐκ ἀγνοοῦντες μέν, δοξάζοντες δέ πη, σφόδρα ἐπιχειροῦσιν πολλοὶ τὸ δοκοῦν σφίσιν τοῦτο ὡς ἐνὸν αὐτοῖς προθυμεῖσθαι φαίνεσθαι ποιεῖν, ὅτι μάλιστα ἔργοις τε καὶ λόγοις μιμούμενοι; ΘΕΑΙ. καὶ πάνυ γε πολλοί. ΞΕ. μῶν οὖν πάντες ἀποτυχάνουσι τοῦ δοκεῖν εἶναι δίκαιοι μηδαμῶς ὄντες; ἢ τούτου πᾶν τούναντίον; ΘΕΑΙ. πᾶν.

TT: Yes.

ST: Now, where should we look for an appropriate name for each of them? Or is it obvious that this is somehow difficult, because there was some long-standing ignorance among the men of old when it came to dividing the kinds into forms, so that no one ever even bothered to make any division, and so it must be the case that names are not very abundant. However, even if it is somewhat rash to do so, let us, for the sake of the distinction, call the imitation based upon opinion, opinionative imitation, while the imitation based on knowledge is a kind of knowledgeable imitation.

TT: Let it be so.

267d

ST: Well, we should use the former, for the sophist did not belong with those who know, but with those who imitate.

ΞΕ. μιμητὴν δὴ τοῦτόν γε ἕτερον ἐκείνου λεκτέον οἶμαι, τὸν ἀγνοοῦντα τοῦ γιγνώσκοντος. ΘΕΑΙ. ναί. ΞΕ. πόθεν οὖν ὄνομα ἐκατέρῳ τις αὐτῶν λήψεται πρέπον; ἢ δῆλον δὴ χαλεπὸν ὄν, διότι τῆς τῶν γενῶν κατ' εἶδη διαιρέσεως παλαιά τις, ὡς ἔοικεν, ἀργία τοῖς ἔμπροσθεν καὶ ἀσύννους

παρῆν, ὥστε μὴδ' ἐπιχειρεῖν μηδένα διαιρεῖσθαι· καθὸ δὴ τῶν ὀνομάτων ἀνάγκη μὴ σφόδρα εὐπορεῖν. ὅμως δέ, κἂν εἰ τολμηρότερον εἰρῆσθαι, διαγνώσεως ἔνεκα τὴν

TT: Yes, certainly.

ST: Then let's examine this opinionative imitator, just like a piece of iron, to see whether he is sound or whether there is still some flaw in him.

TT: We should examine him.

ST: Indeed, there is a really very significant flaw. For one of them is naive, thinking that he knows the matters about which he holds opinions, while the disposition of the other has had a great deal of involvement in arguments, and his very disposition gives rise to misgivings and fears that he does not know what he pretends to know in the presence of others.

267e

TT: Yes, certainly. There are indeed both kinds you describe.

μὲν μετὰ δόξης μίμησιν δοξομιμητικὴν προσείπωμεν, τὴν δὲ μετ' ἐπιστήμης ἱστορικὴν τινα μίμησιν. ΘΕΑΙ. ἔστω. ΞΕ. θατέρω τοίνυν χρηστέον· ὁ γὰρ σοφιστὴς οὐκ ἐν τοῖς εἰδόσιν ἦν ἀλλ' ἐν τοῖς μιμουμένοις δῆ. ΘΕΑΙ. καὶ μάλα. ΞΕ. τὸν δοξομιμητὴν δὲ σκοπώμεθα ὥσπερ σίδηρον, εἴτε ὑγιὲς εἴτε διπλόην ἔτ' ἔχων τινὰ ἐστὶν ἐν αὐτῷ. ΘΕΑΙ. σκοπῶμεν. ΞΕ. ἔχει τοίνυν καὶ μάλα συχνήν. ὁ μὲν γὰρ εὐήθης

ST: So, should we propose that one is a simple imitator while the other is an ironical imitator?

TT: That's likely.

ST: And should we, in turn, say that the form of this fellow is one, or two?

TT: Consider it yourself.

ST: I am considering it, and there appear, to a great extent, to be two. One I see, who is able to dissemble openly in lengthy speeches before large numbers, while the other does this in private, in short discourses, and forces the person who is conversing with him to contradict himself.

268a

TT: What you say is perfectly correct.

αὐτῶν ἔστιν, οἰόμενος εἰδέναι ταῦτα ἃ δοξάζει· τὸ δὲ θατέρου σχῆμα διὰ τὴν ἐν τοῖς λόγοις κυλίνδην ἔχει πολλὴν ὑποψίαν καὶ φόβον ὥς ἄγνοεῖ ταῦτα ἃ πρὸς τοὺς ἄλλους ὥς εἰδὼς ἐσχημάτισται. ΘΕΑΙ. πάνυ μὲν οὖν ἔστιν ἐκατέρου γένος ὢν εἴρηκας. ΞΕ. οὐκοῦν τὸν μὲν ἀπλοῦν μιμητὴν τινα, τὸν δὲ εἰρωνικὸν μιμητὴν θήσομεν; ΘΕΑΙ. εἰκὸς γοῦν. ΞΕ. τούτου δ' αὖτὸ γένος ἐν ἧ δύο φῶμεν; ΘΕΑΙ. ὅρα σύ.

ST: Now, who should we propose is the more long-winded type? Is he a statesman or a popular orator?

TT: A popular orator.

ST: And what shall we call the other? A wise person, or a sophist?

TT: A wise person is impossible, since we proposed that he was ignorant, but since he is an imitator of a wise person, it is clear that he will have a name derived from his, and now I am almost in a position to recognise that we must really and truly refer to this person as the man who is sophist in every sense.

268b

ST: Then shall we put together his name, as we did before, weaving it together from end to beginning?

ΞΕ. σκοπῶ, καί μοι διττῷ καταφαίνεσθόν τινε· τὸν μὲν δημοσίᾳ τε καὶ μακροῖς λόγοις πρὸς πλήθη δυνατόν εἰρωνεύεσθαι καθορῶ, τὸν δὲ ἰδίᾳ τε καὶ βραχέσι λόγοις ἀναγκάζοντα τὸν προσδιαλεγόμενον ἐναντιολογεῖν αὐτὸν αὐτῷ. ΘΕΑΙ. λέγεις ὀρθότατα. ΞΕ. τίνα οὖν ἀποφαινόμεθα τὸν μακρολογώτερον εἶναι; πότερα πολιτικὸν ἢ δημολογικόν; ΘΕΑΙ. δημολογικόν. ΞΕ. τί δὲ τὸν ἕτερον ἐροῦμεν; σοφὸν

ἢ σοφιστικόν; ΘΕΑΙ. τὸ μέν που σοφὸν ἀδύνατον, ἐπείπερ οὐκ εἰδότα αὐτὸν ἔθεμεν· μιμητὴς δ' ὢν τοῦ σοφοῦ δῆλον ὅτι παρωνύμιον αὐτοῦ τι λήψεται, καὶ σχεδὸν ἤδη μεμάθηκα ὅτι τοῦτον δεῖ προσεῖπεῖν ἀληθῶς αὐτὸν ἐκεῖνον τὸν παντάπασιν ὄντως σοφιστήν. ΞΕ. οὐκοῦν συνδήσομεν αὐτοῦ, καθάπερ ἔμπροσθεν, τοῦνομα συμπλέξαντες ἀπὸ τελευτῆς ἐπ' ἀρχήν; ΘΕΑΙ. πάνυ μὲν οὖν. ΞΕ. τὸ δὴ τῆς ἐναντιοποιολογικῆς εἰρωνικοῦ μέρους τῆς δοξαστικῆς μιμητικόν, τοῦ φανταστικοῦ γένους ἀπὸ τῆς

ΤΤ: Quite so.

ST: Now, the contradiction-making, ironical part of opinionative imitation belongs to the appearance-making kind, which is part of image-making and is marked off as the human, not the divine, part of production in the realm of word-making and wonder-working. So, anyone who says that the true sophist is "of that lineage and blood"¹⁵ will, it seems, speak the absolute truth.

268d

ΤΤ: Entirely so.

εἰδωλοποιικῆς οὐ θεῖον ἀλλ' ἀνθρωπικὸν τῆς ποιήσεως ἀφωρισμένον ἐν λόγοις τὸ θαυματοποιικὸν μόριον, ταύτης τῆς γενεᾶς τε καὶ αἵματος ὃς ἂν φῇ τὸν ὄντως σοφιστήν εἶναι, τάληθέστατα, ὥς ἔοικεν, ἐρεῖ. ΘΕΑΙ. παντάπασι μὲν οὖν.

Notes

¹ A reference to the conversation in the Theaetetus, which concluded the previous day. At the end of that dialogue (Theaetetus 210d), Socrates arranged to meet Theaetetus and Theodorus again on the following morning.

² Elea was a Greek colony in southern Italy, home to the philosophers Parmenides and Zeno, whose teachings emphasised the unity and unchangeability of being. The Eleatic Stranger is presented as a follower of this philosophical tradition.

³ A loose reference to Homer, *Odyssey* ix.270–271, where the god Zeus is described as the protector of strangers and suppliants who watches over human affairs.

⁴ A reference to Homer, *Odyssey* xvii.485–487, where gods in the likeness of strangers from afar are said to wander the cities of men, observing their behaviour.

⁵ A reference to Plato's dialogue *Parmenides*, in which the young Socrates engages in conversation with the elderly Parmenides and his associate Zeno.

⁶ The Greek word 'sophistes' is derived from 'sophos' (wise or clever). The stranger here plays on the etymology, observing that the sophist's name implies a wisdom which he does not in fact possess.

⁷ 'The Great King' was the standard Greek term for the King of Persia, ruler of the vast Persian Empire and traditionally regarded as the most powerful and wealthy man in the known world.

⁸ Protagoras of Abdera (c. 490–420 BCE) was one of the most famous of the early sophists. He is the principal figure in Plato's dialogue *Protagoras*, and his views on knowledge and perception are discussed extensively in the *Theaetetus*.

⁹ Parmenides, *Fragment 7*, lines 1–2. This same passage is quoted again by the Stranger at 258d as the 'paternal maxim' which they must refute.

¹⁰ A reference back to the paternal maxim of Parmenides quoted at 237a, which forbids the proposition that 'things that are not, are'.

¹¹ The 'Ionian Muses' is taken to refer to Heraclitus of Ephesus, and the 'Sicilian Muses' to Empedocles of Acragas. Empedocles maintained that the cosmos was governed by the alternating forces of Love (combining) and Strife (separating).

¹² A reference to Heraclitus, *Fragment 51*, expressing the doctrine that opposites are simultaneously in tension and harmony – combining even as they separate.

¹³ A reference to the mythical battle between the Olympian gods and the Giants, in which the Giants attempted to overthrow the gods by piling mountains upon one another to scale heaven. The story is recounted in Hesiod's *Theogony* 675–715 and elsewhere.

¹⁴ Eurycles was a famous Athenian ventriloquist and soothsayer who appeared to have a voice speaking from within his belly. Reference is made to him in Aristophanes, *Wasps* 1017–1020.

¹⁵ A formulaic Homeric phrase used when concluding a genealogy or lineage. The Stranger is using it ironically to mark the completion of the sophist's pedigree of definitions. Compare *Iliad* 6.211.